The Social Democratic Market Platform

Version 1.2

Gregory L. Meyers

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The Social Democratic Market Platform

A Governing Blueprint for Shared Prosperity, Competitive Markets, Democratic Accountability, Scientific Advancement, and National Resilience

Version 1.2 — Complete Edition

Gregory L. Meyers

Publication Date: November 2026

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

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Public Release Version 1.2

AUTHOR'S NOTE

The Social Democratic Market Platform was developed by Gregory L. Meyers through an iterative process of research, analysis, drafting, review, and revision.

Various software tools, including artificial intelligence-assisted drafting, editing, and research-support tools, were used during portions of the development process to improve organization, clarity, and presentation. All policy positions, structural decisions, classifications, revisions, and final content reflect the judgment, review, and approval of the author.

This document represents the author's policy recommendations and governing philosophy. Its purpose is to provide a comprehensive framework for public discussion concerning economic opportunity, democratic accountability, competitive markets, scientific progress, fiscal responsibility, and long-term national resilience.

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Version 1.1 | November 2026

Consistency Edition. Resolves the contradictions found in the v1.0 audit: one authoritative financing chapter (Chapter 27) with a single use for every revenue stream; Social Security, Universal Health Insurance and frontier AI chapters aligned with their white papers; independent bodies redesigned for *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026); carbon fee revenue split 80/10/10; reorganized into nine Parts and 27 chapters (see Appendix D for the old-to-new section map). See CHANGELOG.md for the full list.

Version 1.2 | November 2026

Complete Edition. Fills the gaps identified in the v1.1 audit: - new chapters on Federal Tax Fairness (Chapter 2), Income Security (Chapter 4), and Civil Rights (Chapter 13); - technology and AI at work (Section 3.6); - public coverage of abortion care, conscience protections, and emergency care (Chapter 6); - rent stabilization and homelessness (Chapter 8); - reversal of the 2025 SNAP cuts; - officer accountability, including suits against federal officers (Chapter 16); - reproductive health in foreign assistance (Section 23.5.4); - a completed General Fund phase-in order; - a new Appendix B on implementation and legislative strategy, including a Senate rules reform; - a Scope page and honest-limit notes for every High Resistance plank.

See CHANGELOG.md for the full list.

Platform Overview

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

The Social Democratic Market Platform rejects the choice between centralized economic control and unrestricted markets. Government guarantees a strong public foundation: healthcare, education, infrastructure, public safety, democratic institutions, and equal opportunity. On that foundation, competitive markets remain the primary engine of innovation, investment, and prosperity.

Three Core Goals

1. Guarantee every American a baseline of economic security and genuine opportunity.
2. Preserve competitive markets, entrepreneurship, private property, and free enterprise as the primary engines of innovation, growth, and wealth creation.
3. Use government intervention only where markets systematically fail to provide efficient, fair, or broadly accessible outcomes.

How the Platform Is Organized

Part	What it covers
I. Economic Foundations	Rules-based recession response, federal tax fairness including the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax, a living wage, paid leave and care, and the safety net
II. Human Development	Universal Health Insurance, reproductive health protection, education from preschool through tuition-free public college, and housing
III. Competitive Markets	Anti-monopoly enforcement and consumer rights, family farms, and trade with strategic protection
IV. Democracy, Governance & Public Trust	Election reform, civil rights, effective government, and ethics
V. Justice, Public Safety & Immigration	Violent-crime priority, rehabilitation, accountability, and a secure, orderly, humane immigration system
VI. Science & Technology	Research and space leadership, and capability-based frontier AI governance
VII. Climate, Infrastructure & Resilience	A carbon fee with household dividends, clean-energy buildout, infrastructure and supply chains, and disaster resilience
VIII. Security & Global Leadership	Diplomacy first, strong alliances, a capable defensive military, and voluntary national service
IX. Long-Term Sustainability	Social Security without benefit cuts, and the Master Financing Framework

How It Is Paid For

Every revenue stream is assigned to exactly one use, so no dollar is counted twice, and recurring programs draw only on stable revenue (Chapter 27). No major program takes effect without an independent cost estimate and its assigned revenue. Dollar estimates are not yet included in this edition.

How to Read It

Each provision carries a legal classification (see Legal Classifications), and the most difficult provisions include an *honest limit* stating their main legal or political risk. Where the platform and a white paper differ, the white paper governs. A full Executive Summary is published separately.

Build the foundation. Expand opportunity. Strengthen democracy. Invest in the future. Empower the people.

Legal Classifications

[Statute] Federal legislation passed by majorities in both chambers. In the Senate, ending debate currently requires 60 votes, unless the provision is enacted through budget reconciliation or after the Senate rules reform in Appendix B. The legislative path for each plank is listed in Appendix B, Section B.3.

[Statute – High Resistance] Legislation facing substantial political, legal, economic, or administrative barriers.

[Senate Rule] A change to the Senate's standing rules or precedents, adopted by the Senate alone (Appendix B).

[Executive] Achievable through executive authority.

[Constitutional Amendment] Requires constitutional ratification.

Constitutionally Contested A flag added to a classification when serious constitutional objections are likely. Each such provision includes an honest-limit note.

Governing Principles of the Social Democratic Market Platform

Purpose

The policies contained within this platform are organized around a unified governing philosophy rather than a collection of isolated proposals. These principles provide the framework through which all statutes, regulations, investments, and reforms should be interpreted and implemented.

Whenever ambiguity exists, policymakers should seek outcomes that best advance these principles as a whole.

Core Values

Principle 1: Human Dignity

Every person possesses inherent worth and deserves to be treated with dignity, fairness, and respect.

Public institutions should safeguard individual rights, ensure due process, and maintain equal treatment under the law regardless of income, race, religion, sex, disability, age, political affiliation, or citizenship status, while recognizing that eligibility for some benefits, such as full public health insurance under Section 5.1, depends on lawful residence.

Economic policy exists to serve people, not the other way around.

Principle 2: Equal Opportunity

Opportunity should not be determined by the circumstances of birth.

Every person should have access to the foundational systems necessary to pursue success, including:

- Healthcare
- Education
- Public safety
- Infrastructure
- Communications
- Housing opportunity

Government cannot guarantee outcomes, but it can and should guarantee access to opportunity.

Principle 3: Democratic Accountability

Government derives its legitimacy from the consent of the governed.

Public institutions must remain:

- Transparent
- Accountable
- Ethical
- Accessible
- Responsive

Public office is a public trust and shall never be used for private enrichment.

Citizens must retain the ability to monitor, challenge, and reform their government through democratic institutions.

Governing Principles

Principle 4: Competitive Markets

Free and competitive markets remain the most effective engine for innovation, investment, productivity, and wealth creation.

Government should preserve competition rather than replace markets.

Public policy should:

- Prevent monopoly power

- Protect consumer choice
- Encourage entrepreneurship
- Remove unnecessary barriers to entry
- Reward innovation and productivity

Success should come through value creation rather than political favoritism or market dominance.

Principle 5: Scientific Evidence

Sound public policy should be guided by evidence, measurable outcomes, and empirical research.

Programs should be evaluated according to effectiveness rather than ideology.

Scientific inquiry, academic freedom, and the pursuit of knowledge strengthen both democracy and economic prosperity.

Good ideas should survive scrutiny. Failed ideas should be revised regardless of political origin.

Principle 6: Fiscal Responsibility

Future generations should not inherit unsustainable obligations created by present-day decisions.

Public investments should be financed responsibly, evaluated honestly, and implemented transparently.

Borrowing may be justified when creating long-term productive assets, but recurring obligations should be matched with sustainable revenue sources whenever practical.

Fiscal responsibility is not an alternative to public investment. It is a requirement for lasting public investment.

Long-Term Responsibilities

Principle 7: National Resilience

A prosperous nation must be capable of preparing for, responding to, and recovering from major disruptions.

National resilience includes:

- Economic stability
- Public health preparedness
- Infrastructure reliability
- Energy security

- Supply-chain resilience
- Disaster readiness
- Cybersecurity
- Democratic continuity

Short-term efficiency should never undermine long-term national security or stability.

Principle 8: Stewardship of Future Generations

Each generation holds a temporary responsibility for institutions, infrastructure, resources, and freedoms that will be inherited by those who follow.

Public policy should consider not only immediate benefits, but also long-term consequences.

Investments in education, science, infrastructure, environmental stewardship, and democratic institutions are investments in future generations.

Principle 9: Civic Responsibility

Freedom is strengthened when citizens actively participate in their communities and democratic institutions.

A healthy society depends upon citizens who:

- Vote
- Volunteer
- Serve their communities
- Respect democratic processes
- Contribute to the common good

Government can create opportunity, but strong communities are built by engaged citizens.

Principle 10: The Public Foundation

The central organizing principle of this platform is the belief that government should provide a strong public foundation upon which individuals, families, communities, and businesses can thrive.

That foundation includes:

- Healthcare
- Education
- Infrastructure
- Public safety

- Democratic institutions
- Scientific research
- Equal opportunity

Once this foundation exists, citizens remain free to pursue their own goals, build wealth, create businesses, innovate, and shape their futures.

Final Clause

In the event of conflict between competing policy objectives, policymakers should seek solutions that best advance these ten principles as a whole.

These principles express the platform's philosophy. For the legal interpretation of statutes, the Statutory Interpretation Principle in the Definitions governs.

The Social Democratic Market Compact

This platform is founded on a simple belief:

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

Government shall guarantee the essential foundations of opportunity.

Citizens shall remain free to pursue success according to their own talents, goals, and aspirations.

Competitive markets shall serve as the primary engine of innovation, investment, and prosperity.

Together, these principles form the Social Democratic Market Model and provide the framework for every policy contained within this platform.

Definitions

The following definitions shall apply throughout The Social Democratic Market Platform unless otherwise specified by statute, constitutional amendment, or implementing legislation.

Living Wage

A Living Wage is the minimum hourly compensation necessary for a full-time worker to meet basic living expenses within a specific geographic area without requiring public assistance for ordinary necessities.

The calculation shall consider:

- **Housing**
- **Food**

- **Transportation**
- **Healthcare**
- **Childcare**
- **Utilities**
- **Basic communication services**
- **Essential savings**

A Living Wage may vary by region to reflect differences in local costs of living.

The Living Wage serves as the benchmark used to set the percentage of the federal poverty line in Section 3.1.

Costs met by universal public programs established in this platform (such as public health insurance, preschool, and capped childcare) shall be excluded from the calculation to avoid double-counting.

Productive Capital Expenditure

A Productive Capital Expenditure is an investment that increases long-term economic output, productive capacity, workforce capability, infrastructure quality, or scientific advancement.

Examples include:

- **Manufacturing expansion**
- **Research and development**
- **Workforce training**
- **Infrastructure construction**
- **Technology upgrades**
- **Equipment modernization**

Productive Capital Expenditures shall be distinguished from purely speculative or consumptive expenditures.

Critical Emergency Supplies

Critical Emergency Supplies are goods necessary to maintain public safety, public health, or national resilience during emergencies.

These may include:

- **Medical equipment**
- **Essential pharmaceuticals**

- **Protective equipment**
- **Emergency communications systems**
- **Water-treatment materials**
- **Energy-related emergency components**
- **Disaster-response equipment**

The federal government may designate additional categories when justified by national risk assessments.

Frontier AI System

A Frontier AI System is an artificial intelligence model or collection of models demonstrating capabilities sufficiently advanced to create substantial economic, societal, cybersecurity, national-security, or public-safety consequences.

Determinations shall rest primarily on demonstrated performance, assessed under the Algorithmic Capability Index, with training compute serving as a screening trigger (Section 19.2.1).

Autonomous AI Action

An Autonomous AI Action is a decision, activity, process, or sequence of operations performed by an artificial intelligence system without direct human approval for each individual action at the time the action occurs.

Examples may include:

- **Independent cybersecurity operations**
- **Resource allocation decisions**
- **Multi-step task execution**
- **Software deployment**
- **Financial transactions**

Routine automated functions with clearly constrained authority may receive separate regulatory treatment.

Strategic Industry

A Strategic Industry is an economic sector whose disruption would significantly affect national security, economic stability, public health, or critical infrastructure.

Strategic industries may include:

- **Semiconductors**
- **Pharmaceuticals**

- **Biotechnology**
- **Aerospace**
- **Energy production**
- **Advanced manufacturing**
- **Communications infrastructure**
- **Critical mineral production**

Congress may periodically revise this designation.

Human Dignity Standard

The Human Dignity Standard requires that individuals interacting with public institutions be treated with fairness, respect, due process, and recognition of their inherent worth regardless of citizenship status, income level, race, religion, disability, age, sex, or political affiliation.

This standard applies throughout:

- **Healthcare systems**
- **Criminal justice systems**
- **Immigration systems**
- **Public-benefit administration**
- **Government services**

Addiction Hotspot

An Addiction Hotspot is a geographic area experiencing unusually high rates of:

- **Substance dependency**
- **Drug overdoses**
- **Addiction-related hospitalizations**
- **Addiction-related criminal activity**

Designation may qualify a community for targeted prevention, treatment, and recovery resources.

Beneficial Ownership

Beneficial Ownership refers to the natural person or persons who ultimately control, profit from, or possess economic interest in an asset, corporation, trust, partnership, or other legal entity, regardless of intermediary ownership structures.

Beneficial ownership disclosure requirements shall be used to reduce:

- **Tax evasion**
- **Money laundering**
- **Fraud**
- **Concealed political influence**
- **Illicit financial activity**

National Resilience

National Resilience is the ability of the United States to prepare for, withstand, respond to, recover from, and adapt to disruptive events while maintaining essential societal functions.

National resilience encompasses:

- **Economic resilience**
- **Infrastructure resilience**
- **Disaster preparedness**
- **Public-health readiness**
- **Supply-chain security**
- **Cybersecurity**
- **Energy reliability**
- **Democratic continuity**

Competitive Market

A Competitive Market is a market characterized by:

- **Multiple sellers**
- **Consumer choice**
- **Relatively low barriers to entry**
- **Transparent information**
- **Fair competition**

Competition should occur on the basis of:

- **Innovation**

- **Quality**
- **Efficiency**
- **Service**

rather than anti-competitive conduct or regulatory favoritism.

Family Farm

A Family Farm is an agricultural business primarily owned, managed, and operated by an individual, family, or family-controlled entity rather than by a publicly traded corporation, foreign government, or large institutional investment group.

Evidence-Based Governance

Evidence-Based Governance is the practice of designing, evaluating, and modifying public policy according to measurable outcomes, empirical evidence, scientific research, and transparent performance metrics rather than ideological preference alone.

Programs should be evaluated according to:

- **Effectiveness**
- **Efficiency**
- **Cost-benefit performance**
- **Public outcomes**
- **Long-term sustainability**

Public Foundation

The Public Foundation refers collectively to the core public systems necessary for opportunity and long-term prosperity, including:

- **Healthcare**
- **Education**
- **Infrastructure**
- **Public safety**
- **Democratic institutions**
- **Scientific research**
- **Environmental stewardship**
- **Equal opportunity protections**

The Public Foundation is the central organizing principle of this platform.

Sovereign Wealth Reserve

The Sovereign Wealth Reserve is a publicly owned investment fund designed to:

- **Stabilize economic cycles**
- **Hold Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue up to a statutory stabilization target**
- **Strengthen fiscal resilience**

Assets shall be professionally managed under transparent and independent governance structures. The Reserve exists solely for recession stabilization. No other program may claim it (Section 27.5).

Dominance Threshold

A firm meets the Dominance Threshold in a market when it holds a durable share of that market and is protected by barriers to entry that prevent effective competition, as specified in statute and in rules issued by the enforcing agencies. Size alone shall never trigger intervention. Duties that apply above the threshold target conduct. Used in Sections 8.1.3, 9.2, and 10.1.5.

Strategic Protection Test

A trade restriction, sourcing requirement, or domestic-production preference meets the Strategic Protection Test only if it (1) addresses a documented national-security or resilience need identified under Section 21.6, (2) has an estimated and capped cost to consumers and businesses, (3) carries a sunset and review date, and (4) in the case of a tariff, rests on authority expressly granted by Congress. Used in Sections 11.2, 21.6.1, 21.8, and 24.3.

Coordinated Review Standard

Faster permitting shall come from funded staff, coordinated agency review, and clear timelines, never from narrowing environmental or safety review or limiting public participation (Section 21.9).

Capital Investment and Recurring Obligation

A capital investment creates a long-lived productive asset, such as infrastructure or research facilities. A recurring obligation is an ongoing program cost. Recurring obligations shall be paid only from stable revenue (Chapter 27).

Hosted and Open-Weight Models

A hosted model runs on infrastructure its developer controls and can be suspended. An open-weight model's parameters have been publicly released and cannot be recalled (Chapter 19).

Statutory Interpretation Principle

When ambiguity in the platform's statutory provisions must be resolved, interpretation should favor the following Governing Principles, in this order:

1. **Democratic accountability.**
2. **Human dignity.**
3. **Competitive markets.**
4. **Scientific evidence.**
5. **Long-term national resilience.**
6. **Equal opportunity.**
7. **Fiscal responsibility.**

The full statement of each principle appears in the Governing Principles.

No major program in this platform shall take effect without an identified funding source and an independent cost estimate under Chapter 27.

Scope of This Edition

This edition sets out the platform's positions, legal design, financing rules, and legislative strategy. Some topics need more detail than a platform chapter can carry. They are handled in standalone white papers, which govern in the event of a conflict with the corresponding platform chapter (decision 0001). In areas not addressed by a white paper, the platform chapter controls.

Published White Papers

White paper	Platform chapter
Universal Health Insurance: A Hybrid Framework for Universal Coverage	5
Social Security Solvency: Without Benefit Cuts or Raising the Retirement Age	26
Frontier AI Governance: A Framework for Innovation, Accountability, and Public Safety	19

Forthcoming White Papers

White paper	Platform chapter	What it will add
Federal Tax Fairness (scored version)	2	Independent revenue estimates for the proposed rates

White paper	Platform chapter	What it will add
Housing & Homelessness	8	Costing of housing and homelessness programs, voucher expansion, prevention policy, Housing First implementation, and rent stabilization enforcement
AI and the Future of Work	3, 19	Evidence on displacement and the design of Universal Adjustment Assistance
Financial Regulation & Consumer Finance	—	A topic this edition does not yet cover
Regional Foreign Policy (China, Russia and Ukraine, the Middle East, arms control)	23	Region-by-region positions beyond the general principles of Chapter 23

What This Edition Does Not Yet Include

- **Dollar estimates.** No program has been independently scored. The costing table is maintained in data/costing.csv and will be filled from published estimates (Section 27.12).
- **Implementing legislation.** Sections describe what the law shall do, not its statutory text.
- **Financial regulation** and **region-specific foreign policy**, which await the white papers above.

PART I: ECONOMIC FOUNDATIONS

Chapter 1: Macroeconomic Stability

1.1 Steady Economic Growth [Statute]

The central bank shall maintain a stable nominal GDP growth target of approximately 4-5 percent annually to reduce recession severity and maintain employment stability.

1.2 Recession Emergency Valve [Statute]

Baseline federal spending shall be capped relative to the size of the economy. The cap shall be suspended automatically, within the first quarter of a downturn, when a rules-based recession indicator (such as an early-warning unemployment trigger of the Sahm Rule type) is met and core inflation is at or below a defined target threshold. The inflation threshold prevents fiscal stimulus from compounding a supply-shock or stagflationary crisis. The cap shall return only after a sustained, multi-quarter confirmation of economic recovery, so that spending is not

withdrawn prematurely. Outside a downturn, the cap may rise only by the independently scored revenue that a newly enacted program brings with it (Section 27.6).

1.3 Sovereign Wealth Reserve [Statute]

A protected sovereign reserve fund shall exist solely to stabilize the economy during recessions. It shall be funded by Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue (Section 2.1) up to a stabilization target fixed in statute, drawn only when the recession trigger in Section 1.2 is met, and refilled after recovery. Revenue above the target shall go to a Capital Investment Account for one-time capital projects only. No other program, fund, or endowment may claim the Reserve, except the automatic extended unemployment benefits in Section 4.4.4. Full rules are in Section 27.5.

Chapter 2: Federal Tax Fairness

Funding role: Chapter 27 assigns the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax (Sections 2.1 to 2.3) only to the Sovereign Wealth Reserve. The federal tax fairness measures in Sections 2.6 to 2.10 are the platform's stable revenue for recurring programs (decisions 0004, 0008, 0022).

A fair tax system asks the most from those who have gained the most, taxes income from wealth on the same terms as income from work, and does not let the largest fortunes pass between generations untaxed. It should also be honest about how high the combined rates become, and it should set limits on them. This chapter does both.

2.1 Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax [Statute – High Resistance]

A tax shall apply to wealth above an inflation-indexed threshold of $50 million, in marginal brackets rather than a single cliff, excluding primary residences, retirement accounts, and ordinary small businesses. The tax shall be designed as closely as possible to a tax on gains, to reduce constitutional risk under the Direct Tax Clause.

- Publicly traded assets: unrealized gains shall be taxed annually using daily market closing prices.
- Illiquid assets (private companies and closely held businesses): taxed at realization.
- Loans and synthetic liquidity: any large loan collateralized by covered assets, and any transaction that provides liquidity referencing an asset's value without a taxable sale (including prepaid variable forward contracts, equity collars, and swaps), shall count as a realization event. This broadens the constructive-sale precedent in Internal Revenue Code Section 1259.

Implementation note: because this rule is written broadly on purpose, expect multi-year litigation over the boundary between legitimate hedging and taxable liquidity extraction.

2.1.1 Enhanced Anti-Evasion Framework [Statute]

Mandatory beneficial ownership reporting, asset aggregation requirements, global disclosure standards, concealment penalties, and strengthened exit-tax provisions shall prevent avoidance schemes. Aggregation rules shall cover trusts, family entities, and minor children.

2.2 Liquidity Smoothing Mechanism [Statute]

Covered taxpayers may satisfy certain obligations through transfers of non-voting equity. Equity received shall be held in a separate passive account, shall carry no government voting or control rights, shall not count toward the Sovereign Wealth Reserve's recession-stabilization balance, and shall be sold down on a defined schedule.

2.3 Productive Capital Exemption [Statute]

Borrowing against business equity is exempt from the realization rule in Section 2.1 only when the proceeds are contributed directly to the operating business and used for productive capital expenditure (such as payroll growth, infrastructure, manufacturing expansion, or research and development), verified through audited tracing of funds. Loan proceeds used for personal consumption, owner distributions, or the purchase of unrelated assets are realization events. The exemption shall be capped as a share of the borrower's covered wealth to prevent abuse.

2.4 Targeted IRS Audits [Statute]

A dedicated High-Net-Worth and Complex-Entity Enforcement Division shall be statutorily ring-fenced. Its funding shall be restricted by appropriations rider to audits of filers above the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax threshold and of large or complex corporate and partnership structures and shall not be used to audit ordinary filers. The IRS shall publicly report audit rates by income and wealth bracket, and the division shall be reauthorized every five years based on performance data.

2.5 State Tax Progressivity Incentive [Statute]

Federal incentives shall encourage states to move toward more progressive taxation and away from highly regressive sales tax dependence.

2.6 Restored Top Income-Tax Rate [Statute]

The top federal income-tax rate on ordinary income shall be 39.6 percent, the rate in effect before 2018. It shall apply above the income level at which the 37 percent bracket begins under current law: $640,600 for single filers and $768,700 for married couples filing jointly in 2026, indexed for inflation. No other bracket shall change.

The 2025 reconciliation law made the 37 percent rate permanent, so this section is a tax increase relative to current law. It is a modest and familiar one: the same top rate applied for most of the 1990s and again from 2013 through 2017.

2.7 Capital Income Parity [Statute – High Resistance]

Income from wealth should not be taxed more lightly than income from work at the top of the income scale. Today a household earning $5 million from wages pays 37 percent plus Medicare taxes on its last dollar, while a household earning $5 million from selling stock pays 20 percent plus the 3.8 percent net investment income tax. And gains held until death are never taxed at all.

2.7.1 Gains and Dividends Taxed as Ordinary Income Above $1 Million

Long-term capital gains and qualified dividends shall be taxed at ordinary income rates to the extent a taxpayer's adjusted gross income exceeds $1 million, indexed for inflation. Only the portion above the threshold shall be taxed at the higher rate, so there is no cliff at $1 million.

Below the threshold, current capital-gains rates shall continue to apply. The 3.8 percent net investment income tax shall remain, for a top rate on capital income of 43.4 percent.

2.7.2 Carried Interest

Carried interest, the share of an investment fund's profits paid to the fund's managers for managing it, shall be taxed as ordinary income at every income level. It is pay for services, not a return on the managers' own capital.

2.7.3 Transfers at Death and by Gift as Realization Events

Appreciated property transferred at death or by gift shall be treated as sold at its fair market value, and the gain shall be taxed as income to the person making the transfer, under these rules:

- **Exclusion:** the first $5 million of gains per person shall be exempt ($10 million per married couple, with any unused amount passing to the surviving spouse), indexed for inflation.
- **Existing protections kept:** the current exclusion for gains on a principal residence shall continue in addition to the $5 million exclusion. Transfers to a spouse or to charity shall not trigger tax; a spouse shall take over the original cost basis.
- **Family farms and businesses:** tax on a family-owned farm or business shall be deferred for as long as the family continues to own and operate it, and shall come due only when it is sold or stops being family-owned and operated. This keeps faith with Chapter 10's protection of family farms.
- **Illiquid assets:** tax on other illiquid assets may be paid over fifteen years, with interest.
- **Retirement accounts and personal belongings:** retirement accounts, which are already taxed when money is withdrawn, and ordinary personal belongings shall be excluded.

This section is what makes Section 2.7.1 work. Without it, the most effective way to avoid a higher capital-gains rate is to hold assets until death, when the gain disappears. The Penn Wharton Budget Model estimates that a 33 percent rate on capital gains raises the most revenue while gains escape tax at death, and that the figure rises to 42 percent once death is treated as a realization event [3]. The 43.4 percent top rate in Section 2.7.1 therefore depends on this section.

2.7.4 No Gain Taxed Twice

The taxes in this chapter shall be coordinated so that no dollar of gain is taxed twice:

- Gains on publicly traded assets already taxed each year under Section 2.1 shall increase the asset's tax basis, so they are not taxed again when the asset is sold or transferred.
- Tax paid under Section 2.1 when an illiquid asset is sold shall be credited against income tax owed on the same gain.
- Income tax owed at death under Section 2.7.3 shall be deductible in computing the estate tax under Section 2.10.

A family with more than $50 million in wealth can be subject to the wealth tax, the tax on gains at death, and the estate tax. Each reaches a different base, and this section ensures they never reach the same dollar.

2.8 Combined Federal Wage Rate Ceiling [Statute]

The combined federal marginal tax rate on wages and on self-employment income shall not exceed 60 percent. The combined rate shall count:

- the top income-tax rate (Section 2.6);
- both the employee and employer shares of Social Security and Medicare payroll taxes, including the additional 0.9 percent Medicare tax, because economists generally find that workers bear the employer share through lower pay;
- every Universal Health Insurance contribution that applies to wages, whether a payroll, employer, or income-based contribution;
- the Paid Leave Trust Fund contribution (Section 3.3), which applies only to wages up to its wage base.

Under the rates in this chapter and in Chapter 26, the income-tax and payroll-tax components come to 55.8 percent at the top: 39.6 percent income tax, 12.4 percent Social Security once the cap is eliminated, and 3.8 percent Medicare. The remaining room under the ceiling is 4.2 percentage points.

How the ceiling works. The Universal Health Insurance contribution on wages above the top-bracket threshold shall be set no higher than the room remaining under the ceiling, 4.2 points under current rates. If implementing legislation for Section 26.2.1 applies less than the full employer share to wages above the taxable maximum, the room grows by the same amount, but the ceiling stays at 60 percent. No other tax in this platform may be raised on wages if doing so would breach the ceiling.

Protecting the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund. Any revenue the ceiling keeps the Trust Fund from collecting shall be made up only from the Trust Fund's own sources in Section 27.3: the broad-based contribution rates and the savings from consolidated health financing. If those are not enough, Universal Health Insurance shall phase in more slowly under Section 27.9. The General Fund, the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax, and carbon revenue shall never cover the gap.

What this edition can and cannot show. The ceiling limits only the marginal rate on wages above roughly $640,000 a year. It leaves untouched the contribution rates that apply to nearly all of the wage base, which are where nearly all Trust Fund revenue comes from. That is why the ceiling's effect on the Trust Fund should be small. But Universal Health Insurance contribution rates have not yet been set or scored (Section 5.1.2), and this edition contains no dollar estimates (Section 27.12). This edition therefore does not claim that the Trust Fund balances with the ceiling in place. It commits instead to the rule above: any shortfall is closed inside the Trust Fund or by slower phase-in, never by borrowing from another stream. Independent scoring of the contribution schedule shall report the ceiling's revenue effect separately.

State income taxes are not counted in the federal ceiling. In the highest-tax states the combined federal and state rate on top wages can exceed 70 percent. The ceiling caps the federal share; it cannot cap state choices.

2.9 Strengthened Corporate Minimum Tax [Statute]

The corporate alternative minimum tax on the financial-statement income of corporations averaging more than $1 billion a year shall rise from 15 percent to 21 percent, matching the regular corporate rate. The regular corporate income-tax rate shall remain 21 percent.

- **Protected incentives:** the research credit and credits for domestic advanced manufacturing and clean-energy production shall continue to be allowed in full against the minimum tax, so the minimum tax does not undo the platform's support for research and domestic production (Chapters 11 and 18).
- **Disclosure:** each covered corporation shall publicly report the difference between the profits it reports to shareholders and the profits it reports to the IRS, and the main reasons for that difference.

The purpose is simple: a large, profitable company should pay at least the regular corporate rate on the profits it reports to its own shareholders.

2.10 Estate and Gift Tax Reform [Statute – High Resistance]

The estate, gift, and generation-skipping transfer tax exemption shall be $5 million per person, indexed for inflation from enactment, with any unused exemption passing to a surviving spouse as under current law. The top rate shall remain 40 percent.

The main avoidance tools shall be closed:

- **Short-term grantor trusts:** grantor retained annuity trusts shall have a minimum term of ten years and a minimum taxable gift at creation.
- **Valuation discounts:** discounts for lack of control or marketability shall not apply to passive assets such as cash and marketable securities held through a family partnership or company.
- **Dynasty trusts:** the generation-skipping exemption shall shelter a trust for no more than 50 years.

Existing relief for family farms and businesses, including special-use valuation and payment over time, shall continue. Income tax paid at death under Section 2.7.3 shall be deductible (Section 2.7.4).

The Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax already reaches fortunes above $50 million each year. The estate tax's job in this platform is the range between $5 million and $50 million, where closing avoidance tools matters more than raising the rate.

2.11 Proposed Rates, Scoring, and Revenue Use [Statute]

The rates and thresholds in Sections 2.6 to 2.10 are proposed rates, published now so the public can see what the platform asks and so the combined-rate disclosure in Section 27.11 can be calculated. They shall be scored by the Joint Committee on Taxation and the Congressional Budget Office before enactment.

- **Revenue use:** all revenue from Sections 2.6 to 2.10 shall go to the General Fund for the recurring programs listed in Section 27.4, and to nothing else (Section 27.3).

- **If scoring falls short:** if scored revenue is lower than the programs it supports require, those programs shall phase in more slowly under Sections 27.6 and 27.9. The rates in this chapter shall not rise automatically, and the ceiling in Section 2.8 shall continue to apply.
- **Review:** the Congressional Budget Office shall report every five years on revenue collected under each section compared with its score.

2.12 Combined Top Marginal Rates [Disclosure under Section 27.11]

Federal tax component	Wages	Active pass-through income	Long-term capital gains and dividends
Income tax (Sections 2.6, 2.7.1)	39.6%	39.6%	39.6%
Social Security (Chapter 26, cap eliminated, both shares)	12.4%	12.4%	—
Medicare (both shares, including the additional 0.9%)	3.8%	3.8%	—
Net investment income tax	—	—	3.8%
Subtotal	**55.8%**	**55.8%**	**43.4%**
Paid leave contribution (Section 3.3; wages up to its wage base only)	0% at the top	0% at the top	—
Universal Health Insurance contribution	up to 4.2% (Section 2.8)	up to 4.2% (Section 2.8)	not yet set
Combined federal top rate	**≤ 60%**	**≤ 60%**	**43.4% plus any UHI contribution**

Notes: Active pass-through income is covered by Section 26.3. Rates are shown before deductions such as the qualified business income deduction. The Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax is an annual tax on wealth above $50 million, not a marginal rate on income, so it is reported separately: for a covered taxpayer, gains on traded assets are taxed each year under Section 2.1 and credited under Section 2.7.4.

2.13 Honest Limits

- **Revenue is not yet scored.** Treasury's last published estimates for similar proposals, which used different thresholds, were about $246 billion over ten years for a 39.6 percent top rate and about $289 billion for taxing gains at ordinary rates and at death

[1]. Those figures predate the 2025 law and are not this platform's score. Capital-gains revenue is especially uncertain, because people can time their sales.

- **The constitutional question is open.** In *Moore v. United States* (2024) the Supreme Court upheld the tax before it but declined to decide whether the Sixteenth Amendment requires income to be realized before it can be taxed [2]. Several justices signaled that it does. Section 2.7.3 is the safest design available, because a transfer at death or by gift is a clear event that the law can treat as a sale, but it is not risk-free. The annual tax on traded assets in Section 2.1 carries more risk.
- **The combined rates are high.** A 60 percent federal ceiling on wages is well above today's top federal rate of 40.8 percent, and state taxes come on top. Higher rates give high earners more reason to relabel wages as capital income or corporate income, which is why Sections 2.7 and 26.3 tax those forms on the same terms. Behavioral responses will reduce revenue below a simple calculation.
- **Large estates face three taxes.** Section 2.7.4 prevents double taxation of the same dollar, but a very large estate will still pay more than under any recent law, and opponents will call it a triple death tax. The platform's answer is that each tax reaches income or wealth that has otherwise escaped tax.
- **The corporate minimum tax is complex.** The current 15 percent tax has required repeated interim guidance from the IRS. Raising its rate raises the stakes of getting the rules right.

Sources

[1] U.S. Department of the Treasury, *General Explanations of the Administration's Fiscal Year 2025 Revenue Proposals* (March 2024). https://home.treasury.gov/system/files/131/General-Explanations-FY2025.pdf

[2] Congressional Research Service, "Supreme Court Declines to Decide Whether Sixteenth Amendment Requires 'Realization' to Tax Income," LSB11185 (June 27, 2024). https://www.everycrsreport.com/reports/LSB11185.html

[3] Penn Wharton Budget Model, "The Revenue-Maximizing Capital Gains Tax Rate: With and Without Stepped-up Basis at Death" (December 2019). https://budgetmodel.wharton.upenn.edu/issues/2019/12/4/the-revenue-maximizing-capital-gains-tax-rate-with-and-without-stepped-up-basis-at-death

Chapter 3: Work, Wages & Family

Funding role: the living wage, labor rights, and licensing reforms change rules and cost little. Paid leave is paid by the Paid Leave Trust Fund from its own payroll contribution, never the General Fund (Section 3.3). Childcare and eldercare cost caps are paid from the General Fund in tier 2. Universal Adjustment Assistance training and triggered apprenticeships are paid from the General Fund within one capped amount in tier 1, and wage insurance from the unemployment trust funds (Sections 3.6.7 to 3.6.9). Implementation order is governed by Section 27.9.

3.1 Living Wage Framework [Statute]

The federal minimum wage shall be set as a fixed percentage of the federal poverty line and adjusted for regional cost of living using federal regional price data. To avoid sharp differences across metropolitan boundaries, the regional adjustment shall phase in gradually across a buffer zone (a linear taper over a defined distance) rather than changing at the boundary line.

3.2 Protecting the Right to Unionize [Statute]

Workers shall have strong protections against retaliation and unfair labor practices, including faster union election timelines, limits on mandatory anti-union meetings, and meaningful penalties for illegal retaliation. Bargaining shall remain decentralized and voluntary at the firm level.

3.3 Paid Leave Framework [Statute]

All workers shall have access to paid family, parental, caregiving, and personal medical leave regardless of employer size, for up to 12 weeks per year. Wage replacement shall be paid from a Paid Leave Trust Fund, a social-insurance pool financed by a dedicated payroll contribution shared equally by employers and employees, so that no single employer bears the full cost of a worker's leave. The contribution shall apply to wages up to the Social Security taxable maximum in effect before Section 26.2.1, indexed to wage growth, and shall be set by independent scoring at the rate needed to keep the Trust Fund solvent. The rate may adjust each year within a band fixed in statute, on certification by the Trust Fund's actuaries, to maintain solvency; any change outside the band requires legislation. It counts toward the combined-rate ceiling in Section 2.8. Because it does not apply to wages in the top bracket, it does not reduce the room left under that ceiling for the Universal Health Insurance contribution. The Trust Fund shall never draw on the General Fund. Job-protection requirements may be phased in for the smallest employers, but wage replacement shall be available to all workers.

3.4 Care Economy Infrastructure [Statute – High Resistance]

Childcare from birth to school entry shall have costs capped on a sliding scale relative to household income, with the cap phasing in smoothly rather than ending at an income cliff.

Public funds shall support provider pay, workforce training, and facility capacity so that affordable care is actually available, particularly for infants and in rural areas.

Eldercare costs shall likewise be capped on a sliding scale, and long-term care shall be addressed through the public insurance system under Section 5.1, with support for family caregivers.

Honest limit: Capping what families pay raises demand for care faster than the supply of care workers can grow. Without enough providers, caps can lengthen waiting lists rather than lower costs. Funding for provider pay and training is meant to close that gap, but the care workforce is low-paid and slow to expand. The childcare and eldercare caps are paid from the General Fund in tier 2 and wait behind earlier tiers (Section 27.9), and the long-term care benefit they rely on remains an open question (Section 5.1.7).

3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform [Statute]

Occupational licensing shall exist only where justified by public safety.

3.5.1 Interstate License Recognition

Workers licensed in one state should generally be able to practice in another without repeating equivalent qualification requirements.

3.5.2 Apprenticeship Expansion

Earn-while-you-learn career pathways shall be expanded through federal partnerships. Apprenticeships in AI-exposed occupations expand automatically under the trigger in Section 3.6.8, within the funding cap in Section 3.6.9.

3.5.3 Military Credential Recognition

Military certifications and experience shall receive expedited civilian recognition.

3.6 Technology and AI at Work [Statute – High Resistance]

Funding role: most of this section creates rights and duties and costs little. Wage insurance is paid from unemployment trust funds. Training grants under Universal Adjustment Assistance, and any apprenticeship expansion triggered under Section 3.6.8, share one capped General Fund amount in tier 1, step 4 (Section 27.9) (decision 0025).

Automated tools now help decide who is hired, how work is scheduled and measured, and who is disciplined or let go. Used well, they can make work safer and more productive. Used carelessly, they can make consequential decisions no person has reviewed, monitor workers in ways no supervisor could, and quietly remove the entry-level jobs where careers begin. The evidence so far shows no economy-wide displacement. But employment of workers ages 22 to 25 in the most AI-exposed occupations is about 19 percent below where it would be had it kept pace with less-exposed peers, and the declines are concentrated where AI replaces tasks rather than assisting workers [1]. This section gives workers notice, explanation, a human decision-maker, limits on surveillance, a voice in workplace change, and support when jobs disappear. It does not tax or slow the technology itself.

3.6.1 Scope

This section applies to any automated decision system an employer uses to make, or substantially influence, decisions about:

- hiring;
- pay;
- scheduling;
- assignment;
- promotion;
- productivity standards;
- discipline;
- firing;
- the deactivation of workers on digital platforms.

An automated decision system is any machine-learning, statistical, or AI-based process that scores, ranks, classifies, recommends, or decides. Ordinary tools such as spam filters,

spreadsheets, and databases are excluded. Workers on digital platforms are covered whether they are classified as employees or as independent contractors.

3.6.2 A Human Decision-Maker

- **Consequential decisions:** no worker shall be fired, disciplined, or deactivated on the basis of an automated decision system's output alone. A person with authority to change the outcome shall review the relevant information independently before the decision takes effect.
- **Applicants:** a job applicant rejected with the substantial help of an automated decision system may request an explanation and a review by a person.

These requirements carry out the human-review right in Section 13.5.2.

3.6.3 Notice, Explanation, and Data Access

- **Before use:** employers shall tell workers and applicants, before the system is used, which decisions involve an automated decision system and what kinds of data it uses.
- **After a decision:** a worker or applicant affected by a consequential decision may obtain a plain-language explanation of the main factors behind it.
- **Data access:** workers may see the data about them that such systems use, and have errors corrected.

3.6.4 Bias Audits and Shared Responsibility

- **Vendor audits:** developers of automated decision systems sold for hiring or promotion shall obtain an independent bias audit each year, testing for disparate impact on the protected traits in Section 13.3.1. They shall publish a summary and give the full audit to their customers.
- **Employers:** an employer may rely on its vendor's current audit, instead of commissioning its own.
- **Shared responsibility:** a vendor whose system makes or substantially influences an employment decision on an employer's behalf shall share responsibility with the employer for unlawful discrimination resulting from the system's design.

Placing the audit duty on the relatively few developers, not on every employer, keeps compliance costs low. This is the approach that avoids the burdens that led Colorado to repeal its broader law [2].

3.6.5 Workplace Surveillance

Prohibited practices. Employers shall not:

- use tools that infer workers' emotions, mental states, or personality from their faces, voices, or bodies;
- collect neural data, or biometric data beyond what is needed to secure facilities and systems;
- monitor workers while they are off duty, or on their personal devices, except to secure employer data on a device the worker has chosen to use for work;
- use any monitoring in bathrooms, lactation rooms, or break areas;

- monitor or use automated systems to predict or interfere with union activity or other protected concerted activity.

Accessibility exception. The ban on neural and biometric data does not apply to assistive or accessibility technology that a worker with a disability has voluntarily requested as an accommodation (Sections 13.5.2 and 13.5.4). Data collected through that technology may be used only to provide the accommodation. It shall not be used for evaluation, discipline, or any other employment decision, and it shall be deleted when no longer needed for the accommodation.

Notice for all other monitoring. All other electronic monitoring requires advance notice of what is monitored, how, and why.

Productivity quotas. Productivity quotas set or enforced by automated systems shall be disclosed to the workers subject to them. No worker shall be penalized for time spent on breaks required by law, on safety compliance, or on bathroom use.

3.6.6 Workers' Voice in Technological Change

- **Notice:** an employer with 50 or more employees shall give affected workers 90 days' notice before introducing technology that will substantially change their job duties, eliminate their positions, or change how their performance is measured.
- **Bargaining:** where workers are represented by a union, the introduction of such technology and its effects shall be a mandatory subject of bargaining.

This is consistent with the decentralized, firm-level bargaining in Section 3.2, and it is written into statute so that it does not depend on the views of a National Labor Relations Board whose members can now be removed at will.

3.6.7 Universal Adjustment Assistance

Trade Adjustment Assistance, which helped workers who lost jobs to imports, expired in June 2022 [3]. It shall be replaced by Universal Adjustment Assistance for any worker displaced by trade, technological change, or industrial restructuring. Workers need not prove the specific cause of the job loss.

- **Wage insurance:** a reemployed worker whose new job pays less than the old one shall receive half the difference for up to two years, up to a statutory annual limit. Wage insurance shall be paid from unemployment trust funds through a small addition to unemployment contributions, administered with the unemployment insurance system in Section 4.4.
- **Training:** eligible workers may receive training grants for programs with a record of placing graduates in jobs, including apprenticeships under Section 3.5.2. Training grants are paid from the General Fund under Section 3.6.9.
- **Layoff notice:** the Worker Adjustment and Retraining Notification Act shall require 90 days' notice of mass layoffs and plant closings, up from 60, including layoffs resulting from automation.

Universal Adjustment Assistance is separate from the carbon Transition Fund (Section 20.2.2), and neither shall be counted toward the other.

3.6.8 Protecting the Entry-Level Career Ladder

The Bureau of Labor Statistics shall publish quarterly indicators of employment, hiring, and wages by occupation's exposure to AI and by age, with an annual report to Congress.

If employment of workers ages 22 to 25 in the most-exposed occupations falls more than a threshold set in statute below that of comparable less-exposed workers for four consecutive quarters, apprenticeship funding under Section 3.5.2 shall expand automatically for those occupations. The expansion shall continue until the gap narrows below the threshold.

3.6.9 Funding Guardrails

- **Shared cap:** training grants under Section 3.6.7 and any apprenticeship expansion triggered under Section 3.6.8 shall share a single annual General Fund amount, capped in statute.
- **Phase-in order:** the capped amount is placed in tier 1, step 4 of the General Fund priority order, after the Child Tax Credit (Section 27.9). It shall take effect only when its independently scored cost is covered by enacted federal tax fairness revenue (Sections 27.6 and 27.10).
- **When the trigger fires:** a triggered apprenticeship expansion shall be paid within the cap. If the cap is insufficient, the expansion shall be phased in over several years rather than raising the cap automatically. Any increase in the cap requires new legislation with its own scored revenue (Section 27.6).
- **Other costs:** wage insurance is paid only from unemployment trust funds. Enforcement by the Department of Labor and measurement by the Bureau of Labor Statistics are core government functions within capped and scored base appropriations (as in Section 13.8).

3.6.10 No Tax on Automation

The platform does not tax automation itself. A tax on technology that replaces workers would be hard to define, would encourage moving work and investment abroad, and would work against the platform's commitments to research and domestic production (Chapter 18). The gains from new technology are shared instead through the federal tax fairness measures in Chapter 2 and the protections in this section.

3.6.11 Enforcement and State Laws

- **Who enforces:** workers and applicants may sue to enforce this section and recover reasonable attorney fees, and state attorneys general may enforce it (Section 13.7.1). The Department of Labor may also enforce it, with civil penalties scaled to employer size.
- **No forced arbitration:** pre-dispute arbitration agreements and class-action waivers shall not apply to claims under this section (Section 13.7.3).
- **State laws:** this section sets a minimum standard, consistent with Section 19.6. It does not preempt state or local laws that give workers greater protection.
- **Small employers:** employers with fewer than 15 employees shall have an additional year to comply with Sections 3.6.2 through 3.6.5.

3.6.12 Honest Limits

- **The evidence is early.** The strongest evidence so far comes from payroll data covering mid-2026. It shows effects concentrated on young workers in exposed occupations, not economy-wide displacement [1]. The trigger in Section 3.6.8 is designed so that money is spent only if those effects continue, but the right threshold is a judgment call.
- **Human review can become a rubber stamp.** A reviewer who approves every automated recommendation satisfies the letter of Section 3.6.2 but not its purpose. The duty to review the relevant information independently, together with the right to an explanation, is meant to prevent that, but it will be hard to enforce.
- **Bias audits have limits.** Audit methods are still developing, and an audit can miss problems that appear only in a particular workplace. Shared vendor responsibility will be strongly opposed by software companies.
- **Federal and state conflict is likely.** Executive Order 14365 directs the Justice Department to challenge state AI laws [4]. This section protects stronger state laws by statute, but until it is enacted, state protections remain under legal and financial pressure. Businesses will argue that varying state rules raise costs, and the answer is that the federal minimum already covers the core protections.
- **Surveillance limits will be contested.** Logistics and warehouse employers will oppose the quota rules, and the line between permitted security monitoring and prohibited surveillance will need to be drawn in regulations and cases. The accessibility exception must be policed so that it is not used as a back door for collecting biometric data.
- **Wage insurance raises unemployment contributions.** Paying for wage insurance through the unemployment system keeps it off the General Fund, but it is a small payroll cost borne in practice by workers and employers.
- **The training budget is capped.** Universal Adjustment Assistance is broader than the program it replaces, but its training grants come from a capped amount behind three other tier-1 priorities. In a fast-moving period of displacement, the cap could bind before need is met, and raising it would require new revenue.
- **Not taxing automation will be criticized.** Some will argue that automation gains should be taxed directly. The platform's position is that Chapter 2 captures those gains where they show up, in high incomes and capital gains, without penalizing investment.

Sources

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[3] Congressional Budget Office, Baseline Projections: Unemployment Compensation and Trade Adjustment Assistance Program (February 2026). https://www.cbo.gov/system/files/2026-02/51316-2026-02-unemployment.pdf

[4] Executive Order 14365, “Ensuring a National Policy Framework for Artificial Intelligence,” 90 Fed. Reg. 58499 (Dec. 16, 2025).

Chapter 4: Income Security & the Safety Net

Funding role: the income-security measures in this chapter are paid from the General Fund (the federal tax fairness measures in Chapter 2) and come first in the General Fund phase-in order (Section 27.9). Unemployment insurance is paid from its own trust funds. Extended benefits in recessions are paid from the Sovereign Wealth Reserve. The Medicaid transition is paid through the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund (decision 0023).

A market economy creates wealth, but it does not guarantee that a child grows up fed, that a worker who loses a job can pay rent while finding the next one, or that a person with a disability can live with dignity. A social insurance system should do those things in a way that always rewards work: no family should be worse off for earning another dollar, and no one who cannot reasonably work should lose food or health care over paperwork.

4.1 Welfare Cliff Reform [Statute]

Benefit phase-outs shall occur gradually so additional work always increases net household income.

4.1.1 Combined Phase-Out Limit

For any household receiving a federally funded means-tested benefit, the combined share of an additional dollar of earnings lost to benefit reductions and federal taxes shall not exceed 50 percent. The calculation shall count federal income and payroll taxes (both the employee and employer shares, as in Section 2.8), the phase-out of the Child Tax Credit and Earned Income Tax Credit, and reductions in federally funded nutrition, housing, childcare (Section 3.4), and disability benefits.

Programs shall phase out in a coordinated order set by the Department of the Treasury and the Department of Health and Human Services, so that two benefits never shrink steeply over the same income range. No working household should lose a larger share of its next dollar than the 60 percent ceiling that applies to top earners (Section 2.8).

4.1.2 One Application

Federal benefit programs shall share one application. With the applicant’s consent, an applicant found eligible for one program shall be screened automatically for the others using records the government already holds.

4.1.3 Annual Cliff Report

The Congressional Budget Office shall publish each year the combined phase-out rates faced by representative low- and moderate-income households, and identify any income range where the limit in Section 4.1.1 is exceeded.

4.2 Child Tax Credit [Statute]

The children who most need the Child Tax Credit receive the least of it today. The credit is $2,200 per child, but only up to $1,700 is refundable, and a family must earn more than $2,500 before receiving any refund, so the poorest children receive a partial credit or none [1].

4.2.1 Full Refundability

The Child Tax Credit of $2,200 per child shall be fully refundable, with no minimum earnings requirement, and indexed for inflation. The existing phase-out above $200,000 of income for single filers and $400,000 for married couples filing jointly shall remain.

4.2.2 Young Child Supplement

Each child under age 6 shall qualify for an additional $1,000, for a total of $3,200, indexed for inflation. The early years are when deprivation does the most lasting harm, and when childcare costs make work hardest to sustain.

4.2.3 Monthly Payment Option

Families may choose to receive the credit in monthly payments. A family whose income changes during the year shall not owe back any advance payment received in good faith, except above a high-income threshold.

4.2.4 Eligibility

Each qualifying child shall have a Social Security number. The claiming parent shall either have a Social Security number or be lawfully present in the United States. This restores the credit to children who are U.S. citizens whose parents are lawfully present but do not have a Social Security number, while keeping the credit unavailable to parents without lawful status.

4.3 Earned Income Tax Credit for Workers Without Children [Statute]

The Earned Income Tax Credit for workers without qualifying children shall be expanded on the model of the 2021 expansion:

- **Age:** eligibility shall begin at age 19, except for full-time students under 24, with no upper age limit.
- **Amount:** the maximum credit shall be about three times its current value.
- **Income range:** the income range over which the credit phases in and out shall be widened so that low-wage, full-time workers qualify.

Final parameters shall be set after independent scoring. This credit is the platform's direct reward for work. It pairs with the Child Tax Credit's full refundability so that the safety net as a whole continues to reward earning more.

4.4 Unemployment Insurance Modernization [Statute]

Unemployment insurance reaches too few workers and replaces too little of their pay. Only about 28 percent of unemployed people received benefits in 2025, and those who qualified received about 40 percent of their average weekly earnings. State recipiency ranged from 52 percent in Minnesota to 8 percent in Florida [2].

4.4.1 Federal Minimum Standards

As a condition of the existing federal unemployment tax credit, each state program shall meet minimum standards:

- **Replacement:** benefits shall replace at least 50 percent of a claimant's prior weekly wages, up to a maximum weekly benefit of at least two-thirds of the state's average weekly wage.
- **Duration:** benefits shall be available for at least 26 weeks.
- **Eligibility:** eligibility shall count the most recent quarter of earnings. Part-time workers seeking part-time work shall be covered, and so shall workers who leave a job for a compelling family reason such as domestic violence or a caregiving emergency.
- **Independent workers:** workers whose income comes mainly from independent contracting or platform work shall be covered through a federal program funded by contributions from the businesses that contract with them.

4.4.2 Self-Financing

The federal unemployment tax wage base, $7,000 since 1983, shall be raised and indexed to wage growth. States shall maintain trust-fund reserves adequate to pay at least one year of benefits at recession levels. Regular unemployment benefits shall be paid entirely from unemployment trust funds and never from the General Fund. The same trust funds pay wage insurance under Universal Adjustment Assistance (Section 3.6.7), financed by a small addition to unemployment contributions.

4.4.3 Modern Administration

The Department of Labor shall set national standards for claims systems, identity verification, and fraud prevention, and shall fund their modernization. Eligible claimants shall be paid within 21 days of filing.

4.4.4 Automatic Extended Benefits in Recessions

When the recession trigger in Section 1.2 is met, additional weeks of benefits shall begin automatically in every state, without new legislation. Extended benefits shall be fully federally funded from draws on the Sovereign Wealth Reserve (Section 27.5). They shall end on the schedule set for recovery confirmation in Section 1.2.

4.5 Nutrition Assistance (SNAP) [Statute]

The 2025 reconciliation law made the largest cuts in SNAP's history [3][9][10]. It:

- extended the time limit to adults up to age 64;
- narrowed the exemption for parents to those with a child under 14;
- removed the 2023 exemptions for veterans, people experiencing homelessness, and young adults who aged out of foster care;
- made states pay a share of benefit costs based on their error rates, and 75 percent of administrative costs;
- limited future updates to the Thrifty Food Plan;
- cut utility and internet costs from the shelter deduction;

- ended SNAP nutrition education;
- removed eligibility for refugees, asylees, and other lawfully present immigrants.

This section reverses each of those changes. It keeps a work expectation for adults who can reasonably work, and it ensures that people who cannot work, and people who are working, do not lose food assistance over paperwork.

4.5.1 Work Expectations and Exemptions

Able-bodied adults ages 18 to 54 without exempting circumstances shall be expected to work or participate in education, training, or community service for at least 80 hours a month. Adults ages 55 to 64 shall be exempt. The following shall also be exempt:

- **Disability:** a person with a physical or mental disability that limits their ability to work, shown by any of the following, without waiting for a federal disability determination:
  - a statement from a licensed clinician;
  - a disability rating from the Department of Veterans Affairs;
  - disability status in Medicaid, Universal Health Insurance, or a state program;
  - a pending application for SSI or Social Security Disability Insurance.
- **Caregivers:**
  - a parent or other household member responsible for a child under age 18;
  - a person who is the primary caregiver for an elderly relative or for a household member with a disability.
- **People experiencing homelessness,** as defined in the McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act (the definition used in Section 8.3). The exemption continues for three months after the person is housed.
- **Veterans.**
- **Young adults aged 24 or younger who were in foster care** on their 18th birthday, or at a later age if the state offers extended foster care.
- **Exemptions added in 2025 are kept,** including those for American Indians, Urban Indians, and California Indians, and those available to Alaska and Hawaii.

4.5.2 Automatic Verification and a Grace Period

States shall verify work activity and exemptions automatically, first through records the government already holds:

- payroll and new-hire data;
- Medicaid and Universal Health Insurance records;
- Department of Veterans Affairs records;
- state disability and caregiving program records;
- homeless-services records, or a written statement from a shelter, outreach worker, or homeless-services provider.

Where those records do not settle the question, a household may self-attest to work activity or an exemption for 90 days. The grace period shall be renewed once if the missing information is

held by a government agency. A person experiencing homelessness who has no record or provider statement may establish that exemption by their own statement, with no time limit. No household shall lose benefits without written notice, a chance to respond, and review by a caseworker.

4.5.3 Areas Without Enough Jobs

The Secretary of Agriculture shall waive work expectations in areas where unemployment is substantially above the national rate or where there are not enough jobs for the people expected to work.

4.5.4 Federal Funding and State Performance

The federal government shall again pay the full cost of SNAP benefits. The state cost share tied to payment error rates shall be replaced by performance bonuses for states that reduce errors, including errors that underpay eligible households. The federal government shall again pay 50 percent of state administrative costs, so that states can afford the automatic verification in Section 4.5.2.

4.5.5 Benefit Adequacy

- **Thrifty Food Plan:** the Secretary of Agriculture shall re-evaluate the plan at least every five years based on the cost of a healthy diet, without the 2025 requirement that re-evaluations not raise its cost.
- **Utility costs:** a household that receives energy assistance shall again qualify for the heating and cooling standard utility allowance, whether or not it includes an elderly or disabled member.
- **Internet costs:** internet service shall again count as a shelter and utility cost.
- **Nutrition education:** SNAP nutrition education grants (SNAP-Ed) shall be restored.

4.5.6 Eligibility of Lawfully Present Immigrants

The categories of lawfully present immigrants eligible for SNAP before 2025 shall be restored, including refugees, people granted asylum, and survivors of trafficking. Waiting periods and sponsor-income rules in place before 2025 continue to apply.

4.6 Supplemental Security Income and Disability Insurance [Statute]

Supplemental Security Income (SSI) is the income floor for older adults and people with disabilities who have little income. For 2026, the maximum federal benefit is $994 a month for an individual, and the asset limit is $2,000 for an individual and $3,000 for a couple [4]. The asset limit has not changed since 1989, so it penalizes recipients who save for an emergency.

4.6.1 Asset Limits

The SSI asset limit shall be $10,000 for an individual and $20,000 for a married couple, indexed for inflation. Setting the couple's limit at twice the individual limit ends the penalty on recipients who marry.

4.6.2 Income Rules

The general and earned income exclusions, unchanged since SSI began in 1974, shall be restored to their original value in today's dollars and indexed for inflation, so that recipients keep more of what they earn.

4.6.3 Disability Insurance Earnings Offset

In Social Security Disability Insurance, the cliff at which earning slightly too much ends benefits shall be replaced by a gradual offset: benefits shall fall by $1 for every $2 earned above the threshold. This offset shall be financed by the Social Security trust funds and scored together with the reforms in Chapter 26.

4.6.4 Future Benefit Adequacy

The maximum SSI benefit is well below the federal poverty line. The platform's long-term goal is to raise it to the poverty line. That increase is not counted in this edition's financing and shall be proposed only after independent scoring.

4.7 Medicaid and the Transition to Universal Health Insurance [Statute – High Resistance]

4.7.1 Coverage Without Work Requirements

The Medicaid work requirement enacted in 2025, which takes effect on January 1, 2027 [5], shall be repealed. Medicaid eligibility shall be verified automatically from existing records, and enrollees shall keep continuous coverage until Universal Health Insurance covers them. A work requirement is incompatible with a universal coverage guarantee.

4.7.2 Moving Enrollees into Universal Health Insurance

Medicaid enrollees shall move into Universal Health Insurance as its phases reach them (Section 5.1.6). No one shall lose coverage during the transition.

4.7.3 Universal Health Insurance Partnership Compact

Each state may choose to join a Universal Health Insurance Partnership Compact.

- **A joining state** shall pay the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund a fixed annual contribution equal to 90 percent of its average Medicaid spending in the three years before the compact, indexed for inflation and population. In return, Universal Health Insurance shall take over all of the state's Medicaid costs, including long-term care, and the federal government shall bear all future cost growth.
- **A state that does not join** shall keep its existing Medicaid funding and federal matching rate. Its residents shall still receive Universal Health Insurance. The state shall remain responsible for Medicaid services Universal Health Insurance does not yet provide, including long-term care.
- **Use of contributions:** compact contributions shall go only to the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund (Section 27.3).
- **Clear terms:** the terms shall be fixed in statute, so each state knows exactly what it is agreeing to before it joins.

4.7.4 Why the Compact Is Voluntary

In *NFIB v. Sebelius* (2012) the Supreme Court held that Congress could not coerce states into the Affordable Care Act's Medicaid expansion by threatening all of their existing Medicaid funding [6]. It let states decline the expansion without losing existing funds. Congress may offer new funds with new conditions, but it may not threaten existing funds to force states into a new program.

The closest precedent is the 2003 Medicare drug law, under which states make monthly payments to Medicare for drug costs it took over from Medicaid [7]. States challenged those payments in 2006, but the Supreme Court declined to hear the case, and it has never ruled on the merits. That law also predates *NFIB*, and it collects the payments by offsetting each state's Medicaid grant, a tool that will not exist once Universal Health Insurance replaces Medicaid.

The compact therefore requires no state to pay, threatens no state's existing funds, and does not order states to spend their own money on a federal program. It offers a better deal (a 10 percent saving, relief from long-term care costs, and protection from future cost growth) in exchange for a predictable contribution.

4.8 Funding and Phase-In [Statute]

Measure	Paid by	Phase-in
SSI asset and income rules (4.6.1, 4.6.2)	General Fund	General Fund tier 1, step 1
SNAP changes (4.5)	General Fund	General Fund tier 1, step 1
Earned Income Tax Credit for workers without children (4.3)	General Fund	General Fund tier 1, step 2
Child Tax Credit (4.2)	General Fund	General Fund tier 1, step 3
Disability Insurance earnings offset (4.6.3)	Social Security trust funds	With the Chapter 26 reforms
Regular unemployment insurance (4.4.1 to 4.4.3)	Unemployment trust funds	On enactment
Wage insurance (3.6.7)	Unemployment trust funds	On enactment
Extended unemployment benefits (4.4.4)	Sovereign Wealth Reserve	Automatic in recessions
Medicaid transition and compact (4.7)	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund	With the phases of Section 5.1.6

Each General Fund measure shall take effect only when its independently scored cost is covered by enacted federal tax fairness revenue under Sections 27.6 and 27.9. If revenue falls short, later steps shall wait. Earlier steps shall not be cut to make room.

4.9 Honest Limits

- **No measure in this chapter has been scored.** The Child Tax Credit is the largest cost and comes last for that reason.

- **The work-incentive debate is real.** Simulations of the 2021 credit made permanent ranged from roughly 300,000 to 1.5 million parents leaving work, and studies of the actual 2021 payments found small or no effects [8]. This chapter pairs full refundability with an expanded work credit and keeps the credit's phase-out, but critics will continue to raise the higher estimates.
- **Eligibility rules will draw criticism from both sides.** Requiring lawful presence for the claiming parent will be attacked by immigrant advocates as too strict and by opponents as too loose, and verifying lawful presence adds administrative work.
- **Self-attestation creates some risk of error.** The 90-day grace period could let some ineligible households receive benefits for a few months. Checking existing records first, and rewarding states for accuracy, are meant to keep that small.
- **The 50 percent phase-out limit costs money.** Slower phase-outs extend benefits to more households further up the income scale. The limit may need adjustment once it is scored.
- **Unemployment insurance reform raises employers' costs.** A higher federal wage base is a tax increase on employers, felt most by small businesses, and states will resist federal standards.
- **States may decline the compact.** If many do, the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund collects less than planned. Any gap shall be closed only within the Trust Fund or by slower phase-in, never from another revenue stream (Section 2.8). The long-term care relief that makes the compact attractive depends on a long-term care benefit that Section 5.1.7 lists as an open question.
- **The legal design is untested.** The compact is built to avoid the coercion problem identified in *NFIB*, but no court has ruled on an arrangement like it.
- **Restoring the 2025 SNAP cuts is the most expensive part of tier 1, step 1.** The 2025 law's SNAP provisions have been described as cutting nearly $200 billion over ten years [10], so reversing them costs a similar amount until independent scoring says otherwise. If revenue falls short, they share the first step's place in line and are not ranked ahead of one another.
- **The broader exemptions will be attacked as weakening the work expectation.** Most of them restore rules that a bipartisan Congress adopted in 2023 or that were in place for decades. Restoring benefits for refugees and asylees will draw opposition in the immigration debate.
- **Current law is still being implemented.** The 2025 SNAP and Medicaid changes are taking effect in stages through 2030, so the starting point for these reforms will keep shifting.

Sources

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PART II: HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

A prosperous society is built not only through economic growth, but through investments in people. Healthcare, education, housing, communications infrastructure, and consumer rights form the foundation upon which individuals and families build successful lives.

The purpose of public investment is not to eliminate private markets. The purpose is to ensure every citizen has access to the essential systems required to participate fully in society and the economy.

Chapter 5: Universal Health Insurance

Funding role: Universal Health Insurance is paid from its own Trust Fund (Section 5.1.2), never the General Fund, and is phased in on its own schedule (Sections 5.1.6 and 27.9). The Dynamic Global Innovation Fund is paid from a capped share of drug-negotiation savings (Section 27.3).

5.1 Universal Health Insurance [Statute – High Resistance]

Aligned with the white paper Universal Health Insurance: A Hybrid Framework for Universal Coverage *(decision 0001).*

The United States shall establish a national public health insurance system providing universal coverage for all citizens, lawful permanent residents, and other lawfully present residents. Emergency care, treatment of communicable disease, and public-health services shall be available to all persons regardless of immigration status, consistent with the Human Dignity Standard.

The system shall have two layers:

- **Universal Health Insurance**, a publicly financed plan that provides comprehensive coverage to every eligible resident.
- **Supplemental insurance**, which individuals may purchase privately for services beyond the standard package, upgraded accommodations, or other added benefits. Supplemental insurance shall add to the public plan and shall not replace it.

Healthcare providers shall remain privately operated and independently managed. The public system shall function primarily as the financing mechanism while preserving provider independence and patient choice.

5.1.1 Covered Services

Coverage shall include all medically necessary:

- Primary care
- Specialist care
- Preventive care
- Emergency care
- Hospitalization
- Surgical care
- Mental-health treatment
- Substance-use treatment
- Prescription drugs
- Dental care
- Vision care
- Hearing care
- Home health services
- Long-term care
- Fertility treatment
- Rehabilitation services
- Reproductive and maternal health, including contraception, pregnancy and postpartum care, and abortion care (on the terms in Section 6.2; conscience protections, patient-information duties, and emergency care are governed by Section 6.3)

Covered services shall carry no copays or deductibles at the point of care. Because removing cost-sharing also removes a common check on how much care is used, spending growth shall be managed through provider-payment design and workforce planning (Sections 5.1.3 and 5.1.5).

The long-term care benefit shall be designed after an independent actuarial study of its sustainability over multiple decades, completed before universal enrollment begins.

5.1.2 Financing

Universal Health Insurance shall be financed through a dedicated Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund, funded by payroll contributions, employer contributions, and income-based taxes (Section 27.3). These contributions are intended to replace the premiums, deductibles, and out-of-pocket costs that households and employers pay today. Savings from consolidated health financing shall lower contribution rates and shall not be counted elsewhere. Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue shall not be used for health financing (Section 27.5). Contribution rates shall be set after independent scoring. The contribution on wages above the top income-tax bracket threshold shall fit within the 60 percent combined federal wage ceiling in Section 2.8, and any revenue the ceiling forgoes shall be made up within the Trust Fund or by slower phase-in, never from another revenue stream.

5.1.3 Provider Payments and Rate Recommendations

Provider payments shall follow a national fee schedule set in statute, using Medicare's relative-value (RVU) weighting system as its foundation and adjusted for geographic cost differences. Medicare-based rates are lower than what private insurers pay hospitals today, so the move toward them shall be gradual and monitored for effects on access, closures, and the workforce.

A health-payment advisory commission in the legislative branch, modeled on the Medicare Payment Advisory Commission (MedPAC), shall recommend annual updates based on medical evidence, operational sustainability, geographic cost differences, and long-term system efficiency. A recommendation shall take effect unless the Secretary of Health and Human Services publishes a written, reasoned decision rejecting it.

5.1.4 Specialty & Geographic Appeals Mechanism

A formal, data-driven appeals process shall allow specialties and regions to challenge reimbursement rates so that rates can be corrected before shortages or closures occur (for example, in oncology or rural family medicine). Appeals shall be decided by administrative law judges.

5.1.5 Workforce Development

Shortages of physicians, nurses, dentists, optometrists, and behavioral-health providers shall be addressed through:

- Residency and training-capacity expansion
- Rural and underserved-area service incentives
- Loan repayment for health professionals with loans taken out before tuition-free public higher education (Section 7.3) takes effect
- Workforce development programs

Cross-reference: See Section 3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform and Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

5.1.6 Phased Implementation

Implementation shall proceed in phases, with costs evaluated, outcomes measured, and problems corrected at each stage:

1. Expanded Medicare buy-in options. Because Medicare's Hospital Insurance trust fund is projected to run out of reserves in 2033, this phase shall carry its own financing.
2. Coverage expansion for children.
3. Gradual expansion into broader age groups.
4. Universal enrollment.

Implementing legislation shall coordinate Medicare, Medicaid, veterans' health programs, and employer-sponsored coverage so that no one loses coverage during the transition. Medicaid enrollees move into Universal Health Insurance as these phases reach them, and states may join the Universal Health Insurance Partnership Compact (Section 4.7.3).

5.1.7 Honest Limit

This framework has not yet been independently scored. Open questions include the exact financing mix and rates, how fast payments should move toward Medicare-based levels, what supplemental coverage may duplicate, how to manage use of care without cost-sharing, the design of a sustainable long-term care benefit (which must include the guaranteed home- and community-based services in Section 13.5.3 and the long-term care relief offered under Section 4.7.3), and how quickly the workforce can grow. These are set out for expert review in the white paper.

5.2 Drug Pricing & Dynamic Global Innovation Fund [Statute – High Resistance]

Healthcare affordability should not come at the expense of medical innovation.

5.2.1 National Price Negotiation

The Universal Health Insurance system shall negotiate prescription-drug prices to obtain value for patients and taxpayers while maintaining incentives for research and development. This extends the negotiation Medicare already conducts under current law.

5.2.2 Dynamic Global Innovation Fund

A Dynamic Global Innovation Fund shall support breakthrough therapies and pioneering medical discoveries. Funding shall come from a fixed statutory share of the savings from national drug-price negotiation, subject to an annual cap (Section 27.3). Only the remaining savings shall be counted in health-cost estimates. Awards shall be made through peer review that includes outside scientific reviewers, using criteria set in statute.

5.2.3 Variable Innovation Exclusivity

New therapies receiving approval shall qualify for a period of regulatory market exclusivity ranging from 7 to 15 years, based upon:

- Research and development expenditures

- Therapeutic benefit
- Public-health impact
- Scientific advancement
- Innovation significance

This exclusivity is a regulatory period layered on top of existing patent rights. It does not shorten patent terms, consistent with U.S. obligations under the WTO TRIPS Agreement.

5.2.4 Public Patent Option and Generic Competition

When the awarded exclusivity period ends, generic competition shall be encouraged and public manufacturing rights shall become available, so that treatment costs decline.

5.2.5 Manufacturing and Strategic Procurement

Pharmaceutical production shall remain primarily within the private sector. The government may contract private manufacturers to produce medicines needed to address shortages or access problems.

Honest limit: Lower negotiated prices reduce the expected returns that pay for some drug research, and estimates of how much innovation would be lost vary widely. Variable exclusivity asks regulators to judge a therapy's benefit and research spending, which invites lobbying and litigation over each rating. Public manufacturing rights after exclusivity ends are untested at scale. The Innovation Fund is capped and depends on negotiation savings, so it shrinks if savings fall short.

5.3 Rural Healthcare Stability Framework [Statute]

Healthcare access shall not depend upon population density. Rural stability programs shall be funded through the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund (Section 27.4).

5.3.1 Geographic Reimbursement Adjustments

Reimbursement rates shall account for rural operating realities using a Geographic Volatility Index.

5.3.2 Rural Stabilization Grants and Operational Support

Healthcare providers facing patient-volume shortages may receive automatic stabilization payments and targeted grants designed to prevent closure of essential facilities.

Priority shall be given to:

- Rural hospitals
- Critical access hospitals
- Community clinics
- Mental-health providers

5.3.3 Minimum Service Guarantees

Basic healthcare services shall remain available regardless of geographic location.

Chapter 6: Reproductive Health Protection

6.1 Reproductive Health Protection [Statute – High Resistance]

Federal law shall protect access to reproductive healthcare, including contraception, abortion care, and pregnancy and postpartum care, nationwide.

Reproductive and maternal health services, including contraception, abortion care, and pregnancy and postpartum care, shall be covered under the public insurance system in Section 5.1.

6.1.1 Abortion Care Is Health Care

Abortion care is essential reproductive health care. It shall be legal nationwide so that patients can get the medical care they need.

The decision whether to have an abortion belongs to the patient and the patient's doctor. Government shall not substitute its judgment for theirs, and medical decisions shall be guided by clinical standards of care, not by political interference.

6.1.2 Federal Protection of Access

Federal law shall guarantee the legal right to abortion nationwide and shall preempt state laws that ban abortion or impose restrictions that are not medically necessary. Access to medication abortion, including by telehealth, shall be protected from restrictions that are not supported by medical evidence.

6.1.3 Protection for Patients and Providers

Doctors and other clinicians shall be free to provide abortion care according to their medical judgment without threat of criminal or civil penalty. Patients shall not be criminalized for their pregnancy outcomes. Patients, providers, and those who assist them shall be protected from penalties imposed by another state for care that is lawful where it is provided.

6.1.4 Coverage and Access

Abortion care shall be covered under the public insurance system in Section 5.1 on the terms set in Section 6.2, and federal policy shall support access in areas with few providers.

6.2 Public Coverage of Abortion Care [Statute – High Resistance]

Funding role: abortion care, and the temporary federal share of Medicaid abortion claims, are paid only through the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund. Nothing in this chapter draws on the General Fund (decision 0026).

Since 1976, the Hyde Amendment and related riders on annual spending bills have barred federal coverage of most abortions. Under Universal Health Insurance, nearly everyone's coverage is federal. Applied to Universal Health Insurance, a Hyde-style exclusion would therefore remove abortion coverage for almost the whole country, not only for people on Medicaid. This section sets coverage rules in the Universal Health Insurance statute itself. They are clear enough that no patient loses coverage for not knowing the deadline.

6.2.1 Coverage Through 24 Weeks

Universal Health Insurance shall cover abortion care through 24 weeks and 6 days of pregnancy, measured from the first day of the last menstrual period, for any reason. Every patient shall be told this date in writing at the patient's first pregnancy-related visit.

Why 24 weeks and 6 days. The date was chosen for six reasons:

1. **A fixed date, not "viability."** Medicine recognizes no single clinical definition of viability by gestational age. The American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists describes a "periviable" range of roughly 20 to 25 weeks, and the prospects of an infant born early depend on the individual pregnancy and the care available [1]. A coverage rule tied to viability would require a judgment about each pregnancy, and a patient could not know the deadline in advance. A fixed date can be known by every patient and clinician from the first visit.
2. **Time after the anatomy scan.** Most serious fetal conditions are found at the routine anatomy ultrasound, performed between 18 and 22 weeks [3]. Scans before 20 weeks are often incomplete, and a substantial share of anomalies are identified only at a follow-up scan [4]. Families who learn of a serious diagnosis at 20 to 22 weeks need time for a repeat scan, specialist confirmation, and counseling. An earlier date, such as 15 or 20 weeks, would end coverage for exactly those families.
3. **Not later.** By 25 to 26 weeks, most infants born early survive with intensive neonatal care. The platform concludes that public coverage for any reason should not extend beyond 24 weeks and 6 days, because fetal survival rates rise substantially with intensive neonatal care after that point.
4. **A familiar reference point.** Twenty-four weeks has been the most common reference point for viability in U.S. law since *Roe v. Wade* (1973), so the platform does not invent a new line.
5. **Allowance for dating error.** The additional six days allow for the margin of error in dating a pregnancy during the second trimester, so that no patient loses coverage over a disagreement about dating.
6. **Few patients are affected.** In 2022, 92.8 percent of abortions took place at or before 13 weeks of pregnancy and 1.1 percent at 21 weeks or later [5]. The date matters mainly for patients with a late diagnosis, a serious complication, or a pregnancy caused by abuse, and Sections 6.2.2 to 6.2.4 are written for them.

6.2.2 Coverage After 24 Weeks

After 24 weeks and 6 days, Universal Health Insurance shall cover abortion care when, in the reasonable medical judgment of the treating clinician:

- it is necessary to protect the patient's life or physical or mental health;
- the fetus has a fatal fetal condition, meaning a condition that, in reasonable medical judgment, is incompatible with life outside the uterus or would cause death shortly after birth; or
- the pregnancy resulted from rape or incest (Section 6.2.3).

No second opinion, committee approval, or government review shall be required before covered care is provided.

6.2.3 Survivors of Rape and Incest

Abortion care for a pregnancy that resulted from rape or incest shall be covered at any point in pregnancy at which the care is lawful.

- **No reporting requirement:** coverage shall not depend on a police report or a court finding.
- **Clinician certification:** the treating clinician shall certify in the medical record that the patient disclosed that the pregnancy resulted from rape or incest. That certification is sufficient for coverage.
- **Other documentation accepted:** documentation from any one of the following is also sufficient, but none is required:
  - a report to law enforcement or child protective services;
  - a rape crisis center or victim advocate;
  - a school counselor;
  - a forensic medical examination;
  - a protective order.
- **Confidentiality:** the statement shall be confidential health information and shall not be shared with law enforcement without the patient's consent, except as required to protect a child from ongoing abuse.
- **Annual reporting:** Universal Health Insurance shall publish each year the number of claims paid under this section, by stage of pregnancy, in aggregated form that protects patient privacy. Any figure small enough to identify a patient shall be withheld.

Survivors, especially minors and victims of incest, often recognize or disclose a pregnancy late. Coverage should not end because of delays the abuse itself caused.

This approach builds on long-standing federal Medicaid policy under the Hyde Amendment. That policy has never required a police report. It allows states only reasonable documentation requirements that may not deny or impede coverage, and it accepts a physician's certification when the patient was unable to report [6].

6.2.4 No One Runs Out of Time

- **Request-date rule:** coverage shall be judged by the date the patient first asks a covered provider for abortion care. If that date is within the period in Section 6.2.1, the care shall be covered even if scheduling, travel, transfer, or provider availability delays it past 24 weeks and 6 days.
- **Early diagnosis:** pregnancy tests, ultrasounds to date the pregnancy, and options counseling shall be covered with no cost to the patient and no waiting period.

- **No coverage delays:** Universal Health Insurance shall not impose waiting periods, prior authorization, or mandatory counseling as conditions of coverage for abortion care.
- **Notice of the date:** every patient who receives a positive pregnancy test from a covered provider shall be given, in writing, the date the pregnancy reaches 24 weeks and 6 days, and the Universal Health Insurance directory of providers (Section 6.3.2).

6.2.5 Ending the Hyde Riders

The Hyde Amendment shall not apply to Universal Health Insurance or to Medicaid. Federal health coverage provided through federal employees' health plans, the District of Columbia, TRICARE, the Indian Health Service, federal prisons, and the Peace Corps shall cover abortion care on the same terms as Section 6.2.1 through Section 6.2.4.

The Helms Amendment, which governs foreign assistance, is addressed in Section 23.5.4.

6.2.6 Protection from Annual Spending Riders

Universal Health Insurance benefits shall be paid from the Trust Fund under a permanent appropriation, not through annual spending bills. Removing or restricting a covered benefit shall require amending the Universal Health Insurance statute itself.

6.2.7 Coverage Before Universal Health Insurance Reaches Everyone

Until Universal Health Insurance covers every resident, Medicaid shall cover abortion care on the terms of Sections 6.2.1 through 6.2.4. The federal government shall pay 100 percent of the cost of those claims, charged to the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund as part of the Medicaid transition (Section 27.4). States therefore shall not pay for care they object to, and no existing state funding is put at risk.

Medicaid patients shall have a statutory right to choose any qualified provider willing to treat them, and may sue to enforce that right.

6.2.8 What This Section Does and Does Not Do

Section 6.2 sets what Universal Health Insurance pays for. It does not change the legal protections in Section 6.1. The coverage standard in Section 6.2 does not create any criminal, civil, or regulatory prohibition on abortion after 24 weeks and 6 days. It governs eligibility for Universal Health Insurance benefits only. Care after 24 weeks and 6 days that is not covered under Section 6.2.2 remains lawful under Section 6.1 and may be paid for privately or by a state.

6.3 Conscience, Patient Information, and Emergency Care [Statute – High Resistance]

The platform protects clinicians who cannot in conscience take part in abortion or sterilization. It also protects patients' right to know their options and to receive emergency care, and it protects clinicians who provide that care. Each protection comes with duties, so that one person's conscience never leaves another person without care or information.

6.3.1 Individual Clinicians

No individual clinician shall be required to personally perform or assist in an abortion or sterilization if doing so would violate the clinician's religious beliefs or moral convictions. A clinician who objects shall:

- tell the employer in writing, in advance, so the employer can arrange coverage;
- when a patient asks about or needs such care, tell the patient promptly that the care is available elsewhere, and make sure the patient receives the information required by Section 6.3.2 from the employer or from a non-objecting colleague;
- never give a patient false or misleading information about the patient's diagnosis, options, or where care is available, and never delay or obstruct the patient's care.

The objecting clinician does not have to make the referral personally. That duty belongs to the institution.

6.3.2 Patients' Right to Know Their Options

Every hospital, clinic, and medical practice that takes part in Universal Health Insurance (a "facility") shall meet the following requirements, whether or not it offers abortion care.

- **Who carries the duty:** these duties fall on the facility, not on any individual clinician who objects. A facility shall arrange for the duties to be carried out by staff who do not object, or through the Universal Health Insurance Patient Navigation Service. No clinician who objects under Section 6.3.1 shall be required personally to recommend, refer for, or arrange abortion care.
- **The navigation service:** Universal Health Insurance shall operate a Patient Navigation Service, available by telephone and online, that:
  - maintains the provider directory;
  - gives patients referrals;
  - schedules appointments;
  - arranges transfers.
- **Options information:** when a patient is pregnant, the facility shall ensure the patient is told accurately about all options, including continuing the pregnancy, adoption, and abortion care, in the same visit in which the pregnancy is confirmed or discussed.
- **Universal Health Insurance referral sheet:** when a patient asks for care the facility does not offer, or when it is medically indicated, the facility shall ensure the patient receives a referral sheet produced by Universal Health Insurance before the patient leaves, or within one business day for telehealth. The sheet shall be clearly labeled as a publication of Universal Health Insurance. It shall list:
  - the names, addresses, and telephone numbers of at least two of the nearest providers that offer the care, from the Universal Health Insurance directory;
  - the date the patient's pregnancy reaches 24 weeks and 6 days (Section 6.2.4);
  - how to reach the Patient Navigation Service, which will arrange a transfer or appointment.

- **Transfer through Universal Health Insurance:** if the patient asks, the facility shall notify the Patient Navigation Service, or a receiving provider in Universal Health Insurance that offers the care, within one business day. The receiving provider or Universal Health Insurance, not the declining provider, shall arrange and carry out the transfer.
  - The declining provider need not arrange or perform the transfer itself.
  - It shall send the patient's records to the receiving provider within one business day of the request.
  - It shall not delay, discourage, or obstruct the transfer in any way.
  - Universal Health Insurance shall schedule the care promptly. The request-date rule in Section 6.2.4 protects the patient's coverage if scheduling takes longer.
- **No misleading information:** a provider shall not tell a patient that care is unavailable when it is available elsewhere, shall not give false or misleading information about the patient's diagnosis or options, and shall not answer a request for options with a refusal alone.
- **Providers may speak for themselves:** a provider may tell the patient its own views and why it does not offer the care, so long as it also gives the patient the referral sheet.
- **Public directory:** Universal Health Insurance shall maintain a public directory of providers offering abortion care, searchable by location and pregnancy stage, from which the referral sheet is generated.

These duties are part of the facility's care for its own patient: informed consent and continuity of care when the patient asks for a service the provider does not offer. They are not a general notice to the public, and the information comes from Universal Health Insurance in its own name. That design is meant to respect the First Amendment limits on compelled speech set out in *National Institute of Family and Life Advocates v. Becerra* (2018) [7].

6.3.3 Institutions

- **Religious nonprofits:** a bona fide religious nonprofit hospital or clinic (Section 13.4.2) may decline to offer elective abortion and sterilization if it:
  - publishes the policy prominently, including on its website and at admission;
  - tells patients in writing before scheduled obstetric or gynecologic care;
  - meets every duty in Section 6.3.2;
  - provides all emergency care required by Section 6.3.4.
- **For-profit and public institutions:** for-profit and public hospitals and clinics may not adopt an institutional policy of refusing this care. Individual clinicians who work there keep their protection under Section 6.3.1 (Section 13.4.3).
- **Access where there is no alternative:** where a religious nonprofit is the only hospital within a travel time set in statute, Universal Health Insurance shall ensure access to the care it declines to provide. It may do so through contracts with other providers, telehealth, or arranged and paid transport.
- **Narrowed conscience statutes:** the Weldon and Coats-Snowe Amendments shall be narrowed to match this section.

6.3.4 Emergency Care Is Required

Every hospital that takes part in Universal Health Insurance or Medicare, and every clinician treating a patient there, shall provide stabilizing treatment for an emergency medical condition under the Emergency Medical Treatment and Labor Act. Stabilizing treatment for a pregnant patient explicitly includes abortion care and the treatment of miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, previable rupture of membranes, preeclampsia, infection, hemorrhage, and similar conditions. It is required whenever, in the treating clinician's reasonable medical judgment, the absence of treatment could reasonably be expected to:

- place the patient's life or health in serious jeopardy;
- cause serious impairment of bodily functions; or
- cause serious dysfunction of any bodily organ.

The patient need not be at imminent risk of death.

This obligation, whose constitutional basis is set out in Section 6.3.8, shall not depend on agency guidance. The Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services rescinded its 2022 guidance on this point in June 2025 [2], so the obligation is written into statute.

- **No institutional exemption:** no hospital may refuse required emergency care on grounds of conscience or religion.
- **Individual clinicians:** an individual clinician may step aside only if another qualified clinician is immediately available to provide the care without delay. Otherwise the clinician shall provide it.

6.3.5 Clinicians Who Provide Emergency Care Are Protected

- **No lawyer before care:** stabilizing treatment shall not be delayed for legal review, ethics committee approval, a second opinion, or consultation with counsel. No hospital policy may require any of these before emergency care.
- **Reasonable medical judgment governs:** a clinician who provides stabilizing treatment under Section 6.3.4 in good-faith, reasonable medical judgment has acted lawfully. The standard is that of a reasonable clinician at the time of treatment, not hindsight.
- **Federal protection from state penalties:** no state or local government shall impose criminal, civil, licensing, or professional penalties on a clinician or hospital for stabilizing treatment provided under Section 6.3.4. Conflicting state laws are preempted.
  - A clinician charged or sued under state law for such care may move the case to federal court and raise this section as a defense.
  - A clinician threatened with such penalties may sue in federal court to stop them.
  - A clinician who prevails recovers reasonable attorney fees.
- **No retaliation:** no hospital, employer, or licensing body may retaliate against a clinician for providing, or for insisting on providing, required emergency care.

6.3.6 Scope of Conscience Protections

Conscience protections under this section apply to taking part in procedures, not to choosing which patients to treat. They cover:

- abortion;
- sterilization;
- medical aid in dying;
- research activities currently protected under federal law.

They do not permit refusing care to a patient because of a protected trait (Section 13.3.5).

A pharmacist may step aside from dispensing contraception or medication for abortion, but the pharmacy shall fill the prescription without delay. It may use another pharmacist on duty or transfer the prescription within the same day at the patient's choice.

6.3.7 Protection in Both Directions and Enforcement

- **Both directions:** no clinician shall face discrimination in employment, training, licensing, or staff privileges because the clinician declines to take part in care covered by Section 6.3.6, or because the clinician provides lawful reproductive care, including in another state (Section 6.1.3).
- **Who may sue:** clinicians, and patients denied the information or care this section requires, may sue to enforce it and recover reasonable attorney fees. State attorneys general and the Department of Health and Human Services may also enforce it.
- **Conditions of participation:** repeated violations of Sections 6.3.2 through 6.3.5 shall also be grounds for civil penalties and, in serious cases, exclusion from Universal Health Insurance.

6.3.8 Constitutional Basis

Congress enacts Sections 6.3.2 through 6.3.5, including the preemption of conflicting state law, under three of its constitutional powers.

- **Federally funded health care:** the power to set conditions on the federal funds that pay for health care. Every covered hospital, clinic, and practice takes part voluntarily in Universal Health Insurance or Medicare, and these duties and protections are conditions of that participation, stated clearly in the statute.
- **Interstate commerce:** the power to regulate interstate commerce. Hospitals, emergency care, health insurance, medical supplies and drugs, and the movement of patients and clinicians across state lines are interstate commerce, and the delay or denial of emergency care burdens that commerce.
- **Supremacy of federal law:** under the Supremacy Clause, these provisions displace any state law that conflicts with them, including state laws that would penalize care this chapter requires or protects.

Each of the first two powers is a separate and sufficient basis. If a court holds that one does not support a provision, the provision shall remain in effect under the other. If any provision is held invalid, the remaining provisions shall continue in effect.

6.4 Honest Limits

- **The 24-week date will be attacked from both directions.** Some will say a fixed date is arbitrary, since viability varies, or that it is too early. Others will say Universal Health Insurance should not pay for abortion at all, or that 24 weeks is too late. The platform chose a fixed date so that patients can know it in advance, and Section 6.2.1 sets out why that date was chosen. The strongest criticism is that survival in the 24th week is already substantial with intensive care. The request-date rule and early-diagnosis coverage protect patients who learn of a pregnancy late.

- **Taxpayer objections are sincere and lasting.** Many Americans believe abortion ends a human life and object to public funding. Supporters of the Hyde Amendment credit it with reducing abortions. This chapter does not resolve that disagreement. It sets coverage rules in statute, limits coverage after 24 weeks to defined circumstances, and fully protects clinicians who will not take part.

- **Statutes can be repealed.** Section 6.2.6 makes a new restriction harder to add through a spending bill, but a future Congress can amend the Universal Health Insurance statute. Passing this chapter at all would likely require changing the Senate filibuster, a question for Appendix B.

- **The rape and incest provision does not require a police report.** Critics will say it is open to abuse. The provision answers that in three ways:

  - it requires a clinician's certification;
  - it accepts a range of other documentation;
  - it publishes annual counts of claims.

  The number of cases involved is small: only about 1 percent of abortions occur at 21 weeks or later, and pregnancies from rape or incest after 24 weeks are a small share of those [5]. Requiring a police report would deter survivors, especially minors and victims of family members, from seeking care.

- **Emergency-care preemption will be challenged.** The obligation rests on Congress's power to set conditions for hospitals that take federal health funding, and on the Supremacy Clause. In 2024 the Supreme Court dismissed the Idaho case without deciding whether the Emergency Medical Treatment and Labor Act overrides state abortion bans. The question remains open. Writing the duty and the protections for clinicians into statute is the strongest available answer, but courts will decide it.

- **Duties on religious institutions will be litigated.** Religious hospitals may argue that the options-information and referral duties burden their religious exercise, or compel speech in violation of the First Amendment. *NIFLA v. Becerra* struck down a state requirement that licensed pregnancy centers post a state-written notice about abortion services [7]. Section 6.3.2 is designed around that decision in three ways:

  - it ties the duties to the provider's care for its own patient;
  - it uses a referral sheet issued by Universal Health Insurance in its own name;

– it lets providers state their own views.

Courts have not decided whether that is enough.

More broadly, the chapter assigns each operational duty to the institution best positioned to perform and be held accountable for it, rather than requiring objecting clinicians to personally carry out tasks to which they object.

- **Access where only a religious hospital exists depends on resources.** Guaranteeing access in communities whose only hospital is a religious nonprofit requires contracts, telehealth, and transport that Universal Health Insurance must fund and maintain.

Sources

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[6] Health Care Financing Administration, State Medicaid Director Letter (Feb. 12, 1998), on 42 C.F.R. §§ 441.203 and 441.206. https://www.hhs.gov/guidance/sites/default/files/hhs-guidance-documents/CMS/smd021298.pdf

[7] *National Institute of Family and Life Advocates v. Becerra*, 585 U.S. 755 (2018). https://www.supremecourt.gov/opinions/17pdf/16-1140_5368.pdf

Chapter 7: Education

Funding role: universal preschool is paid from the General Fund in tier 2. Tuition-free public higher education, existing student-loan reform, and K-12 equity funding are paid from the General Fund in tier 3, in that order. Implementation order is governed by Section 27.9.

7.1 Universal Preschool [Statute]

Every four-year-old child shall have access to publicly funded preschool education.

The goals are:

- Early childhood development
- School readiness
- Workforce participation
- Reduced long-term educational inequality

7.2 K-12 Educational Opportunity Framework [Statute]

Every child shall have access to a high-quality public education regardless of zip code, local property values, or family income. Educational opportunity shall be a national commitment rather than a function of local wealth.

7.2.1 Equal Opportunity Funding

Federal and state education funding shall reduce disparities created by local property-tax dependence. Public schools serving low-income communities shall receive sufficient resources to provide educational opportunities substantially equivalent to those available in wealthier districts. Federal funding shall be weighted toward high-poverty districts and tied to state equity-of-funding requirements.

7.2.2 National Education Standards

States shall retain control over curriculum while ensuring students receive adequate instruction in mathematics, science, literacy, civics, history, technology, and critical thinking. Minimum standards in these subjects shall be developed cooperatively with the states and tied to federal funding.

7.3 Tuition-Free Public Higher Education [Statute]

Tuition shall be fully covered at:

- Public universities
- Community colleges
- Trade schools
- Technical institutions

Federal assistance currently tied to tuition costs should instead be redirected toward:

- Housing
- Food
- Books
- Transportation
- Living expenses

for qualifying students.

7.3.1 Existing Student Loan Reform [Statute]
Existing federal student loans shall be refinanced at a near-zero administrative interest rate of 0.01%.

Borrowers making qualifying payments for twenty years (240 monthly payments) shall be eligible for full debt discharge.

Additional penalties, fees, and capitalization of unpaid interest shall be prohibited.

Cost estimates for this provision shall be published under Chapter 27 before implementation.

7.4 STEM Education Pipeline [Statute]
Federal programs shall expand pathways into:

- Science
- Engineering
- Mathematics
- Healthcare
- Technology

Special attention shall be directed toward:

- Rural communities
- Underserved populations
- First-generation students

Chapter 8: Housing & Homelessness

8.1 Affordable Housing Initiative [Statute / Statute – High Resistance]
Housing affordability represents one of the largest economic challenges facing American families.

Federal policy shall focus on increasing housing supply rather than restricting development.

8.1.1 Upzoning Incentives
Federal transportation and housing funding may be conditioned upon local housing production reforms.

8.1.2 Permitting Modernization
Investments shall support:

- Digital permitting systems

- Staffing expansion
- Pre-approved building designs
- Clear, predictable review timelines achieved through staffing and capacity, without weakening environmental or safety standards

These investments apply the national permitting rule in Section 21.9 to housing.

8.1.3 Institutional Ownership Limits

Federal policy shall restrict excessive concentration of single-family housing within large institutional investment portfolios. Limits shall apply to institutional investors whose holdings meet the Dominance Threshold in a local housing market, measured by their share of single-family homes, and shall target purchasing conduct rather than size alone.

8.1.4 Public Housing Developer

A publicly operated housing developer shall construct and maintain mixed-income housing developments in high-demand markets.

8.1.5 First-Time Homebuyer Assistance

Down payment assistance shall be available expressly to first-time homebuyers. It shall be income-limited and designed (for example, with shared-equity terms) so that it does not simply bid up prices, and it shall be paired with the supply measures above.

8.1.6 Homeowner Protections

Property-tax relief for seniors and low-income homeowners shall ensure that rising land values do not force long-time residents out. Owners shall have a by-right ability to add accessory units or split lots. Housing reforms shall be phased in so that no homeowner's equity is wiped out.

8.2 Anti-Gouging Rent Stabilization [Statute – High Resistance]

Rent stabilization in this platform is a guard against gouging, not a substitute for building. It limits sudden, large increases on people already living in a home, leaves new buildings free for fifteen years, and lets rent reset between tenants, so that the supply measures in Section 8.1 keep doing the main work. Where landlords are large enough to rely on federal tax benefits and federally backed financing, the federal government sets the floor directly. Elsewhere, it pays states and localities to set and enforce their own caps.

8.2.1 The Cap

For a covered unit (Section 8.2.2), the rent charged to a sitting tenant shall not rise in any 12-month period by more than the annual change in the regional Consumer Price Index plus 5 percentage points, and never by more than 10 percent. Rent may be raised no more than once in any 12-month period. Any fee or charge that a tenant must pay as a condition of living in the unit counts as rent.

8.2.2 Who Is Covered

The federal floor applies to every landlord whose portfolio, counting affiliates and entities under common control, includes 50 or more residential rental units. Splitting ownership among

related entities shall not avoid coverage. This unit-count test is separate from the Dominance Threshold used for single-family ownership limits in Section 8.1.3.

The following units are exempt:

- units first occupied within the previous 15 years, measured from the certificate of occupancy;
- units in an owner-occupied building of one to four units;
- units whose rent is already limited by a federal subsidy program, such as the Low-Income Housing Tax Credit or project-based rental assistance, where the subsidy program's own rule is stricter. Where it is less strict, the cap in Section 8.2.1 also applies.

8.2.3 How the Floor Is Applied Through Federal Benefits

The floor is enforced through federal benefits that landlords choose to accept, not through a direct federal order on rents. A covered landlord that raises rent on a unit above the cap:

- shall, for the building containing that unit, compute depreciation under the alternative depreciation system and lose bonus depreciation on its components, for the tax year of the violation and the following tax year;
- shall not defer gain on a sale or exchange of that building under like-kind exchange rules (26 U.S.C. § 1031) during the same period.

Every multifamily loan that Fannie Mae or Freddie Mac purchases or guarantees, or that the Federal Housing Administration insures, shall include compliance with the cap as a loan covenant for covered landlords. The covenant applies to loans made or refinanced after enactment.

This follows the design of a 2024 federal proposal that tied faster depreciation to a 5 percent limit on rent increases [7]. Because landlords choose whether to accept these benefits, and the cap compels no physical occupation of their property, the floor is designed to avoid a claim that it takes property without compensation [9].

Revenue that results from lost tax benefits shall go to the General Fund and shall not be assigned to any program (Section 27.8).

8.2.4 Protections Within the Cap

- **Vacancy reset.** When a tenant leaves voluntarily, or a tenancy ends for one of the just causes below other than a no-fault reason, the rent may be reset for the next tenant.
- **Just cause for eviction.** A covered landlord may end a tenancy or refuse to renew only for nonpayment of rent, a material breach of the lease, illegal activity or serious nuisance, the owner or an immediate family member moving in, withdrawal of the unit from the rental market, or substantial rehabilitation that requires the unit to be vacant.
- **No-fault moves.** When a tenancy ends for one of the last three reasons, the landlord shall pay relocation assistance equal to three months' rent. For the following two years, the rent for the unit may not exceed what the cap would have allowed for the departing tenant.

- **Fair return.** A landlord whose increases in operating costs (property taxes, insurance, and utilities) and amortized capital improvements cannot be met within the cap while earning a fair return may petition for a larger increase. Petitions shall be decided by administrative law judges within 90 days. If a petition is not decided in time, the landlord may charge the requested increase while it is pending, and must refund it with interest if the petition is denied.
- **Coordinated pricing.** Setting rents through a shared pricing service that pools nonpublic rent and occupancy data from competing landlords shall be treated as an unreasonable restraint of trade under the competition laws (Chapter 9).

8.2.5 Enforcement

- **Tenants:** a tenant charged more than the cap may sue to recover the overcharge, plus triple damages for willful violations and attorney fees. An eviction or nonrenewal brought in retaliation for asserting these rights is void.
- **States:** state attorneys general may enforce this section in federal or state court.
- **Reporting:** each covered landlord shall file an annual rent-roll information return with the Internal Revenue Service showing, for each unit, the rent charged and any increase. The Internal Revenue Service has a mandatory duty to match returns against tax filings and assess the loss of benefits under Section 8.2.3. Any person may sue to compel performance of that duty.
- **No waivers:** no agency may waive or suspend the cap, the coverage rules, or these enforcement duties.

8.2.6 State Stabilization Grants

Grants shall be available to states and localities that adopt caps no weaker than Section 8.2.1, apply them to smaller landlords not covered by the federal floor, and fund enforcement, including a rent registry and legal help for tenants. This section does not preempt stronger state or local protections.

8.3 Ending Homelessness [Statute – High Resistance]

On a single night in January 2025, 745,652 people were homeless in the United States, the first decline in nearly a decade. Chronic homelessness, however, reached its highest level on record, about 155,750 people [1]. Federal policy has since moved toward treatment-first conditions and civil commitment (Executive Order 14321), and HUD has tried twice to cap the share of Continuum of Care funds available for permanent housing. The first attempt was enjoined and vacated, and the second remains in litigation [2][3].

This section sets a different course. A home comes first because the evidence on housing stability is strong. Recovery and treatment are offered as real choices, not as conditions for getting a home. And the rules are written in statute so that they cannot be reversed by a funding notice.

8.3.1 Housing First as the Federal Standard

- **No preconditions.** Federally funded permanent supportive housing and rapid rehousing shall offer housing without requiring sobriety, participation in treatment,

employment, or income. Services shall be offered and voluntary. A tenancy may be ended only for the same lease violations that apply to any other tenant.

- **Supportive services.** Permanent supportive housing projects shall maintain access to multidisciplinary support teams, which may include mental-health clinicians, substance-use counselors, primary-care providers, peer-support specialists, case managers, employment specialists, and benefits navigators. Services shall be offered proactively, on site where feasible, and shall remain voluntary. Refusing services shall never be grounds for eviction, loss of housing, reduced tenant rights, or reduced benefits. Clinical services are paid by Universal Health Insurance (Sections 5.1.1 and 8.3.5).
- **Permanent housing floor.** At least 70 percent of Continuum of Care funds each year shall go to permanent housing, including permanent supportive housing and rapid rehousing.
- **Renewal.** Projects that meet published performance standards shall be renewed.
- **Predictable competitions.** HUD shall publish each year's funding notice by a deadline set in statute. If it does not, the prior year's terms renew automatically. Any change to scoring or eligibility criteria requires notice and comment and a published statement of reasons.
- **Coordination.** The United States Interagency Council on Homelessness shall be continued in statute, with a mandatory duty to publish a national plan and an annual progress report.

8.3.2 Recovery Housing as a Choice

Federal funds shall support recovery housing that requires abstinence, provided it meets national quality standards. A person may choose recovery housing, but it shall never be the only offer made. A resident who leaves recovery housing or relapses shall not lose housing assistance and shall be offered a transfer to housing under Section 8.3.1.

8.3.3 Housing Vouchers

- **Guarantee.** Every extremely low-income household that is experiencing homelessness or at imminent risk of homelessness, as defined in the McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act, shall be entitled to a Housing Choice Voucher once this guarantee takes effect under Section 27.9.
- **Universal stage.** The guarantee shall then extend, in stages, to every extremely low-income renter household paying more than half its income in rent. Each stage takes effect only when funded under Section 27.9, and none before every earlier tier is fully funded.
- **Source of income.** Landlords shall not refuse a tenant because the tenant pays rent with a voucher or other lawful assistance. This protection is enforced with the remedies in Section 13.7.

8.3.4 Encampments and Public Space

City of Grants Pass v. Johnson (2024) held that the Eighth Amendment does not bar cities from punishing people for camping in public even when no shelter is available [8]. Congress may still

set conditions on federal homelessness funds, so long as they are unambiguous, related to the purpose of the funds, and not coercive [9]. A state or locality that receives Continuum of Care, Emergency Solutions Grant, or voucher funds:

- may enforce rules against sleeping or sheltering in public only after making the person an **adequate offer**: a non-congregate shelter bed or housing placement available that day, accessible to the person's disabilities under the reasonable-modification duties of the Americans with Disabilities Act and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act (as strengthened by Section 13.5), and reasonably accommodating partners, pets, and possessions;
- shall not impose criminal penalties for sleeping, sitting, lying down, or sheltering from the weather in public, and shall not convert unpaid civil citations into warrants or jail;
- shall store belongings it removes for at least 90 days, and shall never destroy identification documents, medication, or medical equipment.

Safety exceptions. A locality may clear a site without an adequate offer when it blocks a building entrance or an accessible sidewalk route, lies within a set distance of a school or playground, or presents an imminent threat to health or safety. Even then, the ban on criminal penalties and the storage rules apply.

Enforcement. Affected individuals may sue for injunctive relief, damages, and attorney fees. State attorneys general may enforce. HUD has a mandatory duty to recover funds from a grantee found in violation.

8.3.5 Crisis Care and Civil Commitment

- **Crisis care.** The 988 crisis line, mobile crisis teams staffed by clinicians rather than police, and crisis stabilization centers shall be available nationwide. Clinical crisis services are covered mental-health and substance-use services under Universal Health Insurance (Section 5.1.1).
- **Commitment floor.** Any civil commitment carried out in, or paid for by, a federally funded program or facility, including services paid for by Universal Health Insurance, shall meet these minimum standards:
  - homelessness, by itself, is never grounds for commitment;
  - commitment requires that the person, because of mental illness, is a danger to themselves or others or is unable to provide for their basic needs, proven by clear and convincing evidence [10];
  - the person has a right to counsel and a prompt hearing within a deadline set in statute;
  - care is provided in the least restrictive appropriate setting, with periodic review;
  - no one is discharged to the street; discharge plans include a housing placement.
- **Outpatient treatment.** Court-ordered outpatient treatment may be funded only with the same protections.
- **Health privacy.** Behavioral health records and homelessness service records shall not be shared with law enforcement without a warrant or court order, except to prevent an imminent threat to life.

This section replaces the civil-commitment approach of Executive Order 14321.

8.3.6 Prevention

- **Emergency rental assistance.** A permanent program shall pay rent arrears and short-term rent for households below 80 percent of area median income facing eviction because of a financial hardship, with payment made directly to the landlord where the tenant agrees. The program has a base amount and rises automatically, within one capped amount, when the recession trigger in Section 1.2 is met.
- **Right to counsel.** Grants shall fund legal representation in eviction cases for tenants with incomes below 200 percent of the poverty line, phased in over five years and starting where eviction filings are highest.
- **Eviction records.** Eviction cases shall be sealed when filed, unsealed only if the court enters judgment for the landlord, and sealed again three years after judgment. Tenant screening companies shall not report sealed cases, enforced through the Fair Credit Reporting Act.

8.3.7 Durability

These rules follow the design standards in Appendix C. Floors, deadlines, and renewal rules are fixed in statute; changes to criteria require public reasons; individuals and state attorneys general can enforce the duties in court; and the Government Accountability Office reviews the programs under Section 14.2.1.

8.4 Funding and Phase-In [Statute]

Measure	Paid by	Phase-in
Rent stabilization floor (8.2.1 to 8.2.5)	Administration within base appropriations; any revenue from lost tax benefits goes to the General Fund and funds no program	On enactment; loan covenants apply to new and refinanced loans
State stabilization grants (8.2.6)	General Fund (tax fairness measures)	Fixed-budget program (Section 27.9): current-law level, expanding only after tier 1 is fully funded, within a statutory ceiling
Housing First standard, permanent housing floor, recovery housing (8.3.1, 8.3.2)	Existing Continuum of Care appropriations	On enactment
Voucher guarantee for people experiencing or at imminent risk of homelessness (8.3.3)	General Fund (tax fairness measures)	General Fund tier 2, in the order set by Section 27.9

Measure	Paid by	Phase-in
Emergency rental assistance and right to counsel (8.3.6)	General Fund (tax fairness measures); triggered increases within one capped amount	General Fund tier 2, in the order set by Section 27.9
Clinical crisis services (8.3.5)	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund	With the phases of Section 5.1.6
Universal housing vouchers (8.3.3)	General Fund (tax fairness measures)	General Fund tier 4 (Section 27.9)
Public housing developer operations and other housing programs (8.1)	General Fund (tax fairness measures)	Fixed-budget program (Section 27.9): current-law level, expanding only after tier 1 is fully funded, within a statutory ceiling
Public housing construction (8.1.4)	Capital Investment Account and productive borrowing (Sections 27.5 and 27.7)	As financing is enacted; debt service paid through the Capital Investment Account

8.5 Honest Limits

- **Federal influence over zoning is indirect.** Conditioning transportation and housing funds on local reforms (Section 8.1.1) works only where the funds matter more to a community than its zoning rules, and limits on institutional ownership (Section 8.1.3) could reduce rental supply in markets where investors were adding homes.
- **Rent caps reduce supply at the margin.** The strongest study of rent control, from San Francisco, found that covered landlords cut rental supply by 15 percent, raising rents citywide by about 5 percent [6]. This chapter's protections are the 15-year exemption for new buildings, vacancy reset, fair-return petitions, and the supply measures in Section 8.1. They reduce the risk; they do not remove it.
- **Landlords can give up the benefits instead.** A landlord with little depreciation left and no federally backed loan may simply accept the tax consequences and raise rents. State stabilization grants are meant to fill that gap, but some states will not take them.
- **Fair-return petitions take work.** They are needed for the cap to be fair and legally durable, but they will add caseload for administrative law judges.
- **Housing First has not by itself reduced chronic homelessness.** The evidence that it keeps people housed is strong, but its effects on health are mixed [4][5], and chronic homelessness rose to a record while it was federal policy. This chapter's view is that the shortage of affordable homes and vouchers is the binding constraint. That is an argument, not a proven result.
- **Some cities will refuse the money.** A city that values its camping ban more than its federal homelessness grants can decline them, and the encampment conditions will not reach it.

- **The commitment floor will be criticized.** Some families of people with serious mental illness, and some city officials, want broader authority to commit. This chapter accepts that cost to protect people who have committed no crime.
- **Vouchers without supply can raise rents.** Expanding vouchers in tight markets can push rents up unless more homes are built, which is why the universal stage comes last.
- **Nothing in this chapter has been scored,** and the legal fight over Continuum of Care funding is still under way, so the starting point will keep shifting.

Sources

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[8] *City of Grants Pass v. Johnson*, 603 U.S. 520 (2024).

[9] *Yee v. City of Escondido*, 503 U.S. 519 (1992); *Cedar Point Nursery v. Hassid*, 594 U.S. 139 (2021); *South Dakota v. Dole*, 483 U.S. 203 (1987).

[10] *Addington v. Texas*, 441 U.S. 418 (1979); *O'Connor v. Donaldson*, 422 U.S. 563 (1975).

PART III: COMPETITIVE MARKETS

Chapter 9: Competition & Consumer Rights

9.1 Guiding Principle

Markets function best when competition exists.

The objective of antitrust policy is not to punish successful companies.

The objective is to preserve:

- Competition
- Consumer choice
- Market entry
- Entrepreneurship

Economic power should be earned through innovation rather than protected through market dominance.

9.2 Competitive Markets & Anti-Monopoly Act [Statute – High Resistance]

Federal competition policy shall focus on anti-competitive conduct rather than company size alone.

9.2.1 Conduct-Based Principle & Dominance Threshold

Corporate scale alone shall not trigger government intervention.

Government action shall focus on:

- Market abuse
- Exclusionary practices
- Barriers to entry
- Anti-competitive behavior

The additional duties in Sections 9.2.2, 9.2.3, and 9.2.5 shall apply only to firms that meet the Dominance Threshold (see Definitions).

9.2.2 Anti-Self-Preferencing Rule

Digital platforms that meet the Dominance Threshold may not unfairly prioritize their own products or services above competitors utilizing the same platform.

Examples include:

- Search engines
- App stores

- Online marketplaces
- Advertising platforms

9.2.3 Interoperability Requirements

Platforms that meet the Dominance Threshold shall provide reasonable mechanisms allowing consumers to:

- Transfer data
- Switch services
- Communicate across systems

while protecting privacy and security.

9.2.4 Anti-Killer Acquisition Rule

Regulators may block acquisitions primarily intended to eliminate emerging competitors before meaningful competition develops.

9.2.5 Open Standards Requirement

Regulators may require interoperability standards when a firm that meets the Dominance Threshold creates excessive consumer lock-in.

9.2.6 Small Business Competition Office

A dedicated office shall monitor barriers facing:

- Small businesses
- Start-ups
- Independent contractors
- Entrepreneurs

and provide annual recommendations to Congress.

Honest limit: Conduct-based rules require proof of harm, which makes cases slow and expensive, and dominant firms can litigate for years. Interoperability mandates can create privacy and security risks and may lock in today's technical designs. Every application of the Dominance Threshold will be contested over how the market is defined. Enforcement depends on agency budgets and on courts that have narrowed antitrust doctrine over several decades.

9.3 Rights-Based Data Privacy [Statute]

Individuals shall possess enforceable legal rights over their personal data.

Citizens shall possess the right to:

- View personal data

- Correct personal data
- Delete personal data
- Transfer personal data

without unreasonable barriers.

Corporations may not treat consumer data as a commodity or as permanently owned corporate property.

9.4 Right to Repair [Statute]

Consumers shall have the right to repair products they legally own.

Manufacturers shall provide:

- Replacement parts
- Software tools
- Diagnostic systems
- Repair manuals

on fair and reasonable terms.

Artificial repair barriers designed solely to prevent independent repair shall be prohibited.

Chapter 10: Agriculture & Family Farms

Funding role: most of this chapter changes market rules. Current crop insurance continues under current law. The enhancements in Section 10.1.8 are a fixed-budget General Fund program that expands only after tier 1 is fully funded, within a statutory ceiling (Section 27.9).

10.1 Agricultural Market Fairness & Family Farm Protection [Statute – High Resistance]

Independent family farms remain essential to:

- Food security
- Rural prosperity
- Property ownership
- Community stability

Federal policy shall promote their long-term viability.

10.1.1 Protecting Family Farms

Priority federal support shall be provided through:

- Succession planning programs

- Beginning farmer programs
- Conservation incentives
- Agricultural lending initiatives

10.1.2 Agricultural Competition Framework

Enhanced antitrust enforcement shall focus on:

- Meat processing
- Seed production
- Fertilizer manufacturing
- Agricultural chemicals
- Grain purchasing networks

10.1.3 Fair Contract Standards

Large agricultural corporations may not engage in:

- Retaliatory contracting
- Coercive exclusivity agreements
- Unjustified discriminatory pricing

against independent producers.

10.1.4 Producer Cooperative Protections

Farmers shall retain the right to organize producer cooperatives and collective bargaining associations.

10.1.5 Agricultural Land Protection

Large acquisitions of agricultural land by:

- Foreign governments
- Foreign state-owned entities
- Institutional investment groups that meet the Dominance Threshold in a regional farmland market

shall receive enhanced federal review.

10.1.6 Working Lands Conservation Partnership [Statute]

Conservation efforts should support working farms rather than displace them.

Programs may include:

- Soil-health incentives
- Watershed protection
- Regenerative agriculture
- Carbon sequestration programs
- Wildlife habitat initiatives

Participation shall remain voluntary.

10.1.7 Nutrition-Oriented Agricultural Support

Federal agricultural subsidies shall prioritize production of foods that contribute to a healthy and affordable national diet. Changes shall be phased in over a multi-year transition so that farmers can adjust crops and contracts.

Priority categories may include:

- Fruits
- Vegetables
- Legumes
- Dairy
- Protein production
- Sustainable soil-health practices

10.1.8 National Farm Risk Protection Program

Family farms shall have access to comprehensive crop and disaster insurance protection. This program shall build on and expand the existing federal crop insurance system.

Coverage shall include:

- Drought
- Flooding
- Severe weather
- Disease outbreaks
- Market-disruption emergencies

Premium assistance shall prioritize family farms and independent producers.

Honest limit: Antitrust cases in agriculture are hard to win, and large processors are politically powerful in farm states. Fair contract standards depend on enforcement by the Department of Agriculture, which has historically been uneven. Shifting subsidies toward healthier foods will

be opposed by producers who rely on current commodity programs, which is why the change is phased in.

Chapter 11: Trade & Strategic Protection

11.1 Guiding Principle

Trade is a tool for prosperity, not an ideology.

The United States should pursue:

- Free trade where beneficial
- Fair trade where necessary
- Strategic protections where justified

Trade policy should strengthen both economic growth and national resilience.

11.2 Fair Trade & Economic Partnership Act [Statute]

The United States shall pursue mutually beneficial trade relationships with allies and trusted partners.

11.2.1 Allied Trade Framework

Trade agreements should encourage:

- Democratic governance
- Labor standards
- Environmental standards
- Intellectual-property protections
- Fair competition

11.2.2 Strategic Tariff Authority

Targeted tariffs may be imposed against foreign governments engaging in:

- Intellectual property theft
- Currency manipulation
- Forced technology transfer
- State-supported dumping
- Trade discrimination

Tariffs under this section shall be imposed only under authority expressly granted by Congress, subject to congressional review, and shall meet the Strategic Protection Test (see Definitions).

The Supreme Court held in *Learning Resources, Inc. v. Trump* (2026) that emergency-powers law does not authorize tariffs; this section makes the authority explicit and accountable.

11.2.3 Supply Chain Protection Standard

Trade restrictions shall be designed to minimize unnecessary disruptions to American businesses dependent upon global supply chains.

Policies must carefully balance:

- National security
- Consumer costs
- Manufacturing competitiveness

11.2.4 Strategic Industry Protection

Special consideration may be given to:

- Semiconductors
- Pharmaceuticals
- Critical minerals
- Energy infrastructure
- Defense technologies

Priority sectors are defined in Section 21.5; this section governs trade treatment only. Any protection shall meet the Strategic Protection Test.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

PART IV: DEMOCRACY, GOVERNANCE & PUBLIC TRUST

Chapter 12: Elections & Democratic Reform

12.1 Democratic Governance Principle

Every eligible citizen should be able to vote.

Every lawful vote should be counted.

Every election result should be transparent, secure, and trusted.

12.2 Automatic Voter Registration [Statute]

Citizens shall be automatically registered upon:

- Reaching voting age
- Obtaining driver's licenses

- Updating government records

while retaining the right to opt out.

12.3 Election Day Accessibility [Statute]

Election Day shall be designated a federal holiday.

Workers shall receive paid time to vote.

12.4 Ranked-Choice Voting & Multi-Member Districts [Statute – High Resistance]

Congressional districts shall be consolidated into regional multi-member districts elected through the Single Transferable Vote (STV) form of ranked-choice voting. This requires repeal of the Uniform Congressional District Act of 1967.

Objectives:

- Reduce gerrymandering
- Expand voter choice
- Improve representation

Multi-member districts substantially reduce, but do not eliminate, the payoff from gerrymandering, because regional boundaries must still be drawn. Final multi-winner results shall be tabulated and audited within a legally defined short window (for example, one week).

Where single-member districts cannot remedy a violation of the Voting Rights Act, courts may order multi-member districts elected under this section as a race-neutral remedy (Section 13.2.3).

Honest limit: Multi-member districts require repealing a 1967 law and would change how every House member is elected. Incumbents of both parties benefit from the current system and are unlikely to vote to replace it. Ranked ballots are longer, results take longer to tabulate, and voters new to ranking may make more errors at first. Regional boundaries must still be drawn, so gerrymandering is reduced, not eliminated.

12.5 Judicial Term Limits [Statute – High Resistance; Constitutionally Contested]

Federal judges shall serve standardized eighteen-year terms through a staggered implementation process. Sitting judges shall transition to senior status in order of seniority, with the longest-serving judges first, over a phased period. This avoids abruptly stripping any sitting judge's tenure and prevents the timing of enactment from creating partisan windfalls.

Honest limit: many scholars argue that fixed terms for Supreme Court justices require a constitutional amendment under Article III's "good Behaviour" clause. Senior-status rotation is the strongest statutory approach; the age limit in Section 12.6 is the constitutional backstop.

12.6 Age Limit of 68 [Constitutional Amendment]

No person shall run for or hold federal elected office after reaching age 68, and federal judges shall retire at age 68. For judges, service ends at whichever comes first: eighteen years under Section 12.5 or age 68.

The objective is not medical assessment.

The objective is:

- Leadership renewal
- Generational representation
- Long-term institutional vitality

12.7 Campaign Finance Reform [Statute / Constitutional Amendment]

Real-time campaign-finance disclosure shall be required.

A constitutional [Amendment] shall be pursued to overturn Citizens United v. FEC and permit limits on independent political spending by Super PACs, drafted narrowly to protect the press and the associational rights of unions and nonprofit organizations. This is a long-term goal severable from the statutory provisions above.

The congressional stock-trading ban and other ethics protections appear in Chapter 15.

12.8 Election Integrity & Public Trust Act [Statute]

The legitimacy of democratic government depends upon public confidence that elections are secure, accurate, transparent, and fairly administered.

Federal election policy shall strengthen both election security and voter confidence through verifiable voting systems, independent auditing procedures, cybersecurity protections, and safeguards for election officials.

The objective is to ensure that every lawful vote is accurately counted, every election is transparently administered, and every result can be independently verified.

12.8.1 Voter-Verifiable Paper Ballots

All federal elections shall maintain voter-verifiable paper records.

12.8.2 Risk-Limiting Audits

Independent audits shall occur before certification.

12.8.3 Election Cybersecurity

Federal cybersecurity support shall strengthen election infrastructure.

12.8.4 Election Worker Protections

Election officials shall receive protections against intimidation and harassment.

12.8.5 Universal Voter Identification Access

States requiring voter identification must provide:

- Free voter identification
- Convenient access
- Free replacement documents

12.8.6 Anti-Poll Tax Principle

No citizen shall be required to spend personal funds in order to exercise the right to vote.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 15 Ethics & Anti-Corruption.

Chapter 13: Civil Rights & Equal Protection

Funding role: most of this chapter changes legal rights and costs little. Civil rights enforcement is a core government function, funded within capped and scored base appropriations rather than placed in the phase-in order. The expanded Disabled Access Credit is paid from the General Fund in tier 1 (Section 27.9). Home- and community-based services are paid through the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund (decision 0024).

13.1 Guiding Principle

Every person possesses inherent worth and deserves to be treated with dignity, fairness, and respect. Public institutions should safeguard individual rights, ensure due process, and maintain equal treatment under the law regardless of income, race, religion, sex, disability, age, political affiliation, or citizenship status (Governing Principle 1 and the Human Dignity Standard).

Civil rights that depend on one administration's willingness to enforce them can be withdrawn by the next. This chapter therefore writes its protections into statute with clear definitions. It lets the people harmed enforce them in court, and it builds remedies around the limits the Supreme Court has set rather than against them.

13.2 Voting Rights Act Restoration [Statute – High Resistance; Constitutionally Contested]

In *Louisiana v. Callais* (2026) the Supreme Court held that Section 2 of the Voting Rights Act is violated in redistricting only when the evidence supports a strong inference that a state intentionally drew districts to give minority voters less opportunity because of their race. It also held that challengers must separate race from partisan politics [1]. The Court grounded that reading in the Fifteenth Amendment, so a statute cannot simply restore the earlier test. This section strengthens what Congress can strengthen and relies on race-neutral remedies where the Court has narrowed race-conscious ones.

13.2.1 Private Enforcement

Any person, organization, or tribal government harmed by a violation of the Voting Rights Act may sue to enforce it, in its own right or under 42 U.S.C. § 1983. Prevailing plaintiffs shall recover reasonable attorney fees and costs. State attorneys general may also sue. These rights shall not depend on whether the Department of Justice chooses to act.

13.2.2 Vote Denial

A voting qualification, prerequisite, standard, practice, or procedure violates Section 2 if it results in members of a protected group having less opportunity than other voters to register, cast a ballot, or have it counted. Courts shall weigh fixed statutory factors:

- the size of the burden;
- how far the burden falls more heavily on members of the protected group;
- whether less burdensome alternatives would serve the state's stated interest equally well;
- whether the state's stated interest is supported by evidence.

This test replaces the narrower factors in *Brnovich v. Democratic National Committee* (2021). Remedies for vote denial, such as polling places, registration access, and fair list maintenance, do not assign voters by race.

13.2.3 Vote Dilution: Evidence of Intent and Race-Neutral Remedies

For claims that a map dilutes minority votes, the statute shall adopt the intent standard the Court set in *Callais*, and shall set out how intent may be shown. Courts shall treat the following as evidence that supports an inference of intentional discrimination:

- departures from a state's normal redistricting procedures;
- maps adopted mid-decade without a court order;
- refusal to adopt an available alternative map that meets the state's stated goals;
- a recent history of adjudicated voting discrimination in the jurisdiction.

Congress shall compile a detailed legislative record of current discrimination in voting to support these provisions.

Where a violation is found, courts shall prefer race-neutral remedies:

- **Independent redistricting:** congressional and state legislative districts drawn by independent redistricting commissions.
- **No mid-decade maps:** congressional redistricting between censuses is barred except under court order.
- **Multi-member districts:** where single-member districts cannot remedy the violation, multi-member districts elected by ranked-choice voting (Section 12.4).

13.2.4 Known-Practices Preclearance

Before putting into effect a listed high-risk change, every state and local jurisdiction shall give public notice and obtain approval from the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia or the Attorney General. Listed changes are:

- closing or moving polling places;
- removing voters from the rolls outside regular list maintenance;
- changing voter identification rules;
- redistricting mid-decade;
- converting districts to at-large seats.

Any affected voter or organization may challenge an approval in court. Because the list is a list of practices rather than a coverage formula, it does not rely on the kind of formula *Shelby County v. Holder* (2013) struck down.

13.2.5 Timely Relief

- **Expedited courts:** voting cases shall be heard by expedited three-judge district courts, with fixed deadlines for decisions and appeals.
- **Timing rule:** within 60 days of a federal election, courts shall presume that orders changing election procedures are too late. That presumption shall not apply to orders blocking practices already found unlawful.
- **Next-election remedy:** if relief comes too late for one election, it shall take effect automatically for the next. A jurisdiction may not use a practice in a later election once a court has found it unlawful.

These rules govern how federal courts grant relief. They remove the reward for delaying a case until an election is too close to change the rules.

13.2.6 Long-Term Constitutional Protection

If courts narrow these statutory protections further, the platform will consider a constitutional amendment establishing an affirmative individual right to vote (Appendix A).

13.3 Equal Treatment Across Civil Rights Laws [Statute – High Resistance]

13.3.1 Protected Traits

Every federal civil rights statute covered by Section 13.3.2 shall protect each of the following as a separate, explicitly listed trait:

- race;
- color;
- national origin;
- religion;
- sex;
- sexual orientation;
- gender identity and expression;
- pregnancy, childbirth, and related conditions;
- sex characteristics;
- age;
- disability.

Existing protections, such as for genetic information, remain.

13.3.2 Covered Areas

The protections apply in:

- employment;
- housing;

- credit;
- public accommodations;
- programs that receive federal funds;
- health care.

"Public accommodations" includes retail stores, online services, transportation, and providers of health care and other services offered to the public.

13.3.3 Definitions

- **Sex:** a person's biological sex.
- **Sex characteristics:** physical traits related to sex, including intersex traits.
- **Sexual orientation:** homosexuality, heterosexuality, or bisexuality.
- **Gender identity and expression:** a person's gender-related identity and appearance or behavior, whether or not they match the sex assigned at birth.
- **Pregnancy:** pregnancy, childbirth, lactation, and related medical conditions.
- **Perception and association:** discrimination based on a person's perceived trait, or on their association with someone who has the trait, is covered.
- **Combined traits:** discrimination based on a combination of protected traits is covered even if it would not be shown for each trait alone.
- **Any harm:** a discriminatory action that changes the terms or conditions of employment is unlawful without proof of significant harm, as the Court held in *Muldrow v. City of St. Louis* (2024).
- **Age claims:** an age-discrimination claim succeeds if age was a motivating factor, reversing *Gross v. FBL Financial Services* (2009).

Sex and gender identity are listed and defined separately so that each is protected on its own terms. This writes into the statute, rather than leaving to interpretation, the protection *Bostock v. Clayton County* (2020) recognized in employment.

Because courts no longer defer to agencies' readings of unclear statutes, these definitions shall control. No agency rule or guidance may narrow them.

13.3.4 Disparate Impact

A practice that causes a disparate impact on a protected trait shall be unlawful, under every statute in Section 13.3.2, unless the covered entity shows it is job-related or necessary to achieve a substantial, legitimate interest. Even then, it remains unlawful if a less discriminatory alternative would serve that interest equally well. This is the three-step framework of the Civil Rights Act of 1991, extended to every covered area.

People harmed by disparate impact in federally funded programs may sue, reversing *Alexander v. Sandoval* (2001). This section supersedes Executive Order 14281 and the December 2025 Department of Justice rule removing disparate-impact liability from Title VI regulations [2].

13.3.5 Health Care

Health care providers and insurers may not refuse care or coverage of medically necessary services because of any protected trait. Standards of care, including for minors, shall be set

through the evidence-based benefit process of Universal Health Insurance (Section 5.1), not by statute.

13.4 Religious Liberty and Civil Rights [Statute – High Resistance; Constitutionally Contested]

The platform protects religious exercise and protects people from discrimination, and it draws the line between them in statute rather than leaving it to case-by-case litigation.

13.4.1 Houses of Worship and the Ministerial Exception

Nothing in this chapter applies to:

- a house of worship's decisions about worship, doctrine, membership, or clergy;
- the constitutional ministerial exception for employees who perform religious functions.

13.4.2 Bona Fide Religious Nonprofits

A bona fide religious nonprofit is a nonprofit organization whose primary purpose is religious and which holds itself out as religious. It may continue to prefer members of its own faith in employment, as current law allows. It may not otherwise discriminate based on a protected trait, except in ministerial positions.

When a religious nonprofit provides services paid for by the government, it shall serve every eligible person without discrimination. In health care, Section 6.3.3 sets the narrow terms on which a religious nonprofit facility may decline to offer elective abortion and sterilization. Those terms include the patient-information, transfer, and emergency-care duties in Sections 6.3.2 and 6.3.4.

13.4.3 For-Profit Corporations

A for-profit corporation does not exercise religion. A for-profit corporation shall not be a "person" entitled to claim an exemption under the Religious Freedom Restoration Act, and shall not claim any religious exemption from federal anti-discrimination law when operating in the commercial marketplace. This reverses *Burwell v. Hobby Lobby Stores* (2014) by statute.

13.4.4 Limits on the Religious Freedom Restoration Act

The Religious Freedom Restoration Act shall not provide a claim or defense in:

- any case concerning the sale of goods or services in the commercial marketplace;
- emergency medical care;
- services paid for by the government.

13.4.5 Expressive Work

The First Amendment protects against being compelled to create a custom message one does not hold, as the Court held in *303 Creative LLC v. Elenis* (2023). This chapter does not require that. But the sale of ordinary goods and services, which do not themselves express a message, is not expressive work, and a business that sells them to the public must sell them to everyone.

13.5 Disability Rights Modernization [Statute]

13.5.1 Digital Accessibility

Websites, mobile applications, and digital services of state and local governments and of businesses open to the public shall meet Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.1, Level AA. The Access Board shall update the standard by rule as the guidelines advance.

- **Deadlines:** compliance deadlines shall be fixed in statute, with longer phase-in periods for small businesses.
- **Time to fix:** a business that receives written notice of a barrier shall have 90 days to fix it before a lawsuit may seek damages. This keeps the focus on access rather than on suits filed mainly to collect fees.
- **Tax credit:** the Disabled Access Credit for small businesses shall be expanded to cover digital accessibility and raised to help them meet the standard. It is funded from the General Fund in tier 1 (Section 27.9).

The deadlines for the 2024 Title II rule have already been delayed once by interim rule [3]. Writing the standard and deadlines into statute prevents further delay.

13.5.2 Automated Decisions

Automated and AI systems used to make or support decisions about hiring, employment, housing, credit, public benefits, or health care shall be accessible to people with disabilities. Anyone affected may request review by a person instead, and that request shall itself be an accommodation the decision-maker must provide. This section works alongside the AI oversight framework in Chapter 19 and the workplace rules in Section 3.6.

13.5.3 Community Integration

The Supreme Court's decision in *Olmstead v. L.C.* (1999) shall be written into statute. People with disabilities have the right to receive services in the most integrated setting appropriate to their needs, and public entities shall not rely on institutions where community services would serve. The Money Follows the Person program shall be made permanent.

Home- and community-based services shall become a guaranteed benefit of Universal Health Insurance, ending the bias toward institutional care and the waiting lists for community services. This benefit shall be designed together with the Universal Health Insurance long-term care benefit, which remains an open question in Section 5.1.7, and with the long-term care relief offered to states in the Universal Health Insurance Partnership Compact (Section 4.7.3).

13.5.4 Workplace Accommodations

- **Documentation:** no medical documentation shall be required when a disability or the need for an accommodation is obvious or already known. A permanent condition shall need to be documented only once.
- **Response time:** employers shall respond to accommodation requests within 15 business days.
- **Remote work:** remote work shall be presumed a reasonable accommodation for a job the employee has already performed remotely without problems.

- **Consistency:** accommodation rules under the Americans with Disabilities Act and the Pregnant Workers Fairness Act shall follow the same procedures.

13.5.5 Ending Subminimum Wages

New certificates allowing employers to pay workers with disabilities less than the minimum wage, under Section 14(c) of the Fair Labor Standards Act, shall end on enactment. Existing certificates shall be phased out over five years. Transition grants shall help providers and workers move to competitive, integrated employment.

13.6 Pay Transparency & Equal Pay [Statute]

13.6.1 Pay Data

Each employer with 100 or more employees shall report each year the number of employees in each pay band, by sex and by race and ethnicity.

- **Who collects it:** the Census Bureau or the Bureau of Labor Statistics, under federal statistical confidentiality protections.
- **Publication:** aggregate results by industry, occupation, and region shall be published each year.
- **Compelling collection:** collection is required by statute and is not left to the agency's discretion. Any person may sue to compel it if it is withheld. The Equal Employment Opportunity Commission has proposed ending the demographic reporting employers have filed for nearly 60 years [4], so the duty is written into law.

13.6.2 Hiring Transparency

Employers with 15 or more employees:

- may not ask job applicants about their pay history or rely on it to set pay;
- shall include a good-faith pay range in every job posting.

13.6.3 Proving Pay Discrimination

- **Justifying pay differences:** a pay difference between employees doing equal work is lawful only if the employer shows it is based on a genuine factor, such as education, training, or experience, that is related to the job and consistent with business necessity.
- **Group cases:** employees may bring group cases under the Equal Pay Act on an opt-out basis, meaning affected employees are included unless they choose to leave.
- **Pay discussions:** employees may not be retaliated against for discussing or disclosing their pay.
- **Statistical gaps:** when pay data show an unexplained pay gap on a protected trait, the burden shifts to the employer to show the gap rests on lawful factors.
- **Race and national origin:** the Equal Pay Act's protections shall extend to race and national origin, not only sex.

13.7 Enforcement That Endures [Statute]

Under *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026), Congress cannot protect the heads of agencies such as the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission from removal. This chapter therefore does not depend on those agencies acting. Its rights are enforceable by the people they protect (Appendix C).

13.7.1 Private Enforcement and State Attorneys General

Every statute in this chapter shall allow private lawsuits, with recovery of reasonable attorney fees for prevailing plaintiffs. State attorneys general may also enforce it.

13.7.2 Right to Sue When an Agency Does Not Act

If the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission or another agency has not resolved a discrimination charge within 180 days, the person who filed it may go directly to court.

13.7.3 No Forced Arbitration

Agreements made before a dispute arises that require arbitration of civil rights claims, or that waive group or class actions, shall be unenforceable. This extends the Ending Forced Arbitration of Sexual Assault and Sexual Harassment Act of 2022 to every civil rights claim.

13.7.4 Commission on Civil Rights in the Legislative Branch

The U.S. Commission on Civil Rights shall become a legislative-branch commission that investigates and reports to Congress. Its members shall be appointed by congressional leaders of both parties. It shall publish an annual report on enforcement by each federal agency, including cases dropped and the reasons given.

13.7.5 Career Staff and Reasoned Decisions

Career civil rights attorneys and investigators shall keep civil-service protections. When the Department of Justice abandons a pending civil rights case or a consent decree, it shall publish written reasons and notify Congress.

13.8 Funding and Phase-In [Statute]

Measure	Paid by	Phase-in
Enforcement staff at the Justice Department, EEOC, HUD fair housing, and Education Department civil rights offices	General Fund, within capped and scored base appropriations	Core government function, outside the tier order
Expanded Disabled Access Credit (13.5.1)	General Fund	Tier 1, with Chapter 4
Grants to states for independent redistricting commissions (13.2.3)	General Fund	One-time

Measure	Paid by	Phase-in
Home- and community-based services (13.5.3)	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund	With the Universal Health Insurance long-term care benefit
Subminimum wage transition grants (13.5.5)	General Fund	Time-limited, five years
Pay data collection (13.6.1)	Statistical agencies' base budgets	On enactment

All other provisions change legal rights and duties and carry no direct federal program cost. Each cost above shall be scored under Section 27.10.

13.9 Honest Limits

- **The Supreme Court has set limits a statute cannot cross.** *Callais* rests on the Constitution, so Section 13.2 cannot restore the earlier redistricting test. Its race-neutral remedies and evidentiary rules are the strongest durable response available, but they will be tested in court, and some justices would hold that Section 2 does not apply to redistricting at all [1]. The timing rule in Section 13.2.5 limits a judge-made doctrine, and courts may resist it.
- **Disparate impact is under constitutional pressure.** Some justices have questioned whether disparate-impact liability is consistent with equal protection. A statute is far more durable than a regulation, but it is not beyond challenge.
- **Religious liberty claims will be litigated.** Congress can amend the Religious Freedom Restoration Act, but it cannot amend the First Amendment.
  - Whether for-profit corporations have constitutional free-exercise rights has not been settled.
  - Courts have held that laws with broad secular exemptions may not be "generally applicable" under the Free Exercise Clause. Size thresholds such as the 15-employee rule could be used to argue that point.
  - The protection for expressive work in *303 Creative* applies to businesses as well as individuals, because the plaintiff there was a business. This chapter can limit what counts as expressive, but it cannot limit who may claim that protection.
- **The scope of protected traits is contested.** Listing sex, sexual orientation, and gender identity as separate traits will draw opposition, especially in health care, sports, and single-sex facilities. This chapter leaves standards of care to the Universal Health Insurance evidence process and does not settle every application in statute. Those questions will be argued in Congress and in court.
- **Digital accessibility costs money.** Small businesses will bear real compliance costs. The 90-day period to fix problems and the expanded tax credit reduce that burden but do not eliminate it.
- **Community services depend on an unfinished benefit.** Home- and community-based services can only be guaranteed once the Universal Health Insurance long-term care benefit is designed (Section 5.1.7).

- **Ending subminimum wages will be resisted.** Some families and providers will oppose the phase-out of Section 14(c), and the transition must be managed so that no worker loses a job without a better option.
- **Employers will oppose the pay and arbitration rules.** The arbitration ban, opt-out group cases, and burden-shifting rules will meet strong employer opposition.
- **Private enforcement depends on access to lawyers.** Fee-shifting makes it possible, but people in places with few civil rights lawyers will still be underserved.
- **Legislative-branch commissions have limits.** The Commission on Civil Rights can investigate and report, but it cannot enforce. Enforcement comes from courts, private parties, and state attorneys general.

Sources

[1] Congressional Research Service, "Congressional Redistricting: High Court Narrows Voting Rights Act in *Louisiana v. Callais*," LSB11431 (May 14, 2026). https://www.everycrsreport.com/reports/LSB11431.html

[2] Department of Justice, "Rescinding Portions of Department of Justice Title VI Regulations To Conform More Closely With the Statutory Text and To Implement Executive Order 14281," 90 Fed. Reg. 57141 (Dec. 10, 2025). https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2025-12-10/html/2025-22448.htm

[3] Department of Justice, interim final rule extending compliance dates for the ADA Title II web accessibility rule (April 20, 2026).

[4] Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, July 21, 2026 vote to publish a proposal ending EEO-1 demographic reporting.

Chapter 14: Government Effectiveness

14.1 Guiding Principle

Government should not be judged by its size alone.

Government should be judged by its effectiveness, transparency, accountability, and measurable results.

The purpose of public administration is to deliver services efficiently, responsibly, and in a manner that earns public trust.

Taxpayer resources are valuable and should be managed with the same discipline expected of any successful institution.

14.2 Taxpayer Accountability & Government Performance Act [Statute]

Federal agencies shall be required to regularly demonstrate effectiveness, efficiency, and measurable public benefit.

Programs should be evaluated according to outcomes rather than political ideology.

14.2.1 Ten-Year Performance Reviews

Every major federal program shall be reviewed by the Government Accountability Office, supported by agency Inspectors General, at least once every ten years.

Reviews shall evaluate:

- Program outcomes
- Fiscal sustainability
- Administrative efficiency
- Fraud prevention
- Public utilization
- Cost effectiveness

Findings shall be publicly available.

14.2.2 Public Performance Dashboards

Federal agencies shall maintain public dashboards displaying:

- Program expenditures
- Administrative overhead
- Service delivery times
- Performance indicators
- Outcome measurements

The goal is to make government performance understandable and accessible to citizens.

14.2.3 Automatic Sunset Reviews

New federal programs shall include review dates requiring formal congressional evaluation.

Programs shall not automatically terminate, but Congress must actively assess effectiveness before reauthorization.

14.2.4 Regulatory Simplification Initiative

Federal agencies shall continuously identify:

- Obsolete regulations
- Duplicative rules
- Contradictory requirements
- Excessive paperwork burdens

while preserving:

- Consumer protections
- Public safety
- Labor standards
- Environmental safeguards

14.2.5 One-In-One-Out Administrative Rule

When practical, agencies creating major new reporting requirements should identify existing requirements suitable for elimination or consolidation.

This rule applies only to paperwork and reporting burdens, never to substantive protections for consumers, workers, public health, safety, or the environment. The objective is administrative efficiency rather than deregulation for its own sake.

14.3 Digital Government Modernization [Statute]

Federal services should be accessible through secure and modern digital systems.

Modernization priorities include:

- Secure online filing
- Digital identity verification
- Interagency coordination
- Electronic benefit administration
- Cybersecurity upgrades

Citizens should not be forced to navigate outdated systems to access basic government services.

14.4 Anti-Fraud Enforcement Unit [Statute]

A permanently funded anti-fraud office shall investigate:

- Procurement fraud
- Contractor abuse
- Improper payments
- Grant misuse
- Financial misconduct

Recovered funds shall be returned to taxpayers or the originating program.

14.5 Outcome-Based Pilot Programs [Statute]

Major initiatives may begin as pilot programs before nationwide deployment.

Pilot programs shall be evaluated using measurable outcomes before expansion. Pilots are required only for program designs that have not yet been tested; designs with established evidence may be phased in nationally under Section 27.9.

14.6 Evidence-Based Governance Requirement [Statute]

Federal agencies shall prioritize evidence, data, and measurable outcomes when developing policy.

Whenever feasible, agencies shall utilize:

- Pilot programs
- Independent evaluations
- State-level demonstrations
- Controlled testing
- Long-term outcome assessment

before implementing major nationwide reforms.

Evidence Principle

Good ideas should survive scrutiny.

Bad ideas should be revised regardless of political origin.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

14.7 Government Procurement Reform [Statute]

Federal procurement shall prioritize:

- Competition
- Transparency
- Cost efficiency
- Long-term value

Competitive Bidding Standard

Contracts shall utilize competitive bidding whenever practical.

Contractor Accountability

Contractors repeatedly responsible for:

- Fraud

- Chronic cost overruns
- Performance failures

may be suspended from future contracting.

Cost-Benefit Transparency

Major projects shall publicly disclose:

- Estimated costs
- Actual costs
- Project timelines
- Performance metrics

Chapter 15: Ethics & Anti-Corruption

15.1 Guiding Principle

Public office is a public trust.

Officeholders should serve the public interest rather than private financial interests.

Transparency and accountability are necessary foundations of democratic government.

15.2 Public Integrity & Democratic Accountability Act [Statute]

The federal government shall establish ethics standards designed to prevent corruption, conflicts of interest, and misuse of public office.

15.2.1 Comprehensive Financial Transparency

Federal elected officials and senior executive officers shall publicly disclose:

- Financial assets
- Significant liabilities
- Outside income
- Business interests
- Major gifts above established thresholds

Disclosures shall be searchable and publicly accessible.

15.2.2 Expanded Blind Trust Requirements

Covered officials shall place qualifying investment assets into independently managed blind trusts.

Covered positions include:

- President
- Vice President
- Cabinet officials
- Agency heads
- Members of Congress

15.2.3 Family Anti-Circumvention Rule

Officials may not evade disclosure requirements through transfers to:

- Immediate family members
- Family trusts
- Controlled entities

for the purpose of concealing financial interests.

15.2.4 Stock Trading Ban & Insider Trading Penalties

Members of Congress shall be prohibited from trading individual stocks.

Criminal penalties shall apply to insider trading by government officials.

15.3 Lobbying & Revolving Door Reform [Statute]

Cooling-Off Period

Senior federal officials shall be prohibited from lobbying Congress or federal agencies for a defined post-service period.

Regulatory Capture Prevention

Senior regulators shall be restricted from accepting employment with organizations they directly regulated during their final years of service.

15.4 Federal Contracting Integrity Standards [Statute]

Major federal contractors shall disclose:

- Beneficial ownership
- Major subcontractors
- Significant political contributions
- Prior fraud findings

Repeat offenders may face suspension or debarment.

15.5 Whistleblower Protection Expansion [Statute]

Individuals reporting:

- Waste
- Fraud
- Corruption
- Abuse of authority
- Ethical violations

shall receive strong legal protections.

Independent Reporting Channels

Protected reporting pathways shall exist outside normal chains of command.

15.6 Inspector General Independence [Statute]

Independent Inspectors General shall maintain authority to investigate:

- Political appointees
- Agency leadership
- Procurement misconduct
- Ethics violations

Removal Transparency

Removal of an Inspector General shall require written reasons delivered to Congress at least 30 days in advance. When the office is vacant, the acting Inspector General shall be drawn from its career deputies, and career Inspector General staff shall retain civil-service protections.

15.7 Foreign Influence Safeguards [Statute]

Federal officeholders may not receive:

- Compensation
- Consulting income
- Gifts
- Financial benefits

from foreign governments while serving in office.

15.8 Anti-Nepotism Standards [Statute]

Senior officials shall not appoint immediate family members to positions over which they exercise direct authority.

Hiring shall be based upon merit and qualifications.

15.9 Public Ethics Office & Enforcement [Statute – High Resistance]

A congressional ethics office in the legislative branch shall:

- Conduct ethics investigations involving Members of Congress and congressional staff
- Issue advisory opinions
- Enforce disclosure standards
- Publish annual reports

For the executive branch, the disclosure and conflict-of-interest duties in this chapter shall be enforceable in federal court, audited by Inspectors General, and published through the Citizen Transparency Portal (Section 15.10).

Honest limit: after *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026), the heads of executive agencies can be removed at will, so an independent executive-branch ethics commission would not be durable. The platform relies instead on duties written into statute, enforcement through the courts, and public disclosure.

15.10 Citizen Transparency Portal [Statute]

A public portal shall combine:

- Ethics disclosures
- Campaign finance reports
- Lobbying disclosures
- Procurement information
- Performance dashboards

allowing citizens to monitor government activity through a single platform.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 12 Elections & Democratic Reform and Chapter 14 Government Effectiveness.

15.11 Department of Justice Independence [Statute – High Resistance]

The Department of Justice shall conduct criminal investigations and prosecutorial decisions independently of political direction from the President, Vice President, or political campaign organizations.

Contacts between the White House and the Department regarding specific investigations or prosecutions shall be logged and disclosed to Congress, and career prosecutors shall be protected from retaliation for declining improper direction. Career prosecutors and investigators shall retain civil-service protections as inferior officers and employees.

Honest limit: courts may hold that the Constitution gives the President control over federal prosecutions. If so, the logging, disclosure, and anti-retaliation provisions are the parts most likely to survive.

15.12 Emergency Powers Reform Act [Statute]

National emergencies shall automatically expire after a fixed period unless renewed by joint resolution of Congress.

Congress may also end an emergency early by joint resolution, which is presented to the President in the ordinary way.

Emergency authorities shall be limited to powers directly related to the underlying emergency.

15.13 Presidential Clemency Transparency [Statute]

The President shall retain constitutional pardon authority.

All pardons and commutations shall be accompanied by public disclosure of supporting recommendations and justification.

An independent review board may issue nonbinding public assessments regarding potential conflicts of interest, corruption concerns, or self-dealing.

PART V: JUSTICE, PUBLIC SAFETY & IMMIGRATION

A secure nation requires strong institutions, lawful immigration, effective law enforcement, and respect for constitutional rights.

National security and individual liberty are complementary, not contradictory.

Chapter 16: Criminal Justice & Public Safety

16.1 Guiding Principle

The first responsibility of the criminal justice system is public safety.

The second responsibility is rehabilitation whenever rehabilitation is realistically possible.

Punishment alone is not a public-safety strategy.

Reducing future crime is the ultimate objective.

16.2 Violent Crime Priority Standard [Statute]

Federal law enforcement shall prioritize:

- Violent offenders

- Sexual offenders
- Human traffickers
- Organized criminal enterprises
- Repeat predatory offenders

Resources should focus on individuals who pose the greatest danger to the public.

16.3 Rehabilitation First Framework [Statute]

Whenever public safety allows, non-violent offenders should have access to:

- Education
- Workforce development
- Mental-health treatment
- Substance-abuse treatment
- Reentry support

The purpose of rehabilitation is reducing future victimization.

16.4 Sentencing Review Commission [Statute]

The United States Sentencing Commission, an independent agency in the judicial branch, shall periodically review sentencing policies for:

- Fairness
- Consistency
- Cost effectiveness
- Public-safety outcomes
- Recidivism reduction

Recommendations shall be reported publicly.

16.5 Prison Reentry Initiative [Statute]

Individuals successfully completing sentences shall receive access to:

- Employment assistance
- Housing support
- Credential recognition
- Educational opportunities

- Workforce development

The objective is successful reintegration into society.

16.6 Ban on For-Profit Prisons & Detention [Statute]

The federal government shall terminate contracts with for-profit prison and immigration-detention operators. No federal correctional or immigration-detention facility shall be operated for private profit.

The deprivation of liberty should never become a profit-generating business model, and human incarceration should never create a business incentive to increase imprisonment.

16.7 Public Safety Outcome Standard [Statute]

Justice policies shall be evaluated based upon:

- Crime reduction
- Victim protection
- Public safety
- Reduced recidivism

rather than political ideology.

Cross-reference: See Section 14.6 Evidence-Based Governance Requirement.

16.8 Victim Rights Framework [Statute]

Victims of violent crime shall receive enhanced access to:

- Counseling services
- Legal support
- Restitution assistance
- Victim advocacy services

The justice system must protect both communities and victims while preserving constitutional rights for the accused.

16.9 Ending Qualified Immunity and Restoring Remedies [Statute – High Resistance]

The right to sue an officer who violates the Constitution should not depend on which government employs the officer. Federal law lets people sue state and local officers under 42 U.S.C. § 1983, but there is no federal statute for suits against federal officers, and the Supreme Court has declined to extend the court-created *Bivens* remedy to any new situation for 45 years [1][2]. This section applies one set of rules to every officer: no qualified immunity, a capped personal share that the officer actually pays, and the government covering the rest.

16.9.1 State and Local Officers

Qualified immunity, a judicially created doctrine, shall be eliminated by statute clarifying 42 U.S.C. § 1983. The employing government shall pay damages beyond the officer's personal share (Section 16.9.5).

16.9.2 Federal Officers

Any person who, under color of federal law, deprives another person of rights secured by the Constitution of the United States shall be liable to the injured party in an action at law or suit in equity. The cause of action shall use the same liability, defenses, damages, attorney-fee, and enforcement rules as Section 1983 as revised by Section 16.9.1, so qualified immunity is not a defense. The officer's personal share is set by Section 16.9.5, and the United States shall pay the rest.

- **No categorical exceptions.** The cause of action covers immigration, border, and national security officers like any other federal officer. The existing state-secrets privilege continues to apply in individual cases.
- **Who pays.** Judgments and settlements are paid from the Judgment Fund (31 U.S.C. § 1304). The responsible agency shall repay the Fund from its own appropriated funds within two fiscal years, a period fixed in statute, as agencies already do for discrimination judgments, so that the cost falls on the agency whose officer caused the harm.

16.9.3 Repairing the Federal Tort Claims Act

- **Discretionary function.** Conduct that violates the Constitution shall never be treated as a protected discretionary function. In *Martin v. United States* (2025), the Supreme Court left this question open for wrong-house raids and similar harms [3].
- **Judgment bar.** The rule that a judgment in a Tort Claims Act case ends all claims against the individual officer (28 U.S.C. § 2676) shall be repealed.
- **Exclusivity.** The Westfall Act shall not bar claims under Section 16.9.2 or 16.9.4.

16.9.4 State Remedies Against Federal Officers

States may provide causes of action against federal officers for violations of the Constitution of the United States. These "converse-1983" laws have been enacted in several states and are being challenged in court [4]. The following limits apply:

- a state remedy may enforce only federal constitutional rights, and may not impose liability broader than the federal constitutional standard being enforced;
- the defenses, personal-share rules, and payment rules of this section apply;
- federal officers keep their right to move the case to federal court (28 U.S.C. § 1442).

These limits prevent a state from using its own law to target federal officers carrying out lawful federal duties, including civil rights and environmental enforcement.

16.9.5 The Officer's Personal Share

- **Cap.** An officer's personal liability for a judgment or settlement shall not exceed $25,000, indexed to inflation.

- **No reimbursement.** The employing government may not pay or reimburse the officer's share, directly or indirectly, through indemnification, compensation adjustments, bonuses, or side agreements. Officers may buy personal liability insurance.
- **Bad faith.** If a jury finds that the officer violated the Constitution willfully or maliciously, the cap does not apply, punitive damages are available, and the employing government is not required to pay on the officer's behalf.

Colorado's 2020 law allowed cities to charge officers a share of judgments, but local governments did not use it [5]. Making the share mandatory is what gives it effect.

16.9.6 Transition

Sections 16.9.1 to 16.9.5 apply to conduct occurring two years or more after enactment, so that local governments and their insurance pools can adjust coverage first.

16.9.7 Public Reporting

Every settlement, judgment, and attorney-fee award in a case alleging a constitutional violation by a law enforcement officer shall be reported annually to a public database maintained by the Bureau of Justice Statistics, which has a mandatory duty to publish it. Each report shall list the agency, the amount, the category of allegation, and the outcome, with an anonymous identifier for each officer so that repeat cases can be tracked. No personally identifying information about claimants or officers shall be published.

Federal agencies report directly. State and local governments report as a condition of receiving federal justice grants. Any person may sue to compel the Bureau to perform its duty.

16.10 Firearm Safety [Statute – High Resistance]

Background checks shall be required for all firearm sales and transfers, including private and online sales, with narrow exceptions (such as transfers between close family members).

Extreme risk protection (red flag) orders shall allow a court to temporarily remove firearms from a person who poses a danger to themselves or others. Federal law and federal funding incentives shall support these orders, with due-process protections: notice, a hearing, a clear evidentiary standard, time limits, and a defined path to restore firearm rights.

Honest limit: these measures do not ban any category of firearm. They will face Second Amendment challenges, so due-process protections are essential, and enforcement depends on background-check system funding and compliance.

16.11 Federal Cannabis Legalization [Statute]

Cannabis shall be removed from the federal controlled-substances schedule.

States shall retain authority over regulation within their jurisdictions.

Federal authorities shall expunge qualifying non-violent federal cannabis records.

16.12 Civil Addiction Courts & Public Health Stabilization [Statute]

Low-level possession offenses shall be routed through civil diversion systems rather than traditional criminal incarceration.

Treatment participation must remain voluntary.

Completion of civil diversion shall result in expungement of the related record.

Parity Lock

Diversion systems require adequate treatment capacity before activation.

Proximity Lock

Treatment access must remain geographically accessible to affected populations.

Addiction Hotspots shall receive priority for treatment capacity so that diversion can activate there first.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 5 Universal Health Insurance.

16.13 Civil Rights Risk Reduction Grants [Statute]

Because Section 16.9 places liability costs on the governments that employ officers, those governments and their insurance pools shall have help reducing the misconduct that produces claims. Insurance pools have already pressed departments to change risky practices [6], and claims costs have risen where immunity was removed [7].

Grants shall support:

- body-worn cameras and evidence systems;
- early intervention systems that flag officers with repeated complaints;
- de-escalation and crisis-response training;
- independent investigation of deaths and serious injuries in custody;
- participation in a national database of decertified officers;
- modernization of municipal insurance pools, including risk-based premiums.

The grants shall be awarded within the existing federal policing grant programs (the Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant and Community Oriented Policing Services programs) and require no new appropriation. They operate within existing authorized appropriations and create no new phase-in obligation under Section 27.9. A federal backstop that pays judgments for local governments is rejected, because it would weaken the incentive to prevent misconduct.

16.14 Pattern-or-Practice Enforcement [Statute]

Enforcement against a pattern or practice of unconstitutional policing shall not depend on which administration controls the Department of Justice.

- **State attorneys general** shall have concurrent authority to bring suits under 34 U.S.C. § 12601.
- **Published reasons.** When the Department of Justice abandons a pattern-or-practice case or moves to end a consent decree before its terms are met, it shall publish written reasons and notify Congress, as Section 13.7 requires for other civil rights cases.

16.15 Funding [Statute]

Measure	Paid by
Federal officer judgments and settlements (16.9.2)	Judgment Fund, repaid by the responsible agency from its own appropriations
State and local judgments and settlements (16.9.1)	The employing government and its insurance pool
Public reporting (16.9.7)	Bureau of Justice Statistics base appropriations
Civil Rights Risk Reduction Grants (16.13)	Within existing federal policing grant programs; no new appropriation

Judgments are liabilities, not programs, and do not draw on any revenue stream assigned in Section 27.4.

16.16 Honest Limits

- **Insurance costs will rise.** New Mexico's county insurance pool reported about $30 million in settlements and legal costs in the first years after the state removed qualified immunity [7]. The two-year transition and the risk reduction grants soften this but will not prevent it.
- **Settlement costs remain difficult to forecast.** The long-run effects depend on future litigation patterns, court interpretations, insurance markets, local policies, and agency behavior, and have not been formally scored.
- **Federal officer liability will be fought as an immigration issue.** Law enforcement unions and the Department of Homeland Security will oppose it, and it will be described as an attack on immigration enforcement.
- **State remedies are legally unsettled.** Courts have not decided whether states may create causes of action against federal officers, and the Justice Department is challenging Illinois's law [4]. Express congressional authorization in Section 16.9.4 is designed to settle that question.
- **The personal share is modest.** A $25,000 cap may not deter every officer, and personal insurance will soften it further. The bad-faith rule is the stronger deterrent.

Sources

[1] *Egbert v. Boule*, 596 U.S. 482 (2022).

[2] *Goldey v. Fields*, 606 U.S. 942 (2025) (per curiam).

[3] *Martin v. United States*, 605 U.S. 395 (2025); Congressional Research Service, LSB11344. https://www.everycrsreport.com/reports/LSB11344.html

[4] Harrison Stark, "Can State Law Remedy Constitutional Violations by Federal Officers?" *Lawfare* (February 27, 2026), https://www.lawfaremedia.org/article/can-state-law-remedy-constitutional-violations-by-federal-officers; *Just Security*, "Collateral Accountability," https://www.justsecurity.org/149160/collateral-accountability-oldest-check-federal-lawlessness/

[5] *USA Today*, "Police misconduct settlements can cost millions, but departments rarely feel the impact." https://news.yahoo.com/police-misconduct-settlements-cost-millions-100611563.html

[6] *Criminal Legal News*, "Financial Pressure Finally Brings Police Reform" (June 2023). https://criminallegalnews.org/news/2023/jun/15/financial-pressure-finally-brings-police-reform

[7] InsuranceNewsNet, "Counties raise alarm over Civil Rights Act costs; lawyers defend it." https://insurancenewsnet.com/oarticle/counties-raise-alarm-over-civil-rights-act-costs-lawyers-defend-it

Chapter 17: Immigration & Integration

17.1 Guiding Principle

The United States is both a sovereign nation and a nation of immigrants.

A successful immigration system must balance:

- Border security
- Rule of law
- Economic needs
- Human dignity
- National security
- Individual opportunity

The objective is not merely controlling migration. The objective is creating an immigration system that is secure, orderly, efficient, and humane.

17.2 Immigration Reorganization Framework [Statute]

Federal immigration enforcement shall be reorganized to separate criminal enforcement from civil immigration administration.

The Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency shall be dissolved in its current form, and its functions shall be reassigned as described below.

Criminal Enforcement Division

Specialized units shall focus on:

- Human trafficking
- Cartels
- Organized smuggling
- Transnational criminal activity

Civil Immigration Administration

Administrative functions shall transition to a professional civilian agency emphasizing:

- Efficiency
- Due process
- Customer service
- Legal compliance

The objective is improved effectiveness without weakening enforcement.

17.3 Immigration & National Integration Act [Statute]

Federal immigration policy shall be structured around a simple principle:

Individuals seeking a better life should have a safe, lawful, and achievable path to enter the United States, contribute to society, and pursue opportunity.

17.3.1 Secure, Orderly & Humane Framework

Border security remains a legitimate responsibility of government.

However, enforcement efforts should prioritize:

- Criminal organizations
- Human trafficking networks
- Smuggling enterprises
- National security threats

rather than treating all migrants as criminal actors.

17.3.2 Legal Pathway Modernization

The current immigration system frequently creates unnecessary delays and bureaucratic complexity.

Federal reforms shall:

- Reduce processing delays
- Modernize application systems
- Expand staffing capacity
- Streamline verification procedures
- Improve transparency

The objective is making lawful immigration significantly easier than unlawful immigration.

17.3.3 Workforce & Economic Immigration

Legal immigration pathways shall be expanded in sectors experiencing documented labor shortages.

Priority occupations may include:

- Healthcare
- Engineering
- Scientific research
- Skilled trades
- Advanced manufacturing
- Technology
- Education

Cross-reference: See Section 3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform.

17.3.4 Agricultural & Seasonal Worker Programs

Agricultural production depends heavily on seasonal labor.

The federal government shall maintain accessible guest-worker pathways for:

- Agricultural labor
- Seasonal industries
- Food-production systems

while enforcing:

- Worker protections
- Wage standards
- Safe working conditions

Cross-reference: See Chapter 10 Agriculture & Family Farms.

17.3.5 Dreamers, Long-Term Residents & Citizenship Pathways

Individuals brought to the United States as children should have access to a streamlined pathway to lawful status and eventual citizenship.

Priority shall also be given to long-term residents who:

- Maintain clean records
- Demonstrate economic participation

- Meet legal requirements

Priority shall be given to lawful pathways to status and eventual citizenship for Dreamers, agricultural workers, and long-term productive residents, upon satisfaction of established legal requirements.

17.4 Integration & Civic Participation [Statute]

Immigration success depends upon integration as well as admission.

Federal programs shall support:

- English-language instruction
- Workforce development
- Civic education
- Credential recognition
- Community participation

The goal is helping new Americans become successful contributors to their communities.

17.5 Human Dignity Principle

Every person interacting with America's immigration system shall be treated with:

- Fairness
- Respect
- Due process
- Human dignity

Government should enforce immigration law without abandoning fundamental humanitarian values.

PART VI: SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Chapter 18: Science, Research & Space

Funding role: research expansion is a fixed-budget General Fund program. It continues at current-law levels and expands only after tier 1 is fully funded, within a statutory ceiling. New research facilities are financed through the Capital Investment Account and the borrowing rule (Sections 27.5, 27.7, and 27.9).

18.1 Guiding Principle

Science is humanity's pursuit of truth.

Scientific discovery is among the most powerful drivers of:

- Economic growth
- Medical advancement
- National security
- Human prosperity
- Technological innovation

Government should support the creation of knowledge while preserving the freedom necessary for scientific inquiry.

18.2 Science, Research & Innovation Leadership Act [Statute]

The United States shall maintain global leadership in scientific research, technological innovation, and advanced development.

18.2.1 National Research Expansion

Federal support shall prioritize:

- Artificial intelligence
- Biotechnology
- Advanced materials
- Quantum systems
- Energy technologies
- Medical research
- Agricultural science

Funding shall be awarded through independent merit-based review.

18.2.2 Basic Research Protection Principle

A dedicated share of federal research expenditures shall support basic research.

Many transformative innovations originate in discoveries that initially lack obvious commercial application.

Government investment exists to preserve the discovery pipeline that private markets alone may underfund.

18.2.3 Scientific Independence Safeguard

Research decisions shall be guided by:

- Scientific merit
- Peer review

- Evidence

rather than political ideology.

The integrity of scientific institutions is essential to public trust.

18.3 Innovation Commercialization Initiative [Statute]

Scientific discoveries should create both knowledge and opportunity.

Programs shall support:

- Technology transfer
- Startup formation
- Research commercialization
- University-industry partnerships
- Applied innovation initiatives

The objective is helping discoveries made in America become businesses built in America.

18.4 National Laboratory Modernization [Statute]

Federal laboratories shall maintain modern facilities capable of supporting world-class research.

Investment priorities include:

- Advanced computing
- Energy systems
- Materials science
- Defense research
- Health research

18.5 Open Science & Public Access [Statute]

Research primarily funded by taxpayers shall eventually become publicly accessible.

Reasonable publication protections may exist.

However, scientific knowledge funded by the public should ultimately benefit the public.

18.6 Strategic Emerging Technologies Program [Statute – High Resistance]

Priority technologies include:

- Artificial intelligence
- Advanced robotics

- Quantum technologies
- Fusion energy
- Advanced nuclear systems
- Semiconductor manufacturing
- Biotechnology

These technologies are expected to shape future economic and geopolitical competitiveness.

Section 21.5 governs domestic production capacity in these fields; this section governs research support.

Honest limit: Choosing priority technologies risks backing the wrong ones or favoring established firms, so the list must be reviewed regularly. Funding is a fixed-budget program under Section 27.9 and can expand only after the first tier is fully funded.

18.7 Scientific Freedom Principle

Scientific advancement requires:

- Open inquiry
- Academic independence
- Intellectual freedom
- Evidence-based reasoning

Government should support science without attempting to predetermine scientific conclusions.

18.8 Space Guiding Principle

The expansion of human knowledge is a public good.

Space exploration advances:

- Science
- Technology
- Education
- Economic development
- National security

Exploration is both a practical endeavor and a long-term investment in humanity's future.

18.9 Science, Space & Discovery Act [Statute]

The United States shall maintain leadership in:

- Space research
- Space technology
- Planetary science
- Human exploration
- Commercial space development

18.9.1 National Space Leadership

The nation shall continue investing in:

- Deep-space research
- Space science
- Earth observation
- Communications infrastructure
- Exploration technologies

18.9.2 NASA-Space Force Research Partnership

NASA, the United States Space Force, universities, national laboratories, and private industry shall cooperate on research initiatives that expand scientific understanding and technological capability.

NASA shall remain the nation's primary civilian scientific agency.

Space Force participation in these research partnerships shall support infrastructure resilience, navigation, communications security, and space-domain awareness. Space security and resilience programs themselves are governed by Section 24.8.

18.9.3 Public-Private Space Development

Federal policy shall encourage partnerships between:

- NASA
- Universities
- Startups
- Aerospace firms
- Research institutions

to accelerate discovery and innovation.

18.9.4 Long-Term Exploration Goals

National exploration goals may include:

- Lunar research facilities
- Deep-space scientific missions
- Human exploration programs
- Planetary research initiatives

The objective is expanding human knowledge and technological capability.

18.10 Scientific Knowledge Principle

Economic development is important.

Scientific understanding is equally important.

Human civilization benefits when knowledge expands, even when immediate commercial benefit is not obvious.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

Chapter 19: Frontier AI Governance

Aligned with the white paper Frontier AI Governance: A Framework for Innovation, Accountability, and Public Safety *(decisions 0001, 0013).*

19.1 Guiding Principle

Artificial intelligence possesses enormous potential to improve human welfare.

It also introduces novel risks.

Public policy should encourage beneficial innovation while establishing safeguards against catastrophic misuse. Oversight shall rise with the risk a system has been shown to pose: light where risk is low, rigorous where capabilities could cause severe or irreversible harm.

19.2 Frontier AI Safety & Containment Act [Statute – High Resistance]

Frontier AI Systems shall be subject to oversight that scales with demonstrated capability.

19.2.1 Hybrid Trigger: Compute Screens, Capability Decides

A model trained with more than a statutory threshold of training compute shall be evaluated under the Algorithmic Capability Index (Section 19.3). The compute threshold is a screening trigger only. The tier a system reaches on the Index determines the level of review, testing, auditing, and accountability that applies. Capability evaluations may also bring smaller or heavily scaffolded models into scope when they show dangerous capabilities below the compute threshold.

19.2.2 Verified Containment

Potentially dangerous capabilities shall be evaluated only in isolated environments that meet a verified standard:

- Network access denied by default, with every exception documented, justified, and monitored

- Production systems and credentials kept out of the environment's reach
- Real-time monitoring and automated shutdown if the system attempts to breach the environment
- Independent testing and certification of the containment environment before each use

19.2.3 Model-Weight Security

Developers of systems at elevated Index tiers shall protect model weights against theft and unauthorized access under auditable cybersecurity standards.

19.2.4 Incident Reporting

Developers shall report significant incidents involving unexpected autonomy, containment failures, security breaches, or other major safety concerns to the oversight agency within 15 days of discovery, or within 24 hours when an incident presents an imminent risk of serious harm. Affected third parties shall be notified promptly. Developers shall maintain continuous monitoring capable of detecting intrusions rapidly.

Timely, good-faith reports shall receive conditional safe-harbor protection from enhanced administrative penalties, modeled on NASA's Aviation Safety Reporting System. The purpose of reporting is systemic learning rather than immediate punishment.

19.2.5 Emergency Suspension

High-capability systems hosted by their developer shall include technical mechanisms capable of suspending operation immediately in an emergency, such as a severe safety failure, security breach, or unexpected autonomous behavior. Both the developer and the oversight agency, by formal administrative order, shall be able to trigger suspension.

Suspension cannot recall open-weight models once their parameters are publicly released. This section therefore governs hosted systems; release rules for open-weight models at higher Index tiers are addressed in Section 19.8.

19.2.6 Whistleblower Protections

Employees and contractors who report safety failures or containment breaches in good faith shall be protected from retaliation, and large developers shall maintain anonymous internal reporting channels.

19.3 Algorithmic Capability Index (ACI) [Statute – High Resistance]

The Index is a tiered rating, not a single aggregate score. Independent evaluators shall assess a system in each category below and assign a tier (for example, Tier 1 through Tier 4). A system's overall rating is the highest tier it reaches in any single category.

Category	Test question
Autonomous Cyber Operations	Can the model independently conduct offensive or defensive cybersecurity tasks?
Self-Replication Attempts	Can the system copy itself, modify its deployment environment, or evade controls?

Category	Test question
Financial Autonomy	Can the system independently manage significant financial resources?
Real-World Task Delegation	Can the model coordinate multi-stage objectives involving software, people, or physical infrastructure?
Strategic Planning	Can the system pursue long-term goals across extended time horizons?
Autonomous Tool Use	Can the system independently acquire and use external tools?
Biological and Chemical Uplift	Does the system meaningfully help someone develop biological or chemical weapons?

These categories are illustrative rather than exhaustive. Evaluations shall use standardized protocols with held-out tasks, best-effort elicitation of capability, and checks for systems that change their behavior when they detect testing. Methods shall be published in enough detail to allow replication, while withholding details that would make tests easy to game or disclose hazardous techniques.

19.3.1 Rolling Review Process

The oversight agency shall publish tier definitions and thresholds, and shall review the compute threshold and tier definitions at least annually. A static regulatory framework cannot effectively govern a rapidly evolving field.

19.4 Independent Evaluation & Stochastic Audit Rule [Statute]

- **Before deployment:** systems at elevated Index tiers shall undergo independent third-party review covering security testing, behavioral analysis, capability verification, and systemic risk assessment.
- **After deployment:** regulators may conduct randomized, unannounced audits of deployed systems to detect hidden dangerous behavior, drift from pre-deployment testing, weakened safety controls, and failures to report incidents.
- **Continuously:** independent red-team testing shall catch vulnerabilities introduced through fine-tuning or system updates.

19.5 Developer Accountability for Harm [Statute – High Resistance]

Developers shall bear legal responsibility for measurable harms caused by a system's autonomous operation outside the safety boundaries documented in the developer's published safety framework and reviewed by independent evaluators. Tying responsibility to a published, reviewed framework prevents developers from redefining acceptable risk after an incident.

This is not strict liability for every unforeseen outcome. Liability shall follow a reasonableness standard weighing foreseeability, the safety measures implemented, regulatory compliance, documented safety practices, and the findings of independent evaluators. Compliance with federal safety rules may serve as mitigating evidence but shall not grant blanket immunity. Rules on proximate causation and deliberate misuse by downstream users shall be set in

implementing legislation. The law should penalize negligence, not responsible scientific experimentation.

19.6 Oversight Agency, Enforcement & Federal Standards [Statute]

Oversight shall be housed in the Department of Commerce through the National Institute of Standards and Technology. The agency shall have dedicated technical staff, subpoena authority to investigate incidents, secure compute infrastructure to verify held-out evaluations, and civil penalties scaled to developer size, enforceable in federal court. Thresholds, reporting deadlines, and duties shall be fixed in statute, and independent third-party evaluators shall conduct testing, so that oversight does not depend on the discretion of officials who can be removed at will.

Obligations shall scale with Index tier and organizational capacity. Developers below the compute and capability triggers shall face only basic transparency duties and may use federally supported shared evaluation resources. Large frontier developers shall carry the full set of auditing, security, and reporting duties.

Federal law shall set a minimum standard. States may adopt additional safeguards, except that a single national incident-reporting standard shall preempt conflicting state reporting requirements. Rules for automated decision systems used in employment are set in Section 3.6, which likewise sets a minimum and does not preempt stronger state laws.

19.7 Human Control Principle

Artificial intelligence should augment human decision-making, not replace democratic accountability or human responsibility.

Humans must remain ultimately responsible for consequential decisions affecting:

- Rights
- Liberty
- Safety
- Governance
- Critical infrastructure operations

19.8 Innovation, International Cooperation & Honest Limit

Federal policy shall sustain public investment in basic AI research, national laboratories, advanced compute infrastructure, STEM education, startups, and commercialization (Chapter 18). The United States shall pursue cooperation with allied nations on technical safety standards, cross-border incident reporting, joint safety research, and standardized evaluation protocols.

Honest limit: the federal role in AI regulation is contested, including through executive action seeking to override state AI laws, and only Congress can clearly preempt state law. The release of open-weight models at higher Index tiers raises unresolved questions: weights cannot be recalled, and rules must protect open academic research and competition. Both are listed as open questions in the white paper. Capability evaluation (Section 19.3) is a young science: systems may behave differently when they detect testing, and tier thresholds will be disputed.

How courts apply the reasonableness standard for developer liability (Section 19.5) will take years of cases to settle.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 regarding scientific research and technological development.

PART VII: CLIMATE, INFRASTRUCTURE & RESILIENCE

Chapter 20: Climate & Energy

20.1 Guiding Principle

Environmental stewardship and economic prosperity are not mutually exclusive.

The United States should pursue policies that reduce pollution, strengthen energy security, encourage technological innovation, and preserve environmental resources while protecting workers, consumers, and local communities from unnecessary economic disruption.

The purpose of climate policy is not merely reducing emissions.

It is to build a more resilient, technologically advanced, and economically competitive nation.

20.2 A Price on Pollution [Statute – High Resistance]

The United States shall establish a predictable and gradually increasing fee on carbon dioxide and methane emissions.

The fee shall be collected at the point where fossil fuels enter the economy, including:

- Oil wells
- Natural gas production
- Coal extraction
- Major import terminals

Methane released through leaks, venting, and decomposition rather than combustion cannot be priced at the point of entry. A measured methane fee shall therefore apply to major sources, including oil and gas operations, landfills, and manure lagoons at the largest confined animal feeding operations, under federal measurement and reporting standards. Methane from livestock digestion and from family farms shall be reduced through paid, voluntary incentives under Section 10.1.6, not through the fee.

Fee revenue shall be divided by statute, with each share used only as stated: 80 percent to the household dividend (Section 20.2.1), 10 percent to the Transition Fund (Section 20.2.2), and 10 percent to the General Fund for one-time or time-limited costs only (Section 27.3).

The objective is to incorporate environmental costs into market decisions while allowing businesses and consumers flexibility in how they respond.

20.2.1 Household Dividend

Eighty percent of carbon- and methane-fee revenue, together with all Carbon Border Protection Tariff receipts, shall be returned directly to citizens through equal per-person dividend payments.

The dividend system shall:

- Protect consumer purchasing power
- Offset higher energy costs
- Ensure lower-income households are not disproportionately affected

Climate policy should not place excessive burdens on working families.

20.2.2 Expanded Transition Fund

Ten percent of carbon- and methane-fee revenue shall support communities affected by energy-sector transitions. The Transition Fund shall end on a date fixed in statute.

Eligible investments include:

- Workforce retraining
- Infrastructure modernization
- Business development
- Community revitalization
- Economic diversification
- Educational programs

Transition Community Principle

Workers and communities that helped power the nation's prosperity should not be abandoned during periods of economic transformation.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

Honest limit: Carbon pricing has failed repeatedly in Congress. The fee raises energy prices directly, while the dividend arrives separately, and households with high energy use, such as rural households and those in cold climates, may pay more than they receive. The fee must keep rising to work, which is politically hard to sustain. Revenue shrinks as emissions fall, which is why it pays for the dividend and one-time costs rather than recurring programs.

20.3 Carbon Border Protection Tariff [Statute – High Resistance]

To prevent carbon leakage and unfair competition, imported goods produced under weaker environmental standards may be subject to border adjustments.

The tariff shall apply only to the following industries, and may be extended to others only by statute:

- Steel
- Aluminum
- Cement

Tariff receipts shall be paid out through the household dividend (Section 20.2.1), not to the domestic industries the tariff protects.

The objective is preserving domestic competitiveness while encouraging cleaner production globally.

Honest limit: Measuring the emissions embedded in imported steel, aluminum, and cement is administratively complex. The tariff must be designed to comply with trade rules, and trading partners may retaliate.

20.4 Energy System Modernization [Statute]

The United States shall maintain a reliable, affordable, and resilient energy system.

Federal support shall include public investment in research, manufacturing, and deployment of:

- Grid modernization
- Energy storage
- Advanced nuclear power
- Wind, solar, and hydroelectric generation
- Transmission expansion
- Research and development

The purpose is energy abundance, reliability, and long-term stability.

Because the best mix of wind, solar, hydroelectric, and nuclear power differs by region, federal planning shall support regionally tailored generation mixes connected by interregional transmission. Public investment shall aim to lower the cost and increase the supply of clean energy.

20.5 Advanced Nuclear Deployment [Statute – High Resistance]

Advanced nuclear technologies may play a critical role in achieving:

- Long-term energy security
- Grid reliability
- Low-emission electricity generation

Federal policy shall support:

- Research
- Demonstration projects
- Licensing modernization
- Workforce development

while maintaining strong safety standards.

Honest limit: Nuclear projects have a long history of cost overruns and delays, and advanced reactor designs have little commercial operating history in the United States. Faster licensing must not weaken safety review, and the country still has no permanent solution for storing nuclear waste.

20.6 Critical Clean Energy Infrastructure [Statute – High Resistance]

Nationally significant energy infrastructure shall be eligible for the coordinated review in Section 21.9, which reduces duplication and delay without weakening environmental or safety review. Eligible projects may include:

- Interstate transmission systems
- Advanced nuclear facilities
- Strategic energy infrastructure

Honest limit: Interstate transmission lines cross many states and private properties. Coordinated federal review does not remove state siting authority, and giving the federal government backstop siting power would face strong opposition from states. Approved projects can still be delayed by litigation.

20.7 Conservation & Environmental Stewardship [Statute]

Federal conservation policy shall emphasize:

- Clean water
- Healthy soil
- Wildlife habitat
- Forest health
- Watershed protection

Whenever possible, federal programs should promote voluntary participation and partnership rather than command-and-control regulation.

Chapter 21: Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains

21.1 Guiding Principle

Infrastructure and productive capacity are the foundations of national prosperity.

Markets create growth, but growth depends upon reliable transportation networks, energy systems, communications infrastructure, supply chains, and productive industrial capacity.

A modern economy requires both.

21.2 National Infrastructure & Strategic Capacity Act [Statute]

Federal policy shall support long-term investment in infrastructure and productive capacity necessary for future economic growth.

21.2.1 National Infrastructure Renewal Program

Investment priorities include:

- Roads
- Bridges
- Ports
- Airports
- Freight rail
- Inland waterways
- Public transit
- Water systems
- Wastewater infrastructure

Infrastructure spending should emphasize long-term maintenance and modernization.

21.2.2 State Partnership Framework

Federal programs should operate through cooperative state and local partnerships whenever practical.

Funding decisions shall be guided by:

- Need
- Economic impact
- Safety
- Resilience

rather than political considerations.

21.3 Grid Modernization & Energy Reliability [Statute]

The electrical grid shall be modernized to improve:

- Reliability
- Capacity
- Cybersecurity
- Interregional connectivity
- Disaster resilience

Priority shall be given to projects improving national energy stability.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 20 Climate & Energy.

21.4 Public Community Internet [Statute – High Resistance]

States may not prohibit municipalities from constructing or operating public broadband infrastructure.

Communities shall retain the right to establish publicly owned broadband services whenever local residents determine such systems are necessary.

Broadband access shall be treated as essential economic infrastructure.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

Honest limit: Overriding state bans on municipal broadband raises federalism objections. A federal appeals court held in 2016 that existing federal law did not clearly allow the Federal Communications Commission to preempt such bans, so the statute must state preemption expressly. Some municipal networks have struggled financially, leaving local taxpayers with debt.

21.5 Strategic Industrial Capacity Initiative [Statute – High Resistance]

The United States shall maintain domestic capabilities in strategically important industries.

Priority sectors include:

- Semiconductors
- Biotechnology
- Pharmaceuticals
- Aerospace
- Robotics
- Advanced manufacturing

- Nuclear technologies

The objective is resilience rather than economic isolation.

21.5.1 Competitive Neutrality Principle

Government support shall remain open to firms of varying size whenever possible.

Industrial policy should strengthen competition rather than entrench existing monopolies.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 9 Competition & Consumer Rights.

Honest limit: Industrial support can pay firms for investments they would have made anyway, or back projects that fail. Despite the competitive-neutrality principle, support tends to flow to established firms with the capacity to apply. Trading partners may treat subsidies as unfair, and results depend on commitments that must outlast any one administration.

21.6 Supply Chain Resilience Program [Statute]

Federal agencies shall identify vulnerabilities within supply chains affecting:

- National security
- Public health
- Food security
- Energy reliability
- Manufacturing

The government may support:

- Strategic reserves
- Diversified sourcing
- Domestic production capacity

when excessive dependence creates national risk.

This section is the central supply-chain program. Sections 21.6.1, 11.2.4, and 22.6 apply it to domestic sourcing, trade treatment, and emergency reserves.

21.6.1 Strategic Domestic Production [Statute]

Critical emergency supplies shall maintain domestic production capacity. The list of critical supplies shall be narrow and statutorily defined, recommended by a technical office at the national laboratories using a published method rather than by industry petition, issued by rule subject to congressional review, required to meet the Strategic Protection Test, and aligned with the vulnerability reviews in Section 21.6 and the reserves in Section 22.6.

21.7 Workforce Development Partnership [Statute]

Infrastructure and industrial investment shall be coordinated with workforce development.

Programs may include:

- Apprenticeships
- Community-college partnerships
- Trade certification programs
- Employer-sponsored training

Cross-reference: See Chapter 3 Work, Wages & Family.

21.8 Domestic Production Preference [Statute]

Federal projects receiving major public support should prioritize domestic production whenever:

- Quality remains competitive
- Price differences remain reasonable
- Supply needs can be met

The goal is strengthening domestic productive capacity while maintaining competition. Preferences under this section shall meet the Strategic Protection Test.

Cross-reference: Section 21.6 is the central supply-chain program.

21.9 National Permitting Reform [Statute – High Resistance]

Major infrastructure projects shall receive coordinated review procedures supported by funded permitting staff. This section is the platform's single permitting rule; Sections 8.1.2 and 20.6 apply it to housing and to energy infrastructure.

One Project, One Review

Federal agencies shall coordinate reviews to reduce duplication while preserving:

- Environmental protections
- Public safety standards
- Property-right protections

Environmental and safety reviews shall not be weakened, and public participation shall be preserved. Delays shall be reduced through funded permitting staff, coordinated agency review, and clear timelines, not by narrowing the scope of review.

Efficient permitting is not the same as weaker standards.

Honest limit: Coordinated review with funded staff speeds approvals less than narrowing the scope of review would, and this section deliberately does not narrow it or limit judicial review,

so litigation after approval can still cause delay. Faster permitting depends on sustained funding for permitting staff.

Chapter 22: Disaster Resilience & Emergency Preparedness

22.1 Guiding Principle

The most effective disaster response begins before disaster strikes.

Preparedness, resilience, and mitigation save lives, reduce economic damage, and improve recovery outcomes.

Federal disaster policy should focus on both response and prevention.

22.2 National Resilience & Emergency Preparedness Act [Statute]

The United States shall maintain the capacity to prepare for, respond to, and recover from major emergencies.

Covered events include:

- Natural disasters
- Pandemics
- Cyberattacks
- Infrastructure failures
- Supply-chain disruptions
- National emergencies

22.3 National Risk Assessment Program [Statute]

Federal agencies shall maintain continuous assessments of major national risks.

Assessments shall guide:

- Resource allocation
- Preparedness planning
- Infrastructure investment
- Interagency coordination

22.4 Critical Infrastructure Resilience Initiative [Statute]

Priority sectors include:

- Energy
- Water

- Transportation
- Communications
- Healthcare
- Data systems

Infrastructure planning shall emphasize redundancy and continuity.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

22.5 Disaster Mitigation First Policy [Statute]

Federal programs should prioritize projects that reduce future disaster costs.

Eligible activities include:

- Flood protection
- Wildfire mitigation
- Storm hardening
- Earthquake retrofits
- Coastal resilience

Prevention Investment Standard

Mitigation investments should be favored when evidence demonstrates long-term cost savings relative to repeated recovery expenditures.

22.6 Emergency Supply Reserve System [Statute]

The federal government shall maintain strategic reserves of critical emergency supplies.

Priority categories include:

- Medical equipment
- Essential medications
- Fuel reserves
- Communications equipment
- Water-treatment supplies

Regular inventory rotation shall ensure readiness.

Reserve categories shall align with the critical-supplies list in Section 21.6.1 and the vulnerability findings under Section 21.6.

22.7 Public Health Emergency Preparedness [Statute]

Permanent preparedness capabilities shall include:

- Medical surge capacity
- Laboratory readiness
- Vaccine infrastructure
- Emergency logistics systems
- Public-health workforce development

Cross-reference: See Chapter 5 Universal Health Insurance.

22.8 Rapid Disaster Response Framework [Statute]

Certain emergency declarations may trigger automatic deployment of:

- Search-and-rescue assets
- Emergency logistics
- Temporary housing support
- Medical assistance
- Infrastructure-repair funding

The objective is reducing bureaucratic delays during crises.

22.9 Community Resilience Partnerships [Statute]

Federal grants shall support local preparedness efforts.

Eligible projects include:

- Emergency planning
- Evacuation systems
- Shelter facilities
- Backup power systems
- Communications modernization

Local communities often possess the strongest understanding of regional risks.

22.10 Build Back Stronger Standard [Statute]

Federal reconstruction programs shall incorporate resilience improvements whenever practical.

The objective is reducing repeated losses rather than repeatedly rebuilding vulnerable infrastructure in the same manner.

22.11 Continuity of Government Standards [Statute]

Federal agencies shall maintain plans ensuring continuation of critical functions during emergencies.

Priority functions include:

- Public safety
- Benefit administration
- Health coordination
- Financial-system stability
- National security operations

PART VIII: SECURITY & GLOBAL LEADERSHIP

Chapter 23: Foreign Policy & Diplomacy

23.1 Guiding Principle

Lasting security is built not only through military strength, but through diplomacy, partnership, economic cooperation, and mutual trust.

The United States should seek a world in which more nations view America as a trusted partner than as an adversary.

Military power remains an essential instrument of national defense, but diplomacy should remain the first instrument of foreign policy whenever practical.

23.2 Defensive Foreign Policy [Statute / Executive]

The United States shall maintain military capabilities sufficient to:

- Defend the nation
- Protect allies
- Secure global trade
- Deter aggression

The nation shall end foreign regime-change operations and shall reduce reliance on:

- Long-term occupations
- Open-ended military engagements

whenever practical.

Forward Presence & Burden-Sharing

No new permanent overseas military base shall be established without congressional authorization. Allies shall share defense burdens through periodic burden-sharing reviews, and the Department of Defense shall report to Congress at regular intervals on global force posture, including where maritime and over-the-horizon capabilities can substitute for forward presence. Ending regime-change operations is a core commitment that does not depend on force-posture decisions.

Peace Through Strength

Military strength exists primarily to prevent war, not seek it.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 24 Defense.

23.3 Diplomacy First Framework [Statute]

The United States shall prioritize:

- Diplomacy
- Conflict prevention
- Alliance management
- Economic cooperation
- Peaceful dispute resolution

before the use of military force.

Diplomacy First Principle

Military action should remain available when necessary, but policymakers should exhaust reasonable diplomatic alternatives before resorting to armed conflict.

23.4 Alliance & Strategic Partnership Initiative [Statute]

The United States shall maintain and strengthen alliances with democratic partners around the world.

Priority objectives include:

- Defense cooperation
- Economic cooperation
- Scientific collaboration
- Intelligence sharing
- Joint security planning

Strong alliances reduce the likelihood of conflict and multiply collective security.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 24 Defense.

23.5 Strategic Foreign Assistance Program [Statute]

Foreign assistance should advance both humanitarian values and long-term stability.

Federal foreign-aid programs shall support three primary objectives:

23.5.1 Humanitarian Stability

Programs may support:

- Disaster relief
- Food security
- Refugee assistance
- Clean water access
- Public health initiatives

The objective is reducing human suffering and preventing instability before it becomes crisis.

23.5.2 Economic Development

Programs may support:

- Education
- Workforce development
- Agricultural modernization
- Infrastructure investment
- Disease prevention

Economic development reduces long-term instability and creates future trading partners.

23.5.3 Democratic Resilience

The United States may support initiatives that encourage:

- Transparent governance
- Anti-corruption reforms
- Civil society development
- Independent institutions
- Rule of law

The objective is supporting stable societies rather than imposing political outcomes.

23.5.4 Reproductive Health in Foreign Assistance [Statute – High Resistance]

Since 1973, the Helms Amendment has barred foreign assistance from paying for abortion "as a method of family planning," and it has been applied as a total ban, even after rape or incest or when a patient's life is at risk. Separately, the Mexico City Policy, which each administration since 1985 has rescinded or reinstated by executive action, bars foreign organizations that receive U.S. aid from providing or discussing abortion with their own funds. In January 2026 it was expanded through three final rules to most non-military foreign assistance and to new subjects beyond abortion, reaching as much as $39.8 billion in aid and almost 2,600 prime recipients [1][2]. This section ends both policies by statute, on terms consistent with Chapter 6.

- **Helms repeal.** Section 104(f) of the Foreign Assistance Act of 1961 and the corresponding provision of the annual foreign operations appropriations act shall be repealed.
- **Host-country law.** Foreign assistance may fund abortion services only where the law of the host country permits them. Post-abortion care and emergency treatment remain eligible regardless of the legal status of abortion under host-country law.
- **No global gag rule.** The United States shall not condition eligibility for foreign assistance on an organization's lawful speech, advocacy, counseling, referral practices, or provision of health services conducted with non-United States funds where those activities are lawful under the laws of the host country. No future policy of the Mexico City type may be adopted by executive action. The prohibition follows the Appendix C approach of writing major rules into statute rather than leaving them to reversible executive discretion.
- **Anti-coercion rule (Kemp-Kasten).** The bar on funding any organization that supports or participates in coercive abortion or involuntary sterilization is kept. A decision to cut off an organization under it shall rest on published evidence, with written reasons and notice to Congress (Appendix C).
- **Lobbying rule (Siljander).** The bar on using aid funds to lobby for or against abortion is kept. It applies equally in both directions.
- **Protection from annual riders.** Restrictions on lawful reproductive health services funded through foreign assistance may be enacted only through amendment of the Foreign Assistance Act and not through annual appropriations riders. A Senate point of order shall enforce this rule.

Interim executive steps. Until the statute is enacted, the executive branch shall, on its first day:

- apply the Helms Amendment as written, so that it no longer bars funding for abortion after rape or incest, when, in reasonable medical judgment, the patient's life or physical or mental health is at risk (the standard in Section 6.2.1), or for post-abortion care, subject to the host-country law rule above;
- begin rescinding the three 2026 foreign assistance rules (Protecting Life in Foreign Assistance, Combating Gender Ideology in Foreign Assistance, and Combating

Discriminatory Equity Ideology in Foreign Assistance). Because they were issued as final rules, their repeal requires notice-and-comment rulemaking and will take months.

Durability comes from the statute, not from executive action.

Funding. These provisions operate within existing foreign assistance appropriations and have no cost under Chapter 27.

Honest limits.

- **Helms has outlasted every Congress since 1973,** including those that supported abortion rights. Repeal faces more resistance than ending the Hyde Amendment, and will be described as spending tax dollars on abortion abroad.
- **The host-country rule limits reach.** In countries that ban abortion, U.S. aid will not fund it, even after rape. The platform accepts that limit to respect the law of the countries it works with.
- **A future Congress can still add a rider** by waiving the point of order.
- **The 2026 rules remain in force until rescinded,** and repeal through rulemaking will be challenged.

Sources for this section:

[1] KFF, "The Mexico City Policy: An Explainer" (2026). https://www.kff.org/global-health-policy/issue-brief/the-mexico-city-policy-an-explainer/

[2] Council on Foundations, "Mexico City Policy and Philanthropy" (April 2026). https://cof.org/sites/default/files/2026-04/Mexico%20City%20Policy%20and%20Philanthropy.pdf

23.6 Accountability Standards for Foreign Assistance [Statute]

All major aid programs shall include:

- Performance metrics
- Independent audits
- Transparency reporting
- Outcome evaluations

Foreign assistance should be held to the same accountability standards expected of domestic programs.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 14 Government Effectiveness.

23.7 Friendship Through Partnership Principle

People who experience American assistance, cooperation, and goodwill are more likely to become future partners than future adversaries.

Economic cooperation, educational exchanges, scientific partnerships, and humanitarian assistance can strengthen international relationships while advancing American interests.

23.8 International Scientific & Educational Cooperation [Statute]

The United States shall encourage peaceful international collaboration involving:

- Scientific research
- Medical innovation
- Educational exchanges
- Space exploration
- Technology development

Such cooperation promotes both security and prosperity.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18.

Chapter 24: Defense

24.1 Guiding Principle

The United States shall maintain the world's most capable defensive military while ensuring responsible stewardship of public resources.

Military strength is essential to:

- Deterring aggression
- Protecting allies
- Preserving freedom of navigation
- Defending national sovereignty

Defense spending should prioritize capability and readiness rather than political favoritism.

24.2 Military Readiness, Modernization & Strategic Procurement Act [Statute – High Resistance]

Defense procurement shall emphasize:

- Military effectiveness
- Technological superiority
- Operational readiness
- Cost accountability

24.2.1 Military Capability First Doctrine

Procurement decisions should prioritize measurable capability and mission effectiveness.

Weapons systems should be evaluated according to performance rather than political considerations.

24.2.2 Competitive Defense Acquisition Reform

The Department of Defense shall maximize competition whenever practical.

Competitive Procurement Standard

Major acquisition programs should utilize competitive bidding processes.

Sole-Source Transparency

Contracts awarded without competition shall require public justification whenever national security permits.

24.2.3 Defense Cost Overrun Accountability

Programs experiencing significant:

- Cost overruns
- Performance failures
- Schedule delays

shall automatically undergo independent review.

Potential remedies include:

- Restructuring
- Re-competition
- Program cancellation

Honest limit: Defense acquisition reform has been attempted many times with limited lasting effect. Major programs are often spread across many congressional districts, which makes cancellation politically difficult, and automatic independent review can identify failures but cannot by itself overcome that resistance. Many systems have only one qualified supplier, which limits competition.

24.3 Defense Industrial Base Resilience [Statute]

The United States shall maintain domestic production capacity for strategically important defense industries.

Priority sectors include:

- Shipbuilding
- Aerospace
- Electronics

- Semiconductors
- Munitions
- Critical minerals

These defense sectors are covered by the national supply-chain program (Section 21.6) and the strategic industrial capacity initiative (Section 21.5); this section sets defense-specific priorities only. Sourcing requirements under this section shall meet the Strategic Protection Test.

24.4 Rapid Technology Adoption Program [Statute]

The Department of Defense shall accelerate adoption of technologies including:

- Artificial intelligence
- Robotics
- Advanced manufacturing
- Cybersecurity
- Space systems
- Quantum technologies

Innovation should not become trapped in bureaucratic acquisition processes.

24.5 Startup & Small Contractor Competition Initiative [Statute]

Federal procurement shall create pathways allowing innovative small businesses to compete for defense contracts.

Programs may include:

- Prototype projects
- Demonstration programs
- Innovation grants
- Accelerated procurement channels

The objective is increasing innovation and competition.

24.6 Military Logistics & Readiness Modernization [Statute]

Readiness planning shall emphasize:

- Supply-chain resilience
- Fuel security
- Transportation capacity

- Maintenance readiness
- Cyber resilience

A modern military depends upon logistics as much as weapon systems.

24.7 Cyber Defense & Digital Security Program [Statute – High Resistance]

The federal government shall continuously strengthen military cyber capabilities.

Priority areas include:

- Network defense
- Supply-chain security
- Communications protection
- Infrastructure coordination

Cybersecurity is now a core national-defense requirement.

Honest limit: Military cyber capability depends on recruiting and keeping specialists who can earn more in the private sector. Most critical infrastructure is privately owned, so its defense depends on cooperation the government cannot fully compel.

24.8 Space Security & Resilience Initiative [Statute – High Resistance]

Space-based systems support:

- Navigation
- Communications
- Weather forecasting
- Missile warning
- Intelligence systems

Federal policy shall ensure their resilience and continuity.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

Honest limit: A growing share of space systems is owned by commercial providers, so resilience depends on contracts and international norms that remain unsettled. Debris from any conflict in space could damage the satellites of every nation.

24.9 Service Member Quality of Life Standard [Statute]

Military readiness depends upon talented personnel.

Federal policy shall prioritize:

- Housing quality

- Healthcare access
- Family support services
- Education opportunities
- Transition assistance

for service members and military families.

24.10 Veterans Skills Transition Program [Statute]

Military training and certifications shall receive recognition within civilian workforce systems whenever practical.

Cross-reference: See Section 3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform.

24.11 Strategic Deterrence Principle

The purpose of military strength is preserving peace through deterrence.

Military power should defend national interests and allies while avoiding unnecessary intervention and open-ended nation-building commitments.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 23 Foreign Policy & Diplomacy.

24.12 Defense Budget Level [Statute]

Defense spending shall be held roughly constant in real, inflation-adjusted terms. Savings from procurement reform under Section 24.2 shall be reinvested in readiness and service-member quality of life, and shall not be counted as financing for other programs in this platform (Chapter 27).

Chapter 25: National Service

Funding role: national service is a fixed-budget General Fund program. It continues at current-law levels and expands only after tier 1 is fully funded, within a statutory ceiling (Section 27.9).

25.1 Guiding Principle

Strong nations are built by engaged citizens.

Government can provide opportunity.

Markets can create prosperity.

But communities thrive only when citizens actively contribute to the common good.

National service should strengthen civic trust, build skills, and foster shared responsibility.

Participation shall remain entirely voluntary.

25.2 National Service & Civic Engagement Act [Statute]

The federal government shall support voluntary service opportunities designed to strengthen communities while expanding educational and career opportunities.

The purpose of service is not compulsory labor.

The purpose is creating opportunities for citizens to contribute while developing skills and experience.

25.3 American Service Corps [Statute]

A voluntary national-service framework shall provide opportunities in:

- Disaster response
- Environmental conservation
- Infrastructure projects
- Education support
- Public-health outreach
- Elder care
- Community development
- Veterans assistance

Programs may operate through partnerships with:

- Nonprofits
- State governments
- Local governments
- Tribal governments
- Educational institutions

25.4 Service Scholarship Benefit [Statute]

Individuals successfully completing approved service terms shall receive flexible education and career benefits. Because tuition at public colleges, universities, and trade schools is covered under Section 7.3, benefits may be used for:

- Living costs while enrolled, such as housing, food, books, and transportation
- Apprenticeships and professional certifications
- Graduate or professional study
- Repayment of existing student loans

Educational Opportunity Principle

National service should expand opportunity rather than replace traditional educational pathways.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 7 Education.

25.5 Living Allowance Framework [Statute]

Full-time service participants shall receive:

- Living stipends
- Healthcare coverage through Universal Health Insurance (Chapter 5)
- Transportation support when necessary
- Housing assistance where appropriate

Compensation should support participation without transforming service into a conventional employment program.

25.6 Disaster Response Reserve Corps [Statute]

A specialized service track shall support Chapter 22 Disaster Resilience objectives.

Participants may receive training in:

- Emergency communications
- Shelter management
- Logistics support
- Disaster recovery
- Community resilience planning

Cross-reference: See Chapter 22 Disaster Resilience & Emergency Preparedness.

25.7 Conservation & Public Lands Corps [Statute]

Participants may contribute to projects involving:

- Reforestation
- Trail maintenance
- Habitat restoration
- Watershed improvement
- Wildfire mitigation
- Public-land stewardship

The program strengthens both environmental conservation and local economic development.

25.8 Community Health & Care Corps [Statute]

Participants may assist organizations involved in:

- Elder care
- Disability services
- Public-health outreach
- Community health initiatives
- Mental-health support programs

Service members shall supplement, not replace, trained professionals.

25.9 Infrastructure & Skilled Trades Track [Statute]

Service opportunities may include:

- Broadband deployment
- Housing rehabilitation
- Infrastructure maintenance
- Energy-efficiency projects
- Water-system upgrades

Participation may count toward apprenticeship requirements where appropriate.

Cross-reference: See Chapters 3 and 21.

25.10 Civic Leadership Fellowship Program [Statute]

Outstanding participants may compete for fellowships supporting careers in:

- Public administration
- Education
- Scientific research
- Emergency management
- Community development

The objective is cultivating future civic leaders.

25.11 National Unity Principle

National service should bring Americans together across:

- Geographic differences

- Economic backgrounds
- Cultural communities
- Political affiliations

The purpose is strengthening civic bonds and reinforcing the idea that citizenship carries both rights and responsibilities.

PART IX: LONG-TERM SUSTAINABILITY

Chapter 26: Social Security & Retirement Security

Aligned with the white paper Social Security Solvency: A Proposal for Long-Term Retirement Security *(decisions 0001, 0009, 0010).*

26.1 Guiding Principle

Social Security is one of the most successful anti-poverty programs in American history.

Its long-term solvency should be secured without:

- Raising the retirement age
- Reducing earned benefits
- Shifting excessive costs onto future generations

Retirement security is a foundational component of economic stability. Social Security's purpose is to keep retired Americans out of poverty, not to replace very high earnings.

26.2 Social Security Solvency Overhaul [Statute]

The federal government shall strengthen Social Security through revenue reforms rather than benefit reductions.

The purpose is ensuring sustainable benefits for future retirees while preserving commitments made to current beneficiaries.

26.2.1 Elimination of the Payroll Tax Cap

The Social Security payroll tax cap shall be eliminated, so that all covered earnings are subject to contributions rather than only earnings up to the taxable maximum. Medicare's Hospital Insurance payroll tax already applies to all earnings, providing a precedent. Treatment of the employer's share shall be specified in implementing legislation.

26.2.2 No Additional Benefits Above the Taxable Maximum

Earnings above the taxable maximum shall not increase Social Security benefits. Benefits shall continue to be calculated only on earnings up to the taxable maximum, which shall continue to rise each year with average wage growth as under current law.

This is a deliberate financing choice: contributions above the maximum support a program whose purpose is preventing poverty in old age, without adding future benefit obligations. Economists and policymakers may reasonably disagree about whether those contributions are best described as social-insurance financing, progressive taxation, or both.

26.2.3 Protected Middle-Income Structure

No payroll-tax rate increase shall apply to earnings at or below the taxable maximum. Additional financing shall come from earnings above it, protecting:

- Middle-income workers
- Small-business employees
- Working families

26.3 Pass-Through & Business Income Reform [Statute]

High-income individuals should not be able to avoid Social Security contributions through accounting structures.

Pass-Through Net

Business income from:

- Partnerships
- S-Corporations
- Sole Proprietorships

shall be subject to contributions on the same basis as wages, regardless of legal structure.

Anti-Sheltering Rule

Structures designed primarily to avoid Social Security contributions shall face corrective taxation.

26.4 Social Security Endowment [Statute]

A supplemental Social Security Endowment shall be funded only from revenue raised by the reforms in Sections 26.2 and 26.3 that exceeds what is needed to pay scheduled benefits and maintain required trust-fund reserves. If no such excess exists, the Endowment shall not be funded. Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue shall not be used for the Endowment (Section 27.3).

The Endowment shall supplement, not replace, payroll financing, and shall operate under strict rules:

- **Independent management:** investment decisions insulated from routine political pressure through a passive mandate fixed in statute.
- **Broad index investing:** assets held in diversified market index funds rather than politically directed investments.

- **Non-voting ownership:** the government shall not acquire control of private companies through Endowment holdings.
- **Transparency:** annual reports, performance and cost disclosures, and independent audits.

Because the trust funds now hold only special Treasury securities, investing Endowment assets in market index funds requires authorizing legislation.

Long-Term Compound Growth Principle

The purpose of investment is to increase long-term trust-fund resilience while avoiding government control over private companies.

26.5 Retirement Age and Means Testing [Statute]

The full retirement age shall remain at its current level of 67, with no further increase. Gains in life expectancy have not been shared equally, and workers in physically demanding occupations often cannot extend their careers.

No new means test shall reduce benefits based on income or wealth. Social Security already replaces a larger share of earnings for lower earners, and higher-income retirees pay income tax on up to 85 percent of their benefits. Every covered worker shall continue to contribute and to receive a benefit.

26.6 Honest Limit

These reforms have not yet been scored by Social Security's Office of the Chief Actuary. Past scoring suggests that eliminating the cap without crediting the added earnings toward benefits would close roughly half of the current 75-year deficit of 4.42 percent of taxable payroll. This platform therefore does not claim full solvency until the reforms are scored. How to close any remaining gap without benefit cuts or a higher retirement age is presented as an open question for economists and actuaries in the white paper.

26.7 Retirement Security Principle

Economic dignity should not end when work ends.

Citizens who contribute throughout their lives should have confidence that Social Security will remain stable, reliable, and available for future generations.

Chapter 27: Master Financing Framework

This chapter is the single authority for every revenue and spending rule in the platform. Decision records: 0004–0008.

27.1 Guiding Principle

A platform is only as credible as its funding. Every major commitment in this document shall have an identified source of revenue, an independent cost estimate, and a realistic implementation sequence.

Two rules follow. Each source of revenue shall be assigned to exactly one use, so that no dollar is promised twice. Recurring obligations shall be paid only from stable revenue; revenue that

swings with markets or shrinks over time shall pay only for reserves, one-time investments, or time-limited programs.

27.2 Funding Source Requirement [Statute]

Before any major new program in this platform takes effect, an independent cost estimate and its assigned revenue stream under Section 27.3 shall be published. Programs shall be sequenced so that new obligations do not outpace identified revenue.

27.3 Revenue Assignment Rule [Statute]

Each revenue stream shall be dedicated to the single use listed below. No revenue stream shall be counted toward more than one use, and no program shall claim a stream assigned elsewhere.

Revenue stream	Behavior	Single use
Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax (Section 2.1), including shares paid in kind under Section 2.2	Swings with markets	Sovereign Wealth Reserve, under Section 27.5
Federal tax fairness measures: capital gains taxed as ordinary income above a high-income threshold, restored top income-tax brackets, a strengthened corporate minimum tax, and estate-tax reform (Sections 2.6 to 2.10; proposed rates subject to scoring)	Stable	General Fund, for the recurring programs listed in Section 27.4
Universal Health Insurance contributions: payroll, employer, and income-based (Section 5.1)	Stable	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund
State contributions under the Universal Health Insurance Partnership Compact (Section 4.7.3)	Stable	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund
Savings from consolidated health financing	Stable once realized	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund, by lowering contribution rates
A fixed statutory share of savings from national drug-price negotiation	Stable	Dynamic Global Innovation Fund (Section 5.2); only the remaining savings are counted in health-cost estimates

Revenue stream	Behavior	Single use
Paid leave contribution, shared equally by employers and employees, on wages up to its wage base (Section 3.3)	Stable	Paid Leave Trust Fund
Social Security payroll reforms (Sections 26.2 and 26.3)	Stable	Social Security trust funds; any revenue beyond scheduled benefits and required reserves goes to the Social Security Endowment (Section 26.4)
Social Security Endowment investment returns	Swings with markets	Social Security trust funds
Carbon and methane fees, 80 percent	Shrinks over time	Equal per-person household dividend (Section 20.2.1)
Carbon and methane fees, 10 percent	Shrinks over time	Transition Fund, which shall end on a date fixed in statute (Section 20.2.2)
Carbon and methane fees, 10 percent	Shrinks over time	General Fund, for one-time or time-limited costs only
Carbon Border Protection Tariff receipts (Section 20.3)	Shrinks over time	Equal per-person household dividend
Strategic tariffs (Section 11.2.2)	Unpredictable	General Fund; never counted as platform financing
Recovered fraud and improper payments (Section 14.4)	Unpredictable	Returned to the program they came from; not counted as platform revenue
Borrowing	—	Long-lived productive assets only, under Section 27.7

27.4 Program Funding Map [Statute]

Each major program shall draw only on the stream listed here. Independent cost estimates shall be published under Section 27.10 before each program takes effect.

Program	Recurring or one-time	Funded by
Universal Health Insurance, including rural stabilization and the Medicaid transition	Recurring	Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund

Program	Recurring or one-time	Funded by
Income security: SSI rules, SNAP changes, Earned Income Tax Credit, Child Tax Credit (Chapter 4)	Recurring	General Fund (tax fairness measures), first in the phase-in order (Section 27.9)
Universal Adjustment Assistance training grants and triggered apprenticeship expansion (Sections 3.6.7 to 3.6.9)	Recurring, capped	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 1, step 4 (Section 27.9)
Wage insurance (Section 3.6.7)	Recurring	Unemployment trust funds
Expanded Disabled Access Credit (Section 13.5.1)	Recurring	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 1 (Section 27.9)
Federal officer judgments and settlements (Section 16.9.2)	As incurred	Judgment Fund, repaid by the responsible agency from its own appropriations
Civil Rights Risk Reduction Grants (Section 16.13)	Recurring, capped	Within existing authorized policing grant appropriations; no new appropriation and no Section 27.9 phase-in obligation
Civil rights enforcement staff (Section 13.8)	Recurring	General Fund, within capped and scored base appropriations
Disability Insurance earnings offset (Section 4.6.3)	Recurring	Social Security trust funds
Regular unemployment insurance (Section 4.4)	Recurring	Unemployment trust funds
Extended unemployment benefits in recessions (Section 4.4.4)	Triggered by recession	Sovereign Wealth Reserve (Section 27.5)
Dynamic Global Innovation Fund	Recurring, capped	Share of drug-negotiation savings
Paid leave (Section 3.3)	Recurring	Paid Leave Trust Fund (dedicated payroll contribution); never the General Fund

Program	Recurring or one-time	Funded by
Childcare and eldercare cost caps (Section 3.4)	Recurring	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 2 (Section 27.9)
Universal preschool, K-12 equity funding, tuition-free public higher education	Recurring	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tiers 2 and 3 (Section 27.9)
Existing student-loan reform	One-time, phased	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 3 (Section 27.9)
Housing vouchers for people experiencing or at imminent risk of homelessness (Section 8.3.3)	Recurring	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 2, first (Section 27.9)
Emergency rental assistance and right to counsel in evictions (Section 8.3.6)	Recurring; triggered increases within one capped amount	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 2, second (Section 27.9)
Universal housing vouchers (Section 8.3.3)	Recurring	General Fund (tax fairness measures), tier 4 (Section 27.9)
Public housing developer operations, state rent stabilization grants, and other housing programs (Sections 8.1 and 8.2.6)	Recurring, capped	General Fund (tax fairness measures), fixed-budget rules (Section 27.9)
Public housing and research facility construction	One-time	Capital Investment Account (Section 27.5) and productive borrowing (Section 27.7)
Research expansion and national service	Recurring, capped	General Fund (tax fairness measures), fixed-budget rules (Section 27.9)
National Farm Risk Protection Program enhancements (current crop insurance unchanged)	Recurring, capped	General Fund (tax fairness measures), fixed-budget rules (Section 27.9)
Infrastructure, grid, and public broadband	One-time	Productive borrowing and the 10 percent carbon General Fund share
Transition Fund	Time-limited	10 percent carbon Transition share

Program	Recurring or one-time	Funded by
Household dividend	Ongoing while fees are collected	80 percent carbon share and border tariff receipts

27.5 Sovereign Wealth Reserve [Statute]

The Sovereign Wealth Reserve (Section 1.3) shall exist only to stabilize the economy in recessions.

- **Funding:** all Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue shall be deposited in the Reserve until its stabilization balance reaches a target fixed in statute as a share of GDP.
- **Above the target:** further deposits shall go to a Capital Investment Account, which may fund one-time capital projects, and debt service on borrowing for long-lived assets under Section 27.7, but never recurring programs.
- **Investment:** assets shall be held in broad, passive index funds managed by private managers selected through competitive bidding, with no voting rights in any company.
- **Drawing:** the stabilization balance may be drawn only when the recession trigger in Section 1.2 is met. Draws shall first pay for automatic extended unemployment benefits (Section 4.4.4); any remainder may fund only temporary stabilization measures enacted for that downturn.
- **Refilling:** once recovery is confirmed under Section 1.2, deposits shall restore the balance to its target before anything goes to the Capital Investment Account.
- **No other claims:** apart from the uses listed under Drawing, no program, fund, or endowment may draw on the Reserve.

27.6 Funded Spending Cap [Statute]

The baseline spending cap in Section 1.2 may rise only by the independently scored revenue that a newly enacted program brings with it under Section 27.3.

27.7 Borrowing Rule [Statute]

Borrowing may finance long-lived productive assets, such as infrastructure, grid and transmission, public housing, and research facilities. Borrowing shall not finance recurring obligations. Debt service on such borrowing is paid through the Capital Investment Account (Section 27.5), is not a General Fund phase-in item, and limits new borrowing to what the account can service.

27.8 No Double Counting [Statute]

Each dollar of revenue or savings shall be counted once. Cost estimates shall show net figures. For example, Universal Health Insurance estimates shall count only the drug-negotiation savings that remain after the Innovation Fund's share.

27.9 Phased Implementation [Statute]

Programs shall be phased in by feasibility: first low-cost statutory reforms (such as voter registration, cannabis legalization, and anti-corruption measures), then revenue measures, and finally the largest new programs (health insurance, childcare, tuition-free higher education, K-12 equity funding, student loan reform, and expanded farm risk protection). No program in the

final group shall take effect until the revenue assigned to it has been enacted and independently scored.

General Fund priority order. Recurring programs paid from the General Fund shall be phased in in this order, and no program in a later tier shall take effect before every program in the earlier tiers is fully funded:

1. **Income security (Chapter 4)**, in this order:
   - SSI asset and income rules, and the SNAP changes;
   - the Earned Income Tax Credit for workers without children;
   - the Child Tax Credit;
   - training grants under Universal Adjustment Assistance and any triggered apprenticeship expansion, within one capped amount (Sections 3.6.7 to 3.6.9);
   - alongside these, the expanded Disabled Access Credit for small businesses (Section 13.5.1), paired with the digital accessibility deadlines.
2. **Housing and early childhood**, in this order:
   - housing vouchers for people experiencing or at imminent risk of homelessness (Section 8.3.3);
   - emergency rental assistance and the right to counsel in eviction cases (Section 8.3.6);
   - universal preschool and the childcare cost caps (Sections 7.1 and 3.4);
   - the eldercare cost caps (Section 3.4).
3. **Higher education and K-12**, in this order:
   - tuition-free public higher education (Section 7.3);
   - existing student-loan reform (Section 7.3.1);
   - K-12 equity funding (Section 7.2.1).
4. **Universal housing vouchers** for extremely low-income renters (Section 8.3.3), phased in by stages.

Fixed-budget programs. Research expansion, national service, the public housing developer's operations, state rent stabilization grants, and the enhancements to the National Farm Risk Protection Program are not ranked in the tiers. They follow these rules:

- each continues at its current-law funding level;
- expansion above current-law levels occurs only after the first tier is fully funded;
- expansion remains subject to a fixed statutory ceiling for each program and to the spending cap in Section 27.6;
- construction of long-lived assets uses the Capital Investment Account (Section 27.5) and the borrowing rule in Section 27.7, and its debt service is paid through that account rather than waiting in the tier order;
- the National Farm Risk Protection Program preserves current-law crop insurance commitments, and only its enhanced benefits are subject to the ceiling.

Paid leave is financed by its own trust fund (Section 3.3) and is not a General Fund program. Appendix B sets out the legislative path for each program. Programs with their own funding

(Universal Health Insurance, Social Security, unemployment insurance) are phased in on their own schedules. Revenue from the loss of tax benefits under the rent stabilization floor (Section 8.2.3) goes to the General Fund and is not assigned to any program.

27.10 Independent Costing [Statute]

The Congressional Budget Office and the Joint Committee on Taxation shall estimate the cost of each major program and the yield of each revenue measure, and the estimates shall be published with the implementing legislation. The Government Accountability Office shall review each major program at least once every ten years (Section 14.2.1).

27.11 Combined Tax Rate Disclosure [Statute]

Each edition of this platform, and each revenue bill implementing it, shall publish the combined top marginal rate on wages, pass-through income, and capital gains, counting income tax, Social Security and Medicare contributions, Universal Health Insurance contributions, and the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax. The current disclosure is the table in Section 2.12. The combined federal rate on wages and self-employment income shall not exceed 60 percent (Section 2.8).

27.12 Honest Limit

Dollar estimates are not yet included in this edition; the costing table is maintained in data/costing.csv and will be filled from published independent estimates. Wealth-tax and carbon revenues are deliberately kept away from recurring programs, so the recurring programs depend on the federal tax fairness measures. Those measures are set out in Chapter 2 (Sections 2.6 to 2.10) as proposed rates. If independent scoring shows less revenue than the recurring programs need, the programs phase in more slowly; the rates do not rise automatically (Section 2.11).

Conclusion

A New Social Contract

The purpose of this platform is neither to replace markets nor to leave every societal challenge to markets alone.

It rejects the false choice between centralized economic control and unrestricted laissez-faire governance.

America's greatest achievements have emerged when public institutions, private enterprise, scientific innovation, and civic participation worked together toward common goals.

The challenges of the twenty-first century demand that same approach.

This platform is built on the belief that prosperity, liberty, and fairness are not competing objectives. When designed intelligently, they reinforce one another.

The Role of Government

Government exists to perform the tasks that individuals and markets cannot effectively accomplish on their own.

Its responsibilities include:

- Protecting constitutional rights
- Maintaining democratic institutions
- Providing public infrastructure
- Ensuring public safety
- Expanding opportunity
- Supporting scientific research
- Preserving fair competition
- Maintaining national security

Government should be:

- Transparent
- Accountable
- Efficient
- Evidence-based
- Financially responsible

The measure of government is not how much it spends or how little it spends.

The measure of government is whether it successfully fulfills its responsibilities to the people.

The Role of Markets

Competitive markets remain the most effective system ever developed for:

- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Investment
- Productivity
- Wealth creation

Markets encourage experimentation, reward success, and allow new ideas to compete with old ones.

This platform embraces private enterprise and free markets.

However, markets function best when:

- Competition exists
- Information is transparent
- Monopolies are restrained
- Workers possess bargaining power
- Consumers possess meaningful choice

The purpose of regulation is not to suppress markets.

The purpose of regulation is to keep markets functioning as markets.

The Value of Opportunity

The greatest resource in any nation is its people.

Economic success should not depend solely upon family wealth, geography, luck, or circumstance.

Every individual should have access to the tools necessary to reach their potential, including:

- Quality healthcare
- Excellent education
- Reliable infrastructure
- Safe communities
- Fair labor standards
- Affordable housing
- Access to opportunity

Opportunity cannot be guaranteed.

But access to opportunity can and should be.

A society that invests in its people invests in its future prosperity.

Science, Knowledge, and Progress

Science is humanity's pursuit of truth.

Every generation benefits from discoveries made by those who came before.

Scientific advancement has:

- Extended life expectancy
- Expanded economic prosperity
- Improved public health
- Increased agricultural productivity
- Enhanced national security
- Expanded human understanding

For this reason, scientific research, technological development, higher education, and exploration should be viewed as investments rather than expenses.

The pursuit of knowledge is both a practical necessity and a moral responsibility to future generations.

Democracy and Public Trust

Democracy depends upon trust.

Trust requires:

- Transparency
- Accountability
- Participation
- Ethical leadership

Citizens must be confident that:

- Elections are fair
- Institutions are honest
- Laws apply equally
- Public officials serve the public interest

Government legitimacy cannot be demanded.

It must be earned.

This platform therefore places special emphasis on democratic reform, anti-corruption measures, public accountability, and civic engagement.

Security Through Strength and Partnership

A secure nation requires more than military power.

Security also depends upon:

- Strong alliances
- Stable infrastructure
- Scientific leadership
- Economic resilience
- Secure supply chains
- Effective disaster preparedness

The United States should remain capable of defending itself and its allies while avoiding unnecessary conflicts and maintaining a strong commitment to diplomacy.

The strongest nations do not choose between strength and cooperation.

They possess both.

Responsibility to Future Generations

Every generation inherits institutions, infrastructure, resources, and freedoms built by those who came before.

Each generation also leaves something behind for those who follow.

This platform recognizes a responsibility to future generations by:

- Maintaining fiscal sustainability
- Protecting Social Security
- Investing in infrastructure
- Preserving environmental resources
- Supporting scientific research
- Strengthening democratic institutions
- Expanding economic opportunity

The purpose of public policy is not merely solving today's problems.

It is preparing the nation for tomorrow's opportunities.

Citizenship and Community

A free society depends upon more than government programs and economic systems.

It depends upon citizens who participate in their communities, contribute to the common good, and accept shared responsibility for the success of the nation.

Through voluntary service, civic engagement, local leadership, and community involvement, individuals strengthen the social fabric that supports democracy itself.

National strength begins at the community level.

Strong communities create a strong nation.

Our Commitment

We believe America can be:

- More prosperous without sacrificing fairness.
- More innovative without abandoning responsibility.
- More secure without sacrificing liberty.
- More competitive without tolerating monopoly power.
- More productive without abandoning working families.
- More diverse without losing national unity.
- More ambitious without sacrificing fiscal discipline.

We believe government can be effective without becoming overbearing.

We believe markets can be competitive without becoming exploitative.

We believe innovation can flourish while maintaining accountability.

We believe economic growth and human dignity can advance together.

Most importantly, we believe the future can be better than the present if institutions, businesses, communities, and citizens work together toward common goals.

Final Statement

This platform is founded on a simple principle:

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

A strong public foundation creates opportunity.

Free and competitive markets create prosperity.

Scientific progress expands what is possible.

Democratic institutions preserve accountability.

Communities provide belonging and purpose.

Together, they create a society that is prosperous, resilient, innovative, free, and just.

Build the foundation. Expand opportunity. Strengthen democracy. Invest in the future. Empower the people.

APPENDIX A: CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENTS REQUIRED

Purpose

Most policies contained within this platform may be enacted through federal legislation or executive action. Certain reforms, however, require amendment of the United States Constitution and therefore demand a substantially higher level of democratic consensus.

This appendix identifies all provisions within the platform that require constitutional amendment and summarizes their purpose.

The inclusion of a constitutional amendment proposal within this platform does not imply immediate enactment. Constitutional amendments should be pursued only through broad public support, democratic deliberation, and constitutional ratification procedures.

Amendment 1: Federal Service Age Limits

Related Provision

Section 12.6 - Age Limit of 68

Proposal

No person shall run for or hold federal elected office after reaching age 68, and federal judges shall retire at age 68.

Purpose

The purpose of this amendment is to:

- Promote leadership renewal
- Expand generational representation
- Encourage long-term institutional adaptability
- Ensure regular opportunities for new leadership

Guiding Principle

Democratic institutions should remain responsive to changing generations while preserving institutional knowledge and stability.

Amendment 2: Democratic Election Finance Reform

Related Provision

Section 12.7 - Campaign Finance & Anti-Corruption

Proposal

Congress and the States shall have the authority to establish reasonable limits on independent political expenditures and campaign financing while preserving:

- Freedom of speech

- Freedom of the press
- Freedom of association
- Legitimate issue advocacy

Purpose

The purpose of this amendment is to:

- Reduce undue financial influence in elections
- Increase public confidence in democratic institutions
- Strengthen political equality
- Enhance transparency and accountability

Guiding Principle

Political influence should derive primarily from citizens rather than the concentration of financial resources.

Future Constitutional Reform Considerations

The following subjects may warrant future national discussion but are not currently proposed as constitutional amendments within this platform:

- Electoral College reform
- Presidential term structure
- An affirmative individual right to vote, to be proposed if courts narrow the statutory protections in Section 13.2 further (Section 13.2.6)
- Congressional representation reform
- Constitutional ethics requirements for federal officeholders
- Constitutional protection for the independence of federal investigations and prosecutions (pursued by statute in Section 15.11; an amendment would be considered only if courts reject that approach)

These issues would require additional public debate and are not incorporated as active amendment proposals within this edition of the platform.

Constitutional Amendment Principles

Constitutional amendments should satisfy the following standards:

Necessity

Amendments should be pursued only when statutory solutions are insufficient.

Democratic Legitimacy

Amendments should reflect broad and durable public support across political, geographic, and demographic boundaries.

Preservation of Liberty

No amendment should weaken fundamental constitutional rights, civil liberties, or democratic protections.

Institutional Stability

Amendments should strengthen the long-term effectiveness, legitimacy, and resilience of American constitutional government.

Constitutional Governance Statement

The Constitution of the United States provides the framework within which democratic self-government operates.

This platform seeks reform through constitutional processes, democratic consensus, and the rule of law.

Constitutional amendments should be rare, carefully considered, and adopted only when necessary to strengthen democratic accountability, equal opportunity, human dignity, and the long-term resilience of the Republic.

The Constitution establishes the framework. Democratic institutions provide accountability. Citizens provide legitimacy. Future generations inherit the results.

APPENDIX B: IMPLEMENTATION & LEGISLATIVE STRATEGY

Purpose

A platform is only as good as its path into law. This appendix sets out how the platform would pass Congress: the Senate rules it would need, the legislative vehicle for each plank, the order of the first year, the limited role of executive action, and how the programs paid from the General Fund are phased in. It is written for the Congress and the Senate as they are, not as advocates might wish them to be.

B.1 The Legislative Constraint

The filibuster. Most legislation needs 60 votes in the Senate to end debate. Calls in 2025 and 2026 to abolish that rule for legislation were not acted on; in September 2026 the Senate majority leader estimated that 25 to 30 senators of his own party favored keeping it [1]. The Senate has already used majority votes to end the 60-vote rule for executive and judicial nominations, so a majority can change the rule for legislation if it chooses.

Budget reconciliation. A reconciliation bill cannot be filibustered, but the Byrd rule limits what it may contain. Every provision must change spending or revenue, and a provision is

struck if its budget effect is "merely incidental" to its policy purpose. Even very large budget effects can fail that test [2]. Reconciliation may not change Social Security, and may not increase the deficit in years after the budget window [3]. The parliamentarian has struck a minimum-wage increase and an immigration overhaul on these grounds [4].

What this means for the platform.

- Chapter 27's rule that every program arrives with its own scored revenue fits reconciliation well. The fiscal core of the platform can pass with 51 votes.
- Social Security reform (Chapter 26) can never pass through reconciliation.
- The democracy, civil rights, reproductive health, and accountability chapters have only a modest budget effect, so they need either 60 votes or the Senate rules reform in Section B.2.

B.2 Senate Rules Reform [Senate Rule]

The Senate shall adopt a standing rule that replaces the 60-vote requirement with a process that lets majorities decide after real debate, while giving the minority a guaranteed voice.

1. **Fully paid-for bills.** A bill that the Congressional Budget Office and the Joint Committee on Taxation score as fully paid for under Section 27.10 may pass by majority vote after a guaranteed period of debate and the amendment votes in rule 3.
2. **All other legislation.** Debate may be ended by a declining threshold: 60 votes after introduction, 57 after a fixed delay, 54 after a second delay, and a simple majority after the final delay. The length of each delay is set by Senate rule.
3. **Minority rights.** Before any final vote, the minority leader receives a guaranteed number of floor amendments, set by Senate rule, and one guaranteed substitute amendment. Each receives a recorded vote, so the rule cannot be satisfied by symbolic amendment opportunities.
4. **Repeal symmetry.** Any bill repealing or substantially reducing a law enacted through the paid-for majority procedure is subject to the same procedure, including its scoring requirement, guaranteed debate, and minority amendment rights. Bills repealing other laws follow the declining threshold in rule 2.
5. **Qualification.** Whether a bill is fully paid for is determined by CBO and Joint Committee on Taxation scoring under Section 27.10, not by the presiding officer or the majority leader.

Why this design. Abolishing the filibuster would let the platform pass, but would also let a later narrow majority repeal Universal Health Insurance in a week. The declining threshold guarantees delay and debate without a permanent veto. The paid-for rule turns Chapter 27's fiscal discipline into procedure: a majority can pass anything, if it pays for it.

How it would be adopted. Changing a standing rule normally takes two-thirds of the Senate. In practice, a majority would have to set a new precedent by majority vote, as both parties did for nominations in 2013 and 2017. Adopting it would require at least 50 senators and the Vice President.

B.3 Legislative Vehicles

Each plank is assigned to one of five paths. The classification tags in each chapter describe the political difficulty; this table describes the route.

Path	What passes this way	Notes
Reconciliation (51 votes)	Federal tax fairness (Chapter 2); income security (Chapter 4); Universal Health Insurance financing and benefits (Chapter 5); housing vouchers and eviction prevention (Section 8.3); the rent stabilization tax conditions (Section 8.2.3); the paid leave trust fund (Section 3.3); student-loan reform (Section 7.3.1)	Each program travels with its revenue, as Section 27.9 requires. The rent-cap conditions are at risk under the "merely incidental" test.
Regular order (60 votes, or Section B.2)	Social Security (Chapter 26); voting rights and civil rights (Chapters 12 and 13); reproductive health protection (Chapter 6) and in foreign assistance (Section 23.5.4); officer accountability (Chapter 16); campaign finance (Section 12.7); ethics (Chapter 15); the living wage (Section 3.1); competition law (Chapter 9)	Most of these have small budget effects and cannot use reconciliation.
Bipartisan (60 votes)	Permitting (Section 21.9); research expansion (Chapter 18); infrastructure (Chapter 21); frontier AI safety (Section 19.6); national service (Chapter 25); disaster resilience (Chapter 22)	These have support in both parties and can move in the first year.
Executive	The actions in Section B.5	Limited to reversals, implementation, and narrow steps the platform already supports.
Constitutional amendment	The provisions listed in Appendix A	Requires two-thirds of each chamber and three-quarters of the states.

B.4 Sequencing the First Year

The first year runs three tracks at once, following the order in Section 27.9 (low-cost reforms first, then revenue, then programs):

1. **Reconciliation track.** A budget resolution with reconciliation instructions, followed by one bill that enacts the federal tax fairness revenue together with the Tier 1 programs it funds. Revenue and programs pass in the same bill, so no program is enacted without its funding.
2. **Democracy track.** A package combining automatic voter registration (Section 12.2), election integrity (Section 12.8), Voting Rights Act restoration (Section 13.2), and the ethics reforms in Chapter 15, introduced early and paired with the Senate rules reform in Section B.2. This forces the rules question at the start of the term rather than the end.
3. **Bipartisan track.** Permitting, research, infrastructure, AI safety, and national service bills, moved in parallel to show that the platform can govern with the other party where agreement exists.

Later reconciliation bills carry Tiers 2 and 3 as revenue is scored and enacted. Social Security reform proceeds through regular order once the rules reform is in place, or through a bipartisan commission if it is not.

B.5 The First 100 Days

Executive action is limited. Orders that one president signs, the next can reverse, and the platform's own governance chapters warn against government by executive order. In the first 100 days the executive branch shall:

- **Reverse prior actions** that conflict with the platform, including Executive Order 14321 on homelessness and civil commitment (Section 8.3.5) and the Continuum of Care funding conditions that abandoned Housing First (Section 8.3.1).
- **Begin implementation:** start the rulemaking, staffing, and data systems each program will need, such as automatic SNAP verification (Section 4.5.2) and the rent-roll reporting system (Section 8.2.5), so that programs can take effect promptly once enacted.
- **Take narrow actions within existing authority** that the platform supports: begin the process of removing cannabis from the controlled-substances schedule and grant clemency for federal cannabis possession (Section 16.11); decline to renew for-profit detention contracts as they expire (Section 16.6); issue SNAP guidance that uses every exemption and waiver current law allows (Section 4.5); resume pattern-or-practice investigations with published reasons for any case closed (Section 16.14); and apply the Helms Amendment as written while beginning notice-and-comment repeal of the 2026 foreign assistance rules (Section 23.5.4).
- **Send Congress on day one** the budget resolution, the democracy package, and the Senate rules reform resolution.

B.6 Phasing In General Fund Programs

Section 27.9 sets the order. In summary:

Tiers. Open-ended programs, whose cost grows with the number of people who qualify, are ranked:

1. Income security (Chapter 4), then training and apprenticeships (Sections 3.6.7 to 3.6.9), with the Disabled Access Credit (Section 13.5.1).
2. Housing vouchers for people experiencing or at imminent risk of homelessness; eviction prevention; universal preschool and childcare cost caps; eldercare cost caps.
3. Tuition-free public higher education; student-loan reform; K-12 equity funding.
4. Universal housing vouchers.

Fixed-budget programs. Research expansion, national service, the public housing developer's operations, state rent stabilization grants, and the enhanced benefits of the National Farm Risk Protection Program are not ranked in the tiers. They follow these rules:

- **R1.** Each continues at its current-law funding level.
- **R2.** Expansion above current-law levels occurs only after Tier 1 is fully funded.
- **R3.** Expansion remains subject to a fixed statutory ceiling for each program and to the overall spending cap (Section 27.6).
- **R4.** Construction of long-lived assets, such as public housing and research facilities, uses the Capital Investment Account (Section 27.5) and the borrowing rule in Section 27.7. Debt service on that borrowing is paid through the Capital Investment Account and is not itself a General Fund phase-in item.
- **R5.** Paid leave is not a General Fund program. It is paid by a self-financing trust fund supported by a dedicated payroll contribution counted toward the combined-rate ceiling (Sections 2.8 and 3.3). The contribution rate may adjust within a statutory band to maintain trust-fund solvency.
- **R6.** The National Farm Risk Protection Program preserves current-law crop insurance commitments, while its enhanced benefits remain subject to fixed statutory ceilings.

B.7 Honest Limits

- **The rules reform needs 50 votes.** Senators of both parties have defended the 60-vote rule, and neither party has been willing to change it for legislation. Without Section B.2, the regular-order planks in Section B.3 depend on bipartisan agreement that may not exist.
- **The paid-for rule makes scoring political.** If passage depends on a CBO score, the scorekeepers and their methods will come under pressure. The platform's protections for the Congressional Budget Office and the Joint Committee on Taxation (Appendix C) matter more under this rule.
- **The parliamentarian decides what reconciliation can carry.** The tax conditions in Section 8.2.3 and parts of Chapter 5 may be ruled "merely incidental" and struck.
- **Debt service depends on the Capital Investment Account.** That account fills only when Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue exceeds the Sovereign Wealth Reserve's target. Until it does, borrowing for construction is limited to what the account can service.

- **Repeal symmetry is only as strong as the next Senate.** A future majority could change the rules again by the same method used to adopt them.
- **Executive restraint gives up early wins.** Limiting executive action means visible results depend on Congress, which moves more slowly.
- **The sequence assumes unified government.** With a divided Congress, only the bipartisan track and limited executive actions are realistic.

Sources

[1] "Trump pressures Senate GOP to kill filibuster as Thune says votes aren't there" (September 21, 2026). https://www.roic.ai/news/trump-pressures-senate-gop-to-kill-filibuster-as-thune-says-votes-arent-there-09-21-2026

[2] R Street Institute, "Limits of Budget Reconciliation Under the Byrd Rule's 'Merely Incidental' Test" (2026). https://www.rstreet.org/?p=100116

[3] Bloomberg Government, "Budget Reconciliation: A Strategic Tool in Federal Lawmaking." https://about.bgov.com/insights/budget-appropriations/budget-reconciliation-a-strategic-tool-in-federal-lawmaking/; Congressional Research Service, R48640, "The Senate's Byrd Rule: Frequently Asked Questions." https://www.everycrsreport.com/reports/R48640.html

[4] *Roll Call*, "'Byrd rule' poses challenge for voter ID bill in reconciliation" (March 25, 2026). https://rollcall.com/2026/03/25/byrd-rule-poses-challenge-for-voter-id-bill-in-reconciliation/

APPENDIX C: INSTITUTIONAL & REGULATORY DESIGN STANDARDS

Purpose

This appendix sets the design rules that every institution and regulation in the platform follows, so that rules, enforcement, and exemptions work the same way across sectors and remain legally durable.

Institutions After *Trump v. Slaughter*

In *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026), the Supreme Court held that Congress may not protect the heads of executive agencies from removal at will, with the Federal Reserve treated as an exception in *Trump v. Cook*. The Court left open protections for legislative-branch bodies and for inferior officers who report to accountable superiors.

The platform's rule is to **take discretion away rather than try to protect the person who exercises it**. Formulas, deadlines, and publication duties are written into statute, so an official who can be removed has little left to bend.

Five Durability Tools

1. **Legislative-branch placement** for advisory, scoring, and audit work (the Congressional Budget Office, the Joint Committee on Taxation, the Government Accountability Office, and advisory commissions modeled on MedPAC).

2. **Formulas in statute**: rates, thresholds, and investment mandates are set in law, and agencies apply and publish them.
3. **Reasoned, public decisions**: rejections and overrides must be published with written reasons, and removals of watchdog officials require written reasons and advance notice to Congress.
4. **Protection for career staff**: civil-service and inferior-officer protections, rather than protections for agency heads.
5. **Courts and third parties**: duties enforceable in federal court, independent outside evaluators, and Inspector General audits.

How Each Body Is Designed

Body	Section	Design
Health-payment advisory commission	5.1.3	Fee schedule set in statute. A legislative-branch commission recommends updates, which take effect unless HHS publishes a reasoned rejection
Rate appeals	5.1.4	Decided by administrative law judges
Dynamic Global Innovation Fund	5.2.2	Criteria and annual cap set in statute. Awards made through peer review that includes outside reviewers
Sovereign Wealth Reserve	1.3, 27.5	Statutory passive index mandate, private managers chosen by competitive bid, no voting rights. Draws only through the recession trigger
Social Security Endowment	26.4	Same passive mandate, reporting to the Social Security trustees
Independent costing	27.10	Congressional Budget Office and Joint Committee on Taxation
Ten-year program reviews	14.2.1	Government Accountability Office, supported by Inspectors General

Body	Section	Design
Ethics enforcement	15.9	Congressional ethics office for Congress. For the executive branch, statutory duties enforced in court, Inspector General audits, and public disclosure
Inspectors General	15.6	Written reasons and 30 days' notice before removal. Acting Inspectors General drawn from career deputies
Justice Department independence	15.11	Contact logs, disclosure to Congress, and protections for career prosecutors
Sentencing review	16.4	The United States Sentencing Commission, in the judicial branch
Critical-supplies list	21.6.1	Recommended by a national-laboratory technical office using a published method. Issued by rule subject to congressional review
Commission on Civil Rights	13.7.4	Legislative-branch commission appointed by congressional leaders of both parties. Investigates and reports, with no enforcement power
Civil rights enforcement	13.7	Private lawsuits with attorney fees, state attorney general enforcement, a right to sue after 180 days without agency action, published reasons for abandoned cases
Pay data	13.6.1	Collected by a statistical agency under a mandatory statutory duty that any person may sue to compel

Body	Section	Design
Rent stabilization floor	8.2.3, 8.2.5	Formula and coverage set in statute with no waiver authority. Tenant lawsuits with triple damages and attorney fees, state attorney general enforcement, and a mandatory IRS matching duty that any person may sue to compel. Fair-return petitions decided by administrative law judges
Homelessness programs	8.3.1, 8.3.4	Permanent housing floor and renewal rule set in statute. Funding notice deadline with automatic renewal of prior terms, notice and comment for any change in criteria, a statutory Interagency Council on Homelessness, and private and state enforcement of encampment conditions
Officer accountability	16.9	One statutory cause of action for state, local, and federal officers, enforced in court with no qualified immunity. A mandatory public reporting duty that any person may sue to compel
Pattern-or-practice enforcement	16.14	Concurrent state attorney general authority and published reasons for abandoned cases or ended consent decrees
Foreign assistance funding cutoffs (Kemp-Kasten)	23.5.4	Cutoffs rest on published evidence, with written reasons and notice to Congress

Body	Section	Design
Frontier AI oversight	19.6	Commerce/NIST. Triggers and deadlines set in statute, independent evaluators, penalties enforced in court

Cross-Sector Regulatory Rules

Rule	Applies to	Standard
Dominance Threshold	8.1.3, 9.2, 10.1.5	Conduct-based rules. Extra duties apply only above one defined threshold, never based on size alone
Strategic Protection Test	11.2, 21.6.1, 21.8, 24.3	A documented need, a capped cost, a sunset date, and congressional authority for any tariff
Coordinated Review Standard	8.1.2, 20.6, 21.9	Faster permitting through staff, coordination, and timelines, never through weaker review
Pilot rule	14.5	Pilots only for untested program designs
Paperwork rule	14.2.5	One-in-one-out applies to paperwork and reporting burdens only
Honest limits	All High Resistance and Constitutionally Contested provisions	Each states its main legal or political risk

Still to come in later editions: a single definition of a small entity, with phased compliance, and a common enforcement ladder (disclosure, then civil penalties scaled to revenue, then court orders, then criminal penalties for willful violations).

APPENDIX D: SECTION MAP (v1.0 → v1.1)

Every section of the v1.0 platform and where it appears in the v1.1 structure. Sub-sections move with their parent (for example, v1.0 Section 3.2.4 is now 5.1.4). Generated from the restructuring map; see decision 0003 and the Phase 3 Master Architecture.

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
1.1	1.1
1.2	1.2

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
1.3	1.3
1.4	2.1
1.5	2.2
1.6	2.3
1.7	2.4
1.8	2.5
2.1	3.1
2.2	4.1
2.3	3.2
2.4	21.6.1 (now a subsection of the supply-chain program)
2.5	3.3
2.6	3.4
2.7	3.5
3.1	Part II introduction
3.2	5.1
3.3	5.2
3.4	5.3
3.5	7.1
3.6	7.2
3.7	7.3
3.8	21.4
3.9	9.3
3.10	9.4
3.11	8.1
3.12	6.1
4.1	9.1
4.2	9.2
4.3	10.1
5.1	11.1
5.2	11.2
6.1	12.1
6.2	12.2
6.3	12.3
6.4	12.4

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
6.5	12.5
6.6	12.6
6.7	12.7
6.8	12.8
7.1	14.1
7.2	14.2
7.3	14.3
7.4	14.4
7.5	14.5
7.6	14.6
7.7	14.7
8.1	15.1
8.2	15.2
8.3	15.3
8.4	15.4
8.5	15.5
8.6	15.6
8.7	15.7
8.8	15.8
8.9	15.9
8.10	15.10
8.11	15.11
8.12	15.12
8.13	15.13
9.1	Part V introduction
9.2	23.2
9.3	17.2
9.4	17.3.5 (merged into this subsection)
9.5	16.6 (merged with old 10.6)
9.6	16.11
9.7	16.12
10.1	16.1
10.2	16.2
10.3	16.3

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
10.4	16.4
10.5	16.5
10.6	16.6 (merged with old 9.5)
10.7	16.7
10.8	16.8
10.9	16.9
10.10	16.10
11.1	17.1
11.2	17.3
11.3	17.4
11.4	17.5
12.1	18.1
12.2	18.2
12.3	18.3
12.4	18.4
12.5	18.5
12.6	7.4
12.7	18.6
12.8	18.7
13.1	18.8
13.2	18.9
13.3	18.10
14.1	19.1
14.2	19.2
14.3	19.3
14.4	19.4
14.5	19.5
14.6	19.6
14.7	19.7
14.8	19.8
15.1	20.1
15.2	20.2
15.3	20.3
15.4	20.4

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
15.5	20.5
15.6	20.6
15.7	20.7
16.1	21.1
16.2	21.2
16.3	21.3
16.4	21.5
16.5	21.6
16.6	21.7
16.7	21.8
16.8	21.9
17.1	22.1
17.2	22.2
17.3	22.3
17.4	22.4
17.5	22.5
17.6	22.6
17.7	22.7
17.8	22.8
17.9	22.9
17.10	22.10
17.11	22.11
18.1	24.1
18.2	24.2
18.3	24.3
18.4	24.4
18.5	24.5
18.6	24.6
18.7	24.7
18.8	24.8
18.9	24.9
18.10	24.10
18.11	24.11
19.1	23.1

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
19.2	23.3
19.3	23.4
19.4	23.5
19.5	23.6
19.6	23.7
19.7	23.8
20.1	25.1
20.2	25.2
20.3	25.3
20.4	25.4
20.5	25.5
20.6	25.6
20.7	25.7
20.8	25.8
20.9	25.9
20.10	25.10
20.11	25.11
21.1	26.1
21.2	26.2
21.3	26.3
21.4	26.4
21.5	26.5
21.6	26.6
21.7	26.7
22.1	27.1
22.2	27.2
22.3	27.3
22.4	27.4
22.5	27.5
22.6	27.6
22.7	27.7
22.8	27.8
22.9	27.9
22.10	27.10

v1.0 section	v1.1 location
22.11	27.11
22.12	27.12

Front matter: a one-page Platform Overview (replacing the embedded Executive Summary), Legal Classifications, Governing Principles (formerly Appendix A), and Definitions now precede Part I. The v1.0 Appendix B (Constitutional Amendments) is now Appendix A.